

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Modern History 05 - British Territorial Expansion (Mysore, Marathas, Sikhs; Subsidiary Alliance & Lapse) - Complete Learning Session

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

British Territorial Expansion, 1767-1856

TOPIC 05

Mysore * Marathas * Sikhs * Subsidiary Alliance * Doctrine of Lapse | GS-I Modern Indian History | Date: 2026-08-19

FOCUS

Mysore's four wars, the Maratha confederacy, the Subsidiary Alliance, Sindh, the Sikh Empire's two wars, and Dalhousie's Doctrine of Lapse and Awadh annexation, 1767-1856.

EXAM MOVE

Prelims: hold treaty years, clause detail and lapse-vs-misgovernance precision. Mains: frame expansion as a contingent, multi-instrument process, not one method.

EVIDENCE

Bipan Chandra's History of Modern India and Sekhar Bandyopadhyay's From Plassey to Partition, cross-checked against the repository's basic/advanced files and PYQ ledgers.

CAUTION

No invented troop strengths, subsidy sums, territorial shares, casualties or quotations; Topics 02, 04, 06, 07 and 11 own their adjacent themes.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

Modern History 05 - British Territorial Expansion (Mysore, Marathas, Sikhs; Subsidiary Alliance & Lapse) - Complete Learning Session

Subject: Modern Indian History | GS-I | Prelims and Mains | Date: 2026-08-19.

Source order followed: Topic 05 basic/advanced Markdown; the Master Chronology and the repository's PYQ routing ledgers and PYQ-integration audits (2018-2023, 2024-2025, 2026); OCR-searchable local editions of Bipan Chandra's *History of Modern India* and Sekhar Bandyopadhyay's *From Plassey to Partition*, and the local official Prelims/Mains papers held under attempts/_pyq_text/; a live official-heritage check for a defensible current anchor; bounded links to Modern History Topics 02, 04, 06, 07 and 11. FACT statements are source-grounded; ANALYSIS statements are qualified; no troop strength, subsidy sum, territorial share, casualty figure or quotation is invented anywhere in this package.

British Territorial Expansion, 1767-1856

TOPIC 05

Mysore * Marathas * Sikhs * Subsidiary Alliance * Doctrine of Lapse | GS-I Modern Indian History | Date: 2026-08-19

FOCUS

Mysore's four wars, the Maratha confederacy, the Subsidiary Alliance, Sindh, the Sikh Empire's two wars, and Dalhousie's Doctrine of Lapse and Awadh annexation, 1767-1856.

EVIDENCE

Bipan Chandra's *History of Modern India* and Sekhar Bandyopadhyay's *From Plassey to Partition*, cross-checked against the repository's basic/advanced files and PYQ ledgers.

EXAM MOVE

Prelims: hold treaty years, clause detail and lapse-vs-misgovernance precision. Mains: frame expansion as a contingent, multi-instrument process, not one method.

CAUTION

No invented troop strengths, subsidy sums, territorial shares, casualties or quotations; Topics 02, 04, 06, 07 and 11 own their adjacent themes.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05

Visual 0: British territorial expansion, 1767-1856 -- frame, evidence and exam moves

Visual 0: British territorial expansion, 1767-1856 -- frame, evidence and exam moves. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

Learning roadmap

1. From commercial-fiscal base to military-fiscal state: ring-fence, buffer, subsidiary dependency, paramountcy, annexation
2. Contingency, not inevitability: reading territorial expansion as a sequence of choices
3. Why Company armies prevailed I: Bengal revenue, the sepoy army, officers, artillery and logistics
4. Why Company armies prevailed II: credit and supply, maritime reinforcement, diplomacy, serial isolation, Indian allies and recruits -- and the Company's own reverses
5. Mysore's state capacity: Haidar Ali's rise, army reform and Tipu's "military fiscalism"
6. Four Anglo-Mysore Wars: alliances, treaties, Madras/Mangalore/Seringapatam
7. Malabar, Travancore and Tipu's diplomacy: the French connection without myth
8. The 1799 settlement: Seringapatam, Wodeyar restoration, subsidiary control, and why resistance failed
9. The Maratha confederacy: structure, five houses, and the cost of a headless polity
10. First Anglo-Maratha War: Raghunath Rao, Surat, Purandar, Wadgaon, Salbai
11. Treaty of Bassein, 1802: the turning point
12. Second Anglo-Maratha War: Assaye, Delhi, Laswari, and Holkar's resistance
13. Third Anglo-Maratha War: Pindaris, 1817-18, Bajirao II, and the end of the Peshwaship
14. Precedents and Wellesley's systematisation: the exact core clauses of Subsidiary Alliance
15. The case sequence: Hyderabad 1798, Mysore 1799, Awadh 1801, Bassein 1802 and after
16. Sovereignty eroded: dependency, the Resident, and the responsibility paradox
17. Sindh: commercial and strategic context, and Napier's 1843 annexation
18. Ranjit Singh's state: the Khalsa army and the Treaty of Amritsar, 1809
19. Post-1839 succession crisis: factional instability and the Khalsa's political rise
20. First Anglo-Sikh War: battles, the Treaty of Lahore, and the Treaty of Bhyrowal
21. Second Anglo-Sikh War: the Multan trigger, Chillianwala and Gujrat, and annexation, 1849
22. The Doctrine of Lapse: principles, the paramountcy debate, and Satara/Jhansi/Nagpur
23. Awadh, 1856: misgovernance, explicitly not Lapse
24. Dispossession and the bounded bridge to 1857
25. Historiography: four lenses on territorial expansion
26. Comparative synthesis: Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh; war vs alliance vs lapse vs misgovernance
27. Sources, PYQ audit and practice.

PRE-TEACH CHECKLIST

Book context: queried - Topic 05 basic/advanced notes, the Master Chronology, the repository's PYQ-integration audits for 2018-2023, 2024-2025 and 2026, and the Prelims/Mains routing ledgers were checked, alongside OCR-searchable local chapters of Bipan Chandra and Sekhar Bandyopadhyay covering Mysore, the Marathas, the Subsidiary Alliance, Sindh, the Sikh wars and Dalhousie's annexations. Modern History Topic 02 (18th-century regional states) and Topic 04 (Bengal conquest and fiscal base) are assumed as background, not repeated; Topics 06 (constitutional development), 07 (economic impact) and 11 (1857) are named only as bounded forward hand-offs.

CA Search: "Srirangapatna Tipu Sultan fort ASI conservation Waqf Board heritage news 2025 2026"

CA Found: in late 2025, routine civil work near Srirangapatna's fort (Tipu Sultan's capital and the site of the 1799 siege this topic teaches) unearthed ten cannonballs dated to Tipu's era, reported in the regional press as a reminder of the site's ongoing archaeological significance; separately, a 2025 dispute placed over 70 heritage properties at Srirangapatna -- several linked to Tipu-era structures under ASI care -- on Waqf Board revenue records, prompting public debate on the site's protected status. The Ministry of Culture's 2025-26 national allocation of Rs 376.88 crore for ASI conservation, preservation and environmental development of centrally protected monuments (the same figure this repository has verified for other topics) covers Srirangapatna among many sites nationally. Verify any further 2026 site-specific ruling or allocation officially before citing new specifics. STATIC LINK retained for exam use: Srirangapatna's fort and the Gumbaz (Tipu's mausoleum) are the standing heritage anchor for the Fourth Anglo-Mysore War and the 1799 settlement this topic teaches; the Waqf-record dispute and the 2025 finds are heritage-linkage notes, not examinable facts about the 1799 siege itself.

PART I - THE FISCAL-MILITARY FRAME AND WHY COMPANY ARMIES PREVAILED

1. From commercial-fiscal base to military-fiscal state: ring-fence, buffer, subsidiary dependency, paramountcy, annexation

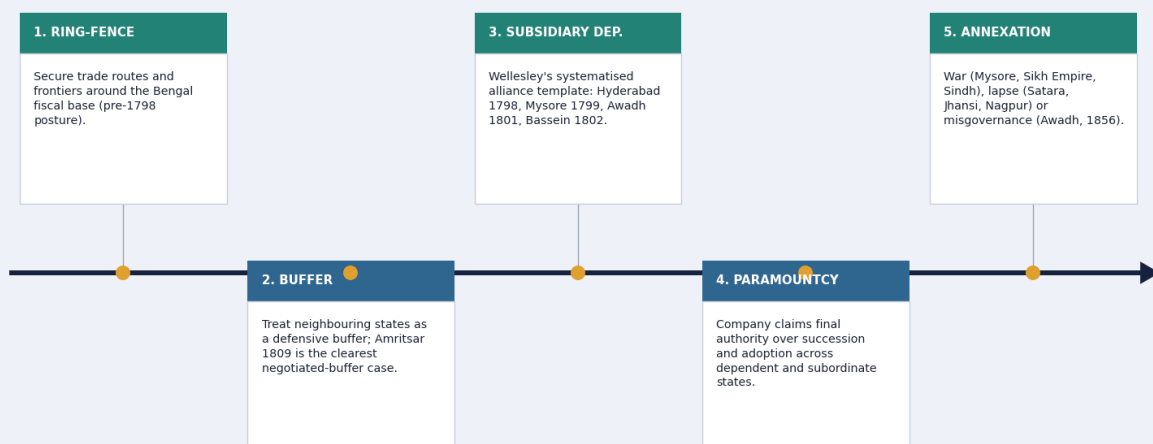
Topic 04 established that Buxar and the 1765 Treaty of Allahabad converted the Company from a trading concern with political leverage into Bengal's direct revenue sovereign. This topic begins where that one ends: it asks how a firm holding one province's Diwani became, within roughly sixty years, the paramount power over virtually the entire subcontinent except the Punjab and Sindh. The honest answer is not a single master plan executed from Calcutta, but a recognisable escalating ladder of policy postures that different Governors-General climbed at different speeds, for different local reasons, using the same underlying fiscal-military capacity built on Bengal's revenues.

FACT: five successive postures recur across this topic and are worth naming precisely, because examiners routinely test whether a candidate can place a specific episode on the correct rung. **Ring-fence/buffer policy** treated a neighbouring state as a security perimeter to be kept stable and friendly, not conquered -- the Company's early stance toward Awadh after 1765 and its early stance toward the Sikh state before 1809 both fit this description. **Subsidiary dependency** (examined fully in Part IV) converted a formally sovereign ally into a state that had surrendered its own army, diplomacy and, often, part of its revenue, while its ruler remained on the throne. **Paramountcy**, a term historians attribute to Lord Hastings's explicit articulation from 1813, asserted that the Company's own security interests entitled it to override, arbitrate, or threaten any Indian state's internal or external conduct, whether or not a subsidiary treaty existed. **Annexation** -- the direct absorption of territory into Company-administered provinces -- was the final rung, reached by outright conquest (Mysore's core territory in 1799, Sindh in 1843, the Punjab in 1849), by succession doctrine (the Lapse cases culminating in 1848-56), or by an administrative pretext (Awadh, 1856).

ANALYSIS: reading these five postures as a ladder, rather than as unrelated episodes, does two things for an answer. First, it explains why the same decade could see the Company simultaneously act as a cautious neighbour (toward the Sikh state before 1839), an intrusive over-lord (toward Hyderabad and Awadh after 1798-1801), and an outright conqueror (toward Mysore in 1799) -- these were not contradictory policies but different rungs applied to different states at different moments of relative strength. Second, it prevents the common error of treating "expansion" as one uniform process; a 15- or 20-mark answer earns marks precisely by naming which rung a given episode belongs to, rather than describing all of Company expansion as generic "conquest."

Five rungs of Company expansion, 1767-1856

MASTER TIMELINE



Read left to right as escalating leverage, not a fixed timetable -- any state could remain at an earlier rung for decades (Amritsar's Punjab held at 'buffer' from 1809 to 1839) before moving on.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Expansion master timeline

Visual 1: five rungs of Company expansion -- ring-fence, buffer, subsidiary dependency, paramountcy, annexation

Visual 1: five rungs of Company expansion -- ring-fence, buffer, subsidiary dependency, paramountcy, annexation. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

2. Contingency, not inevitability: reading territorial expansion as a sequence of choices

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: a persistent temptation in narrating 1767-1856 is to write it backwards -- to treat the 1856 map of British India as the predetermined destination of a single continuous plan set in motion at Plassey. Every governor-generalship examined in this package resists that reading. Company directors in London genuinely wavered between expansion and retrenchment: Warren Hastings's era mixed opportunistic war with real caution; the Court of Directors recalled Wellesley in 1805 specifically because his wars had produced a financial crisis, not because London approved of unlimited conquest; Cornwallis returned in 1805 with explicit non-intervention instructions; and even Dalhousie's annexations were debated, not unanimous, within Company and parliamentary circles of the day. Local governors-general on the spot frequently exceeded, reinterpreted, or reversed instructions from London based on immediate security or revenue calculations, meaning the trajectory of expansion was produced by repeated local decisions, not executed from a single fixed blueprint.

FACT: the clearest textbook evidence for genuine contingency is that the Company lost battles and signed treaties it did not dictate on its own terms. Haidar Ali forced the Madras Council to accept peace on his terms in 1769; the Marathas defeated a British force at Wadgaon in 1779, forcing the humiliating Convention of Wadgaon; the First Anglo-Maratha War ended in 1782 with the negotiated Treaty of Salbai, a genuine settlement rather than a dictated surrender; and Yeshwant Rao Holkar fought Company forces to a standstill in 1804-05, contributing to Wellesley's recall. None of these outcomes fit a narrative of predetermined, uncontested conquest.

ANALYSIS: this does not mean expansion was accidental or that no consistent pattern existed -- the pattern (war, alliance, and annexation feeding a growing fiscal-military base that made the next round of expansion easier) is real and repeats across all three fronts this topic covers. The correct formulation, and the one that earns marks in a "was British expansion inevitable" question, is that expansion was **structurally favoured but not predetermined**: each governor-general's forward policy was itself a contested choice, reversible in principle, whose cumulative effect nonetheless built an increasingly self-reinforcing advantage.

3. Why Company armies prevailed I: Bengal revenue, the sepoy army, officers, artillery and logistics

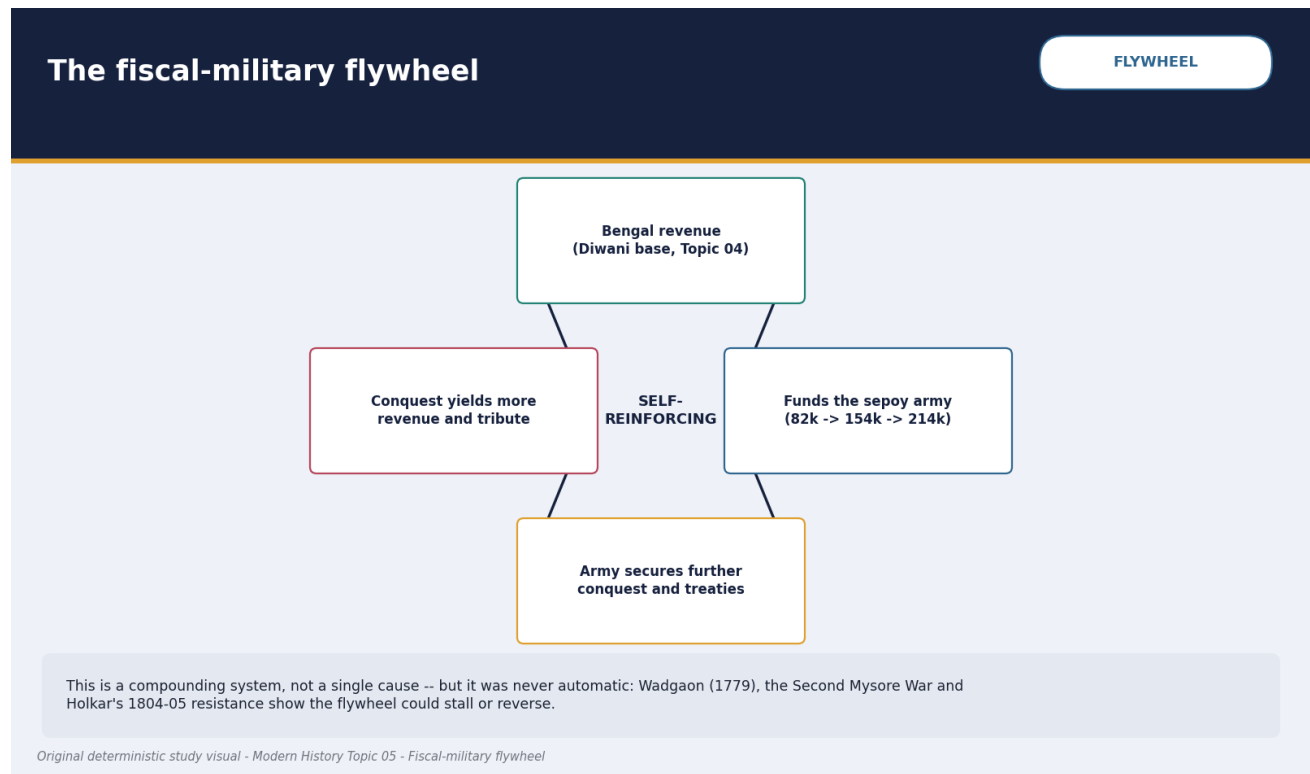
Directly answers the 2022 Mains GS-I Q2 demand (examined in full as a solved Mains model in Part IX): why did Company armies, mostly Indian soldiers, defeat larger and often well-equipped Indian armies with such consistency? The first and most load-bearing part of the answer is fiscal: Bengal's Diwani, secured in 1765, gave the Company a large, increasingly reliable direct-tax base entirely independent of trade profit or metropolitan remittance, and this revenue is what financed every subsequent campaign this topic covers -- Mysore, Maratha, Sindh and Sikh alike. Historians studying the Company's army (notably Douglas Peers) describe this fusion of taxation and military build-up as a form of "**military fiscalism**": the army was not merely funded by the state, it was itself one of the state's primary instruments for extracting and defending revenue, creating a self-reinforcing loop between fiscal capacity and military capacity.

FACT: the Company's sepoy armies expanded steadily after the conquest of Bengal and were composed predominantly of Indian soldiers under a comparatively thin European officer corps. Their strategic importance came from permanence, regular finance, drill, artillery support and organised logistics rather than from an unsupported aggregate headcount. Recruitment drew heavily from north Indian military-labour networks, while later expansion brought additional regional groups into Company service.

ANALYSIS: three structural features distinguished this force from most opposing Indian armies of the period, and each is a legitimate, source-grounded exam point. **Permanence and regularity of pay:** soldiers who are paid reliably, in cash, on a fixed schedule are more disciplined and less prone to desertion or extortion of the local population than irregularly paid troops, and several regional Indian states struggled to match this regularity once their own revenue bases were strained by war. **A standing officer corps and artillery arm:** European-trained artillery and engineering officers gave the Company a durable technical edge in siege warfare (decisive at Seringapatam in 1799 and

repeatedly in the Maratha wars), even where individual Indian armies matched or exceeded Company numbers.

Integrated logistics: a functioning commissariat, credit network and transport system let Company armies sustain campaigns far from their home bases (Wellesley's armies fighting simultaneously in the Deccan and north India in 1803 is the clearest example), whereas several opposing forces depended on more localised, less continuous supply arrangements.



Visual 2: the fiscal-military flywheel -- Bengal revenue, army, conquest, more revenue

Visual 2: the fiscal-military flywheel -- Bengal revenue, army, conquest, more revenue. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

4. Why Company armies prevailed II: credit and supply, maritime reinforcement, diplomacy, serial isolation, Indian allies and recruits -- and the Company's own reverses

FACT: beyond fiscal depth and standing military organisation, the Company drew on three further, well-evidenced advantages. **Credit and banking access:** Company forces could draw on organised credit markets (including, in Bengal, banking houses such as the Jagat Seths in the Plassey era) to bridge campaign expenses ahead of revenue collection, a facility not every regional treasury could match on comparable terms. **Maritime reinforcement:** naval control of the Bengal, Bombay and Madras coastlines let the Company move troops, artillery and supplies by sea between presidencies faster than most opponents could redeploy overland -- Clive and Watson's relief of Calcutta by sea in January 1757, and the ability to reinforce Madras from Bengal during the Mysore wars, both illustrate this.

Diplomacy that produced serial isolation of opponents: this is the single most consistently documented mechanism across all three fronts this topic covers. Cornwallis brought the Marathas, the Nizam and the rulers of Travancore and Coorg into alliance against Tipu in the Third Anglo-Mysore War (1790-92); the same Maratha-Nizam combination had fought alongside the Company against Haidar Ali in the First Anglo-Mysore War, then against the Company in the Second; and Wellesley methodically detached Hyderabad, the restored Mysore state, and then the Peshwa himself from any common front, before finally confronting Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar in sequence rather than together.

FACT: this diplomacy relied heavily on **Indian allies and recruits**, not on Company arms alone. The Nizam of Hyderabad fought alongside the Company against Mysore in three of the four Anglo-Mysore Wars; substantial numbers of Indian soldiers disbanded from defeated Mysorean and Maratha armies were absorbed, where the Company's own recruitment system could accommodate them, into its expanding sepoy ranks; and Company campaigns regularly depended on Indian intelligence networks, supply contractors and local guides. ANALYSIS: this

recruitment and alliance pattern means the "British versus Indians" framing that sometimes appears in popular retellings is imprecise -- a more accurate description, and the one the 2022 PYQ itself invites ("armies... mostly comprising of Indian soldiers"), is that Company campaigns were fought predominantly by Indian personnel under a British-organised fiscal-military and diplomatic system, against other Indian rulers who were rarely able to sustain a comparably durable coalition against it.

FACT: this advantage was neither immediate nor unbroken, and any complete answer must include the Company's own limitations and reverses, both to avoid overclaiming and because these episodes are independently examinable. Haidar Ali twice defeated Company forces decisively enough to dictate peace terms (1769 and again through the early 1780s, when he "inflicted one defeat after another" on Company armies in the Carnatic); the Marathas defeated a Company force at Wadgaon in 1779, forcing a full renunciation of gains; and Yeshwant Rao Holkar's mobile Maratha tactics, combined with the Raja of Bharatpur's resistance, inflicted heavy losses on Lord Lake's forces in 1804-05 and contributed directly to Wellesley's recall. In the Anglo-Sikh Wars, the Company suffered severe losses at Ferozeshah (1845) and again at Chillianwala (1849) before recovering to win the decisive engagements that followed. ANALYSIS: including these reverses is not a concession that weakens the "why Company armies won" argument -- it strengthens it, by showing that Company success rested on a durable, resilient system (fiscal depth, replaceable manpower, alliance-building) that could absorb individual defeats, rather than on uninterrupted battlefield dominance.



Visual 3: the Company victory system -- eight linked factors and where each fits

Visual 3: the Company victory system -- eight linked factors and where each fits. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

PART II - MYSORE: HAIDAR ALI AND TIPU SULTAN

5. Mysore's state capacity: Haidar Ali's rise, army reform and Tipu's "military fiscalism"

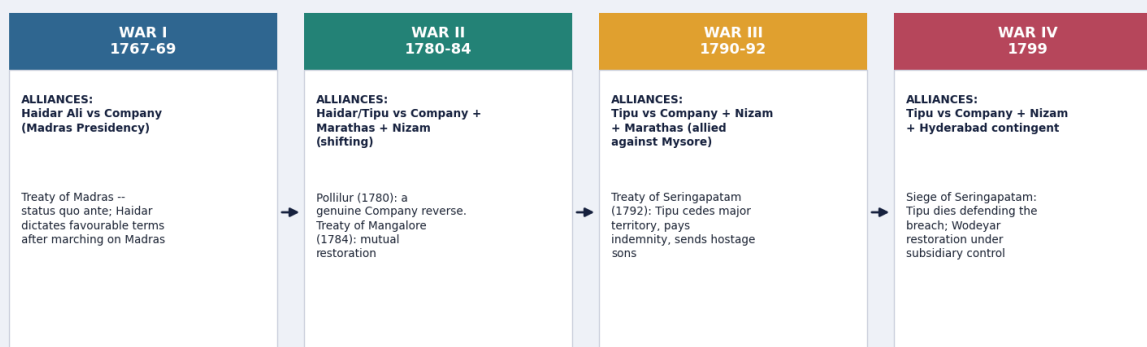
FACT: Mysore rose from a Vijayanagara-era vice-royalty into an assertive regional power across the eighteenth century, with its centralised military authority strengthening from the reign of Chikkadevaraja Wodeyar in the late seventeenth century. Haidar Ali, a man of comparatively humble origin who began as a junior Mysore army officer, rose through military talent and, by 1761, ousted the corrupt dalavai (chief minister) Nanjaraj and effectively took charge of the state, leaving the Wodeyar king as a titular figurehead. Haidar modernised his army with French-trained officers, building an efficient, European-disciplined infantry and artillery organised through the risala system -- fixed-strength units with clear chains of command reporting directly to the ruler -- and used this reformed force to subjugate local hereditary chiefs (deshmukhs and pategars) who had previously controlled the countryside's agricultural surplus.

FACT: Haidar, and after him Tipu Sultan, replaced indirect, intermediary-based land-revenue collection with direct assessment and cash collection by salaried state officials, sharply enlarging the state's own resource base while curbing the older Mughal-derived jagir system. The historian Burton Stein has described Tipu's revenue system as a form of **"military fiscalism"**: taxes collected from a wide base directly by state officials specifically to mobilise resources for a large standing army, part of a deliberate project to build centralised military hegemony in place of the older segmentary, intermediary-sharing structure inherited from Vijayanagara. ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this is the same underlying logic -- revenue depth converted into permanent military capacity -- that the Company itself was applying at greater scale from its Bengal base (subtopic 3); Mysore is best understood not as a "traditional" state overwhelmed by a "modern" one, but as a rival state pursuing a structurally similar fiscal-military strategy on a smaller territorial and resource base.

FACT: Tipu's ambitions extended beyond the army. His state encouraged agricultural expansion (tax remission for reclaiming wasteland), promoted irrigation repair and new construction, encouraged manufacturing and sericulture, sent missions toward Europe seeking technology, built a navy, and launched what one historian (Irfan Habib, as cited by Sekhar Bandyopadhyay) has been more cautious about, noting that Tipu's modernising ambitions ran well ahead of the state's actual resources, so that Mysore remained, in this reading, "far away from a real opening to modern civilization." Even hostile contemporaries reportedly conceded that Mysore's agriculture and population were among the most flourishing in India of the period. ANALYSIS: this combination -- genuine, source-attested reform ambition, alongside a resource base that could not fully sustain every ambition -- is the correct, qualified position for an exam answer; overstating Mysore's modernity (claiming it rivalled contemporary European industrial capacity) is as much an error as dismissing Tipu's reforms as mere myth.

Four Anglo-Mysore Wars: alliances and treaties, 1767-99

MYSORE WARS



Mysore was allied with the Company against a common front only once (effectively never); the Company instead allied with the Nizam and/or the Marathas against Mysore in three of the four wars -- serial diplomatic isolation, not superior force alone.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Four Anglo-Mysore Wars

Visual 4: Mysore's military-fiscal reform under Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan

Visual 4: Mysore's military-fiscal reform under Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

6. Four Anglo-Mysore Wars: alliances, treaties, Madras/Mangalore/Seringapatam

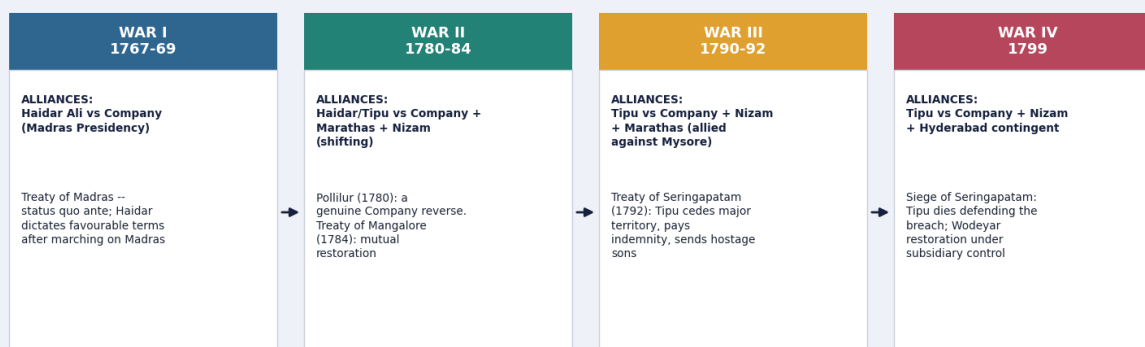
FACT: there were four rounds of Company-Mysore warfare, and the alliance pattern across them is itself a classic exam point, because it shifted each time. In the **First Anglo-Mysore War (1767-69)**, the Marathas and the Nizam initially stood with the Company against Haidar Ali; Haidar nonetheless defeated Company forces decisively enough to threaten Madras directly in 1769 and dictate peace on his own terms, concluded as the **Treaty of Madras (1769)**, a mutual restoration of conquests with a promise of mutual defence that the Company did not honour when the Marathas attacked Haidar in 1771. In the **Second Anglo-Mysore War (1780-84)**, the alliance inverted: the Marathas and the Nizam now joined Haidar against the Company, part of a wider anti-British combination that also drew in the Company's difficulties in the American colonies and against France. Haidar again inflicted repeated defeats on Company forces in the Carnatic; after his death in December 1782, his son Tipu Sultan continued the war, which ended inconclusively with the **Treaty of Mangalore (1784)**, restoring each side's conquests.

FACT: in the **Third Anglo-Mysore War (1790-92)**, the alliance reverted again: the Marathas and the Nizam sided with the Company, and Lord Cornwallis's forces, together with these allies, defeated Tipu after he attacked the Company's ally the Raja of Travancore. The resulting **Treaty of Seringapatam (1792)** required Tipu to cede roughly half his territory to the allies and pay a substantial war indemnity (a scholarly range is cited in different accounts; this package does not assert a single precise sum). ANALYSIS: the correct exam-ready generalisation is that Mysore's Maratha and Hyderabad neighbours fought *with* the Company in the First and Third wars but *against* it in the Second -- a pattern that shows regional alliance choices were driven by immediate calculations of relative threat, not by any settled "Indian versus British" camp, and that the Company's diplomacy (subtopic 4) worked specifically by keeping that calculation tilted in its favour more often than not.

FACT: the **Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799)** was fought without a comparable Maratha-Nizam counterweight problem, since Lord Wellesley had already secured Hyderabad's Subsidiary Alliance in 1798 (Part IV) and moved decisively against Tipu after learning of his renewed diplomatic contact with Revolutionary France. The war ended with the fall of Seringapatam and Tipu's death on 4 May 1799, examined in full in subtopic 8.

Four Anglo-Mysore Wars: alliances and treaties, 1767-99

MYSORE WARS



Mysore was allied with the Company against a common front only once (effectively never); the Company instead allied with the Nizam and/or the Marathas against Mysore in three of the four wars -- serial diplomatic isolation, not superior force alone.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Four Anglo-Mysore Wars

Visual 5: four Anglo-Mysore Wars -- shifting alliances and treaties, 1767-1799

Visual 5: four Anglo-Mysore Wars -- shifting alliances and treaties, 1767-1799. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

7. Malabar, Travancore and Tipu's diplomacy: the French connection without myth

FACT: Haidar Ali had invaded and annexed Malabar and Calicut in 1766, extending Mysore's reach to the Kerala coast and its lucrative pepper, sandalwood and cardamom trade; this expansion brought Mysore into recurring friction with both the Marathas (whose own reach extended along the Konkan-Malabar coast) and with the Raja of Travancore, whose territory bordered Mysore's southern Malabar holdings. Tipu's 1789-90 attack on Travancore -- a state under Company protection -- supplied Lord Cornwallis's direct pretext for the Third Anglo-Mysore War. Tipu had also, in the mid-1780s, imposed export embargoes on pepper, sandalwood and cardamom through his ports and restricted English traders' dealings, directly threatening Company and private-merchant commercial interests in the region -- a commercial friction that sat alongside, and reinforced, the wider strategic rivalry.

FACT: Tipu did pursue genuine diplomatic overtures toward Revolutionary France, including missions seeking European technological and military assistance, and separately sent missions toward Afghanistan, Arabia and Turkey seeking anti-British alliances; he was also reported to have invited Zaman Shah, the ruler of Kabul, to join a concerted effort against the Company in northern India. **ANALYSIS:** contemporary British officials treated the French connection as an urgent existential threat, but this threat perception has been read by later historians (Edward Ingram's assessment of the period, as reported by Sekhar Bandyopadhyay) as substantially exaggerated relative to the real likelihood of an actual French invasion of British India by the late 1790s -- there was little realistic prospect of a French landing via Egypt or the Cape by that date. The historically correct, balanced position is therefore: Tipu's outreach to France was real and diplomatically significant, but the scale of "French threat" invoked by Wellesley to justify the Fourth Anglo-Mysore War substantially outran the actual military probability of French intervention, and functioned at least as much as a pretext for a war Wellesley had independent reasons to want.

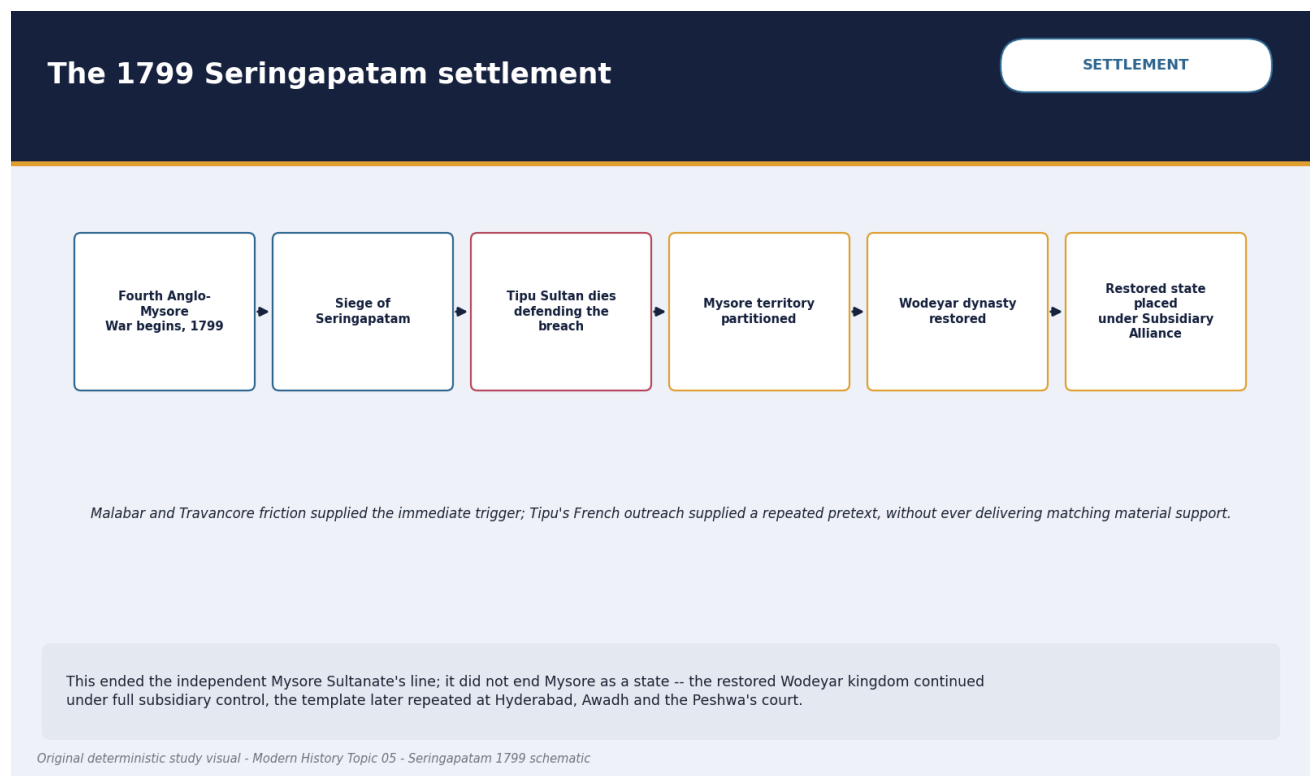
ANALYSIS: this is also the right place to state, without cultural caricature, why Mysore's resistance nonetheless ultimately failed despite genuine military and administrative reform: Tipu fought without a durable regional coalition (the Marathas and the Nizam were with the Company in three of the four wars), his territorial ambitions in Malabar and against Travancore created additional regional friction that the Company's diplomacy could exploit, and his single state's resource base -- however impressively mobilised -- could not indefinitely outlast a Company drawing on the combined and growing fiscal capacity of Bengal, Madras and an expanding alliance network. Mysore's defeat is

therefore a story of a genuinely capable, reforming state defeated by structural and diplomatic isolation, not a story of Indian military or administrative backwardness.

8. The 1799 settlement: Seringapatam, Wodeyar restoration, subsidiary control, and why resistance failed

FACT: the Company's army, reinforced to prevent any French assistance from reaching Tipu in time, defeated Mysore's forces and stormed Seringapatam; Tipu died on 4 May 1799 defending his capital, and his army is recorded as having remained loyal to him through the city's fall. Nearly half of Tipu's remaining dominions were divided between the Company and its ally the Nizam, with some territory (including Wynad, Coimbatore, Canara and Sunda, and the Malabar coast) annexed directly by the Company and folded into an enlarged Madras Presidency together with the absorbed Carnatic. The reduced core of Mysore was restored to the Wodeyar dynasty -- the original royal line that Haidar Ali had displaced decades earlier -- but the restored Raja was immediately bound by a Subsidiary Alliance treaty (Part IV) that authorised the Governor-General to assume the administration of the state if judged necessary, making Mysore, in substance, a complete dependency of the Company from 1799 onward.

FACT: an important, separate result of the Fourth Anglo-Mysore War was the elimination of any realistic French foothold or influence in southern India, removing the strategic justification Wellesley himself had most emphasised for the campaign. ANALYSIS: the sequence -- war, territorial partition, restoration of a pliable dynasty, and immediate subsidiary subordination -- is the template Wellesley then extended methodically across the rest of India (Part IV); Mysore in 1799 is best read as the opening, most militarily decisive case of a pattern that would recur, in less violent form, at Hyderabad, Awadh, Poona and elsewhere.



Visual 6: the 1799 Seringapatam settlement -- siege, partition, restoration, subsidiary control

Visual 6: the 1799 Seringapatam settlement -- siege, partition, restoration, subsidiary control. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

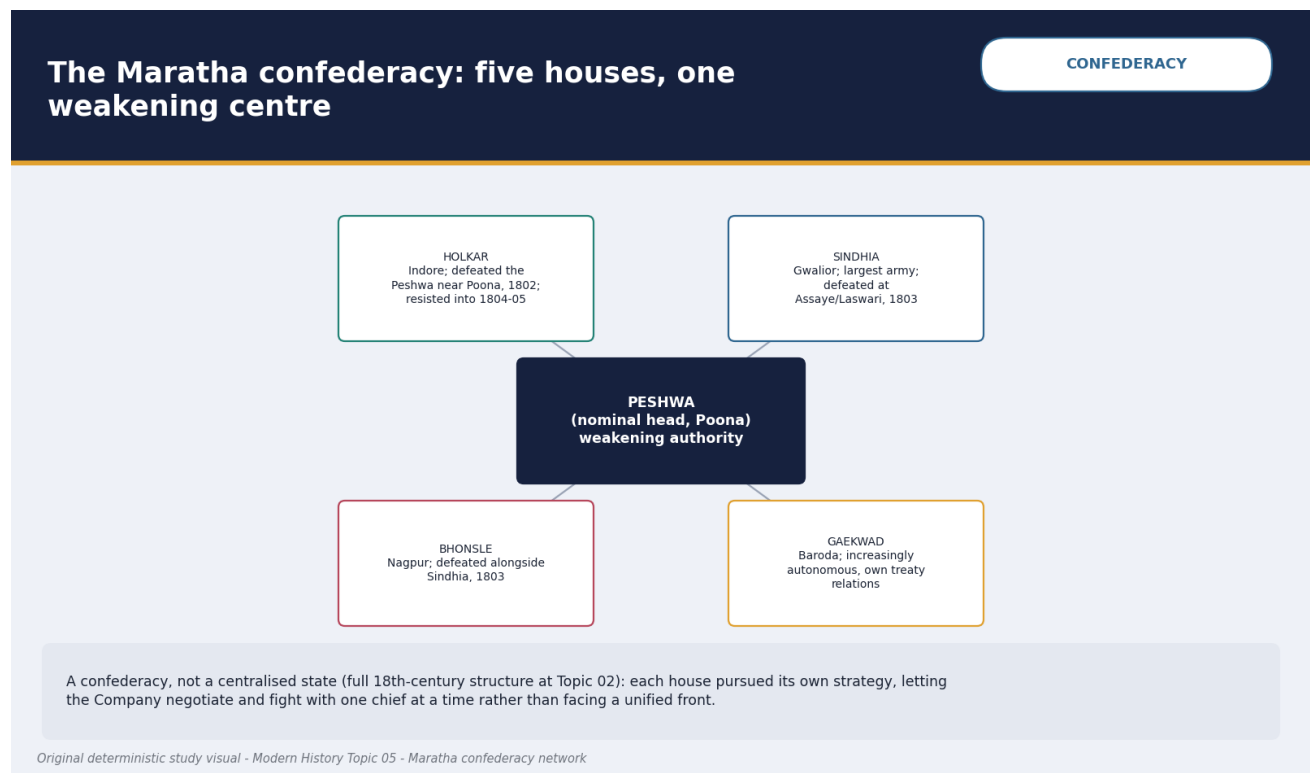
PART III - THE MARATHAS

9. The Maratha confederacy: structure, five houses, and the cost of a headless polity

(Topic 02 owns the Marathas' eighteenth-century rise and internal state structure in full; this subtopic recaps only what is load-bearing for the Company wars that follow.)

FACT: by the later eighteenth century, Maratha power was organised as a confederacy of five major houses -- the Peshwa at Poona (nominal head of the confederacy), the Sindhia (Scindia) of Gwalior, the Holkar of Indore, the Bhonsle of Nagpur, and the Gaekwad of Baroda -- rather than as a single centralised kingdom. This structure had given Maratha power its remarkable eighteenth-century territorial reach, but it also meant the confederacy's cohesion depended heavily on a small number of capable individual leaders and on the Peshwa's personal authority to arbitrate disputes among the houses. **FACT:** by 1800, a cluster of the confederacy's most experienced leaders -- Mahadji Sindhia, Tukoji Holkar, Ahilya Bai Holkar, Peshwa Madhav Rao II and the long-serving minister Nana Phadnis, who had held the confederacy together for roughly three decades -- had all died, leaving a younger, more fractious generation of chiefs, most visibly Yeshwant Rao Holkar and Daulat Rao Sindhia, locked in open rivalry with each other and with Peshwa Baji Rao II.

ANALYSIS: this matters for the whole of Part III because it explains, without denying Maratha agency or military capacity, why the Company could repeatedly apply its own "serial isolation" diplomacy (subtopic 4) against the Marathas specifically: a confederacy whose constituent houses did not trust one another, and periodically fought each other directly (Holkar's defeat of the combined Peshwa-Sindhia force at Poona in October 1802 is the clearest single example), gave the Company recurring openings to negotiate with, subordinate, or defeat one house without facing a unified Maratha response. The Marathas' military capacity was real and repeatedly demonstrated on the battlefield (subtopics 10-13); their vulnerability was structural and political, not a lack of fighting ability.



Visual 7: the Maratha confederacy -- five houses and the Peshwa's weakening authority

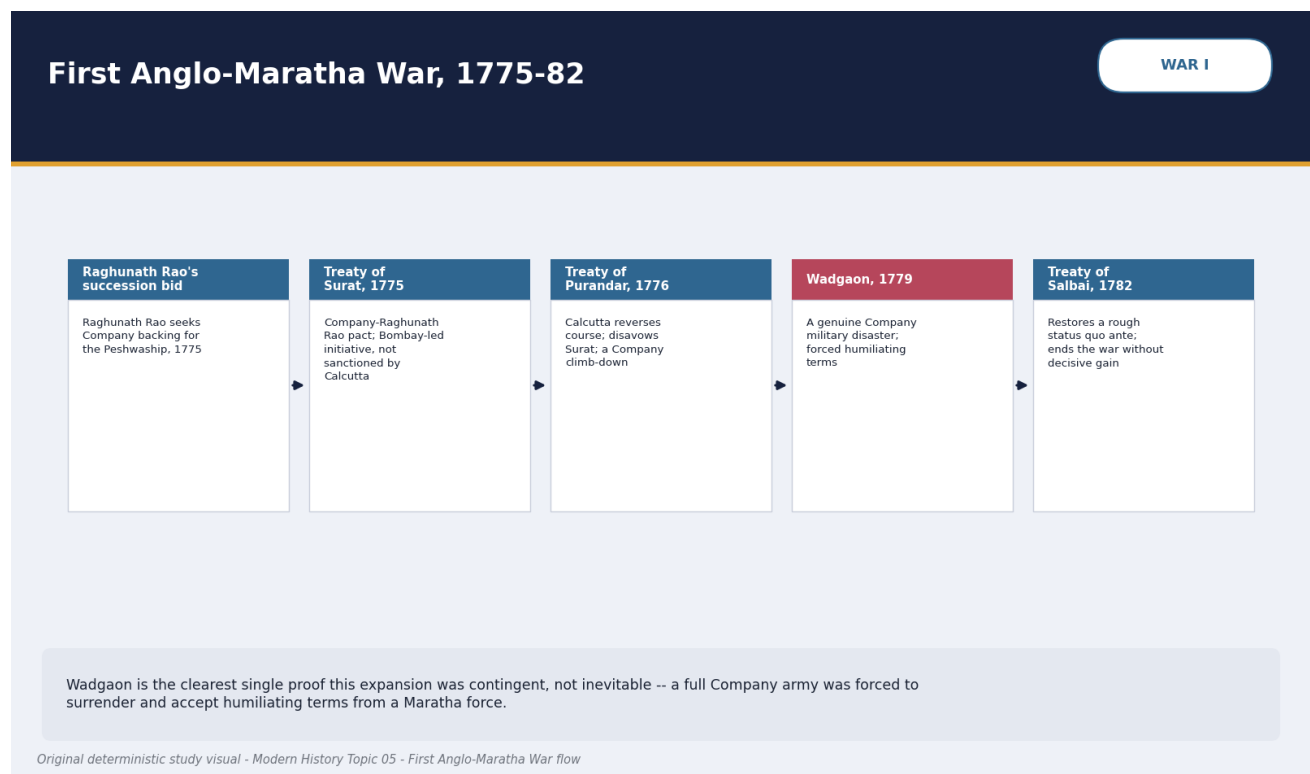
Visual 7: the Maratha confederacy -- five houses and the Peshwa's weakening authority. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

10. First Anglo-Maratha War: Raghunath Rao, Surat, Purandar, Wadgaon, Salbai

FACT: the First Anglo-Maratha War (1775-82) originated in a Maratha succession dispute: Raghunath Rao, implicated in the killing of his nephew Peshwa Narayan Rao, was opposed by the confederacy's other sardars under the young Peshwa Madhav Rao II and the minister Nana Phadnis, and turned to the Company's Bombay establishment for support. In 1775 the Bombay government agreed to back Raghunath Rao's claim, and after his forces were defeated in Gujarat, offered him direct support -- an intervention traditionally associated with an agreement (the Treaty of Surat) trading Company backing for territorial and revenue concessions from Raghunath Rao, though this early Bombay-led initiative was not ratified by the Company's Calcutta authorities.

FACT: the Calcutta government's own negotiators instead concluded the inconclusive **Treaty of Purandar (1776)**, under which the Company withdrew support from Raghunath Rao in exchange for concessions, but this settlement was not honoured by all parties and fighting resumed in 1777-79. A Bombay force advancing toward Poona was defeated and encircled by regrouped Maratha forces under Nana Phadnis, Sindhia and Holkar, forcing the humiliating **Convention/Treaty of Wadgaon (1779)**, by which the English renounced all their conquests and abandoned Raghunath Rao's cause outright. Warren Hastings, then Governor-General at Calcutta, refused to accept this reverse as final: a Bengal force under Goddard marched across central India and captured Ahmedabad in 1780, demonstrating that the Company could sustain a war effort even after a serious battlefield defeat, while Mahadji Sindhia's continued military strength meant neither side could force a decisive result.

FACT: peace was concluded through Mahadji Sindhia's mediation in the **Treaty of Salbai (1782)**, which restored the pre-war status quo between the Company and the Marathas and secured roughly twenty years of peace between them -- a genuinely negotiated settlement, not a dictated surrender, and clear evidence against any inevitability narrative for this period. ANALYSIS: Salbai's importance runs beyond its own terms: it gave the Company two decades to consolidate Bengal governance largely undisturbed by Maratha pressure, while the Maratha chiefs spent much of the same period in internal rivalry rather than renewed external expansion -- and it further indirectly enabled the Company to press Mysore in the Third Anglo-Mysore War, since the Marathas had separately promised cooperation against Haidar Ali as part of the wider settlement climate of the early 1780s.



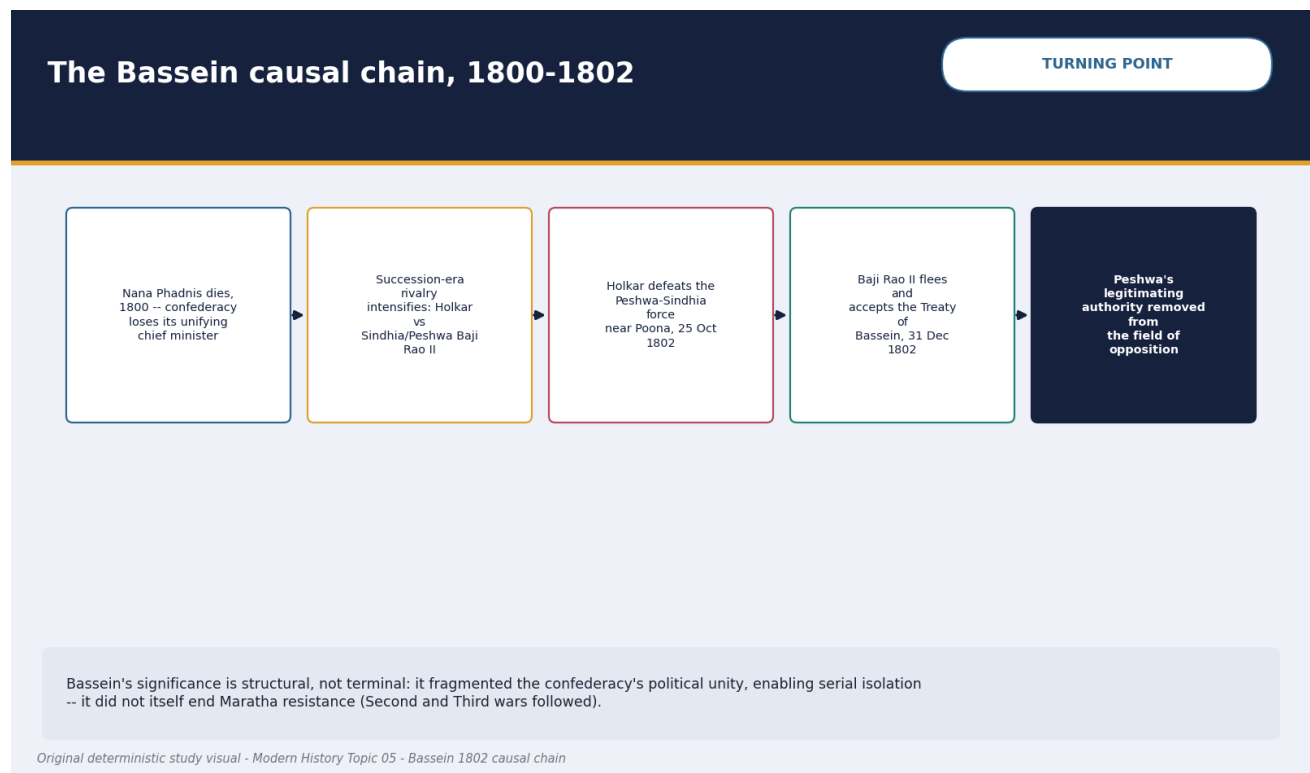
Visual 8: First Anglo-Maratha War -- Surat to Purandar to Wadgaon to Salbai

Visual 8: First Anglo-Maratha War -- Surat to Purandar to Wadgaon to Salbai. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

11. Treaty of Bassein, 1802: the turning point

FACT: Lord Wellesley repeatedly offered a Subsidiary Alliance to the Peshwa and to Sindhia during the years around 1800, and the far-sighted Nana Phadnis had consistently refused. Nana Phadnis's death in 1800, however, removed the confederacy's most experienced check on internal rivalry, and the succession-era feuding examined in subtopic 9 intensified sharply between Yeshwant Rao Holkar on one side and Daulat Rao Sindhia and Peshwa Baji Rao II on the other. On 25 October 1802, Holkar decisively defeated the combined forces of the Peshwa and Sindhia near Poona; Baji Rao II fled and, before the year's end, signed the **Treaty of Bassein (31 December 1802)**, accepting a Subsidiary Alliance with the Company.

FACT: under this treaty, the Peshwa ceded territory (including Surat) to the Company, accepted a permanent British force at his own expense, admitted a Resident to his court, and agreed not to employ Europeans without British approval -- the exact clause structure examined in full in Part IV. Wellesley himself described the moment, in a letter dated 24 December 1802, as the most favourable opportunity yet for establishing British interests within the Maratha empire without risking war with the confederacy as a whole. ANALYSIS: Bassein is properly read as the single most consequential turning point in Company-Maratha relations, not because it ended Maratha military resistance (Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar all fought on, as subtopics 12-13 show), but because it removed the Peshwa -- the confederacy's nominal head and its most important legitimating figure -- from the field of potential opposition, converting what had been an external contest between the Company and a (nominally unified) Maratha power into a set of separate conflicts between the Company and individual Maratha houses, each of which the Company could now fight, one at a time, with the Peshwa's own formal authority no longer available to the opposing side.



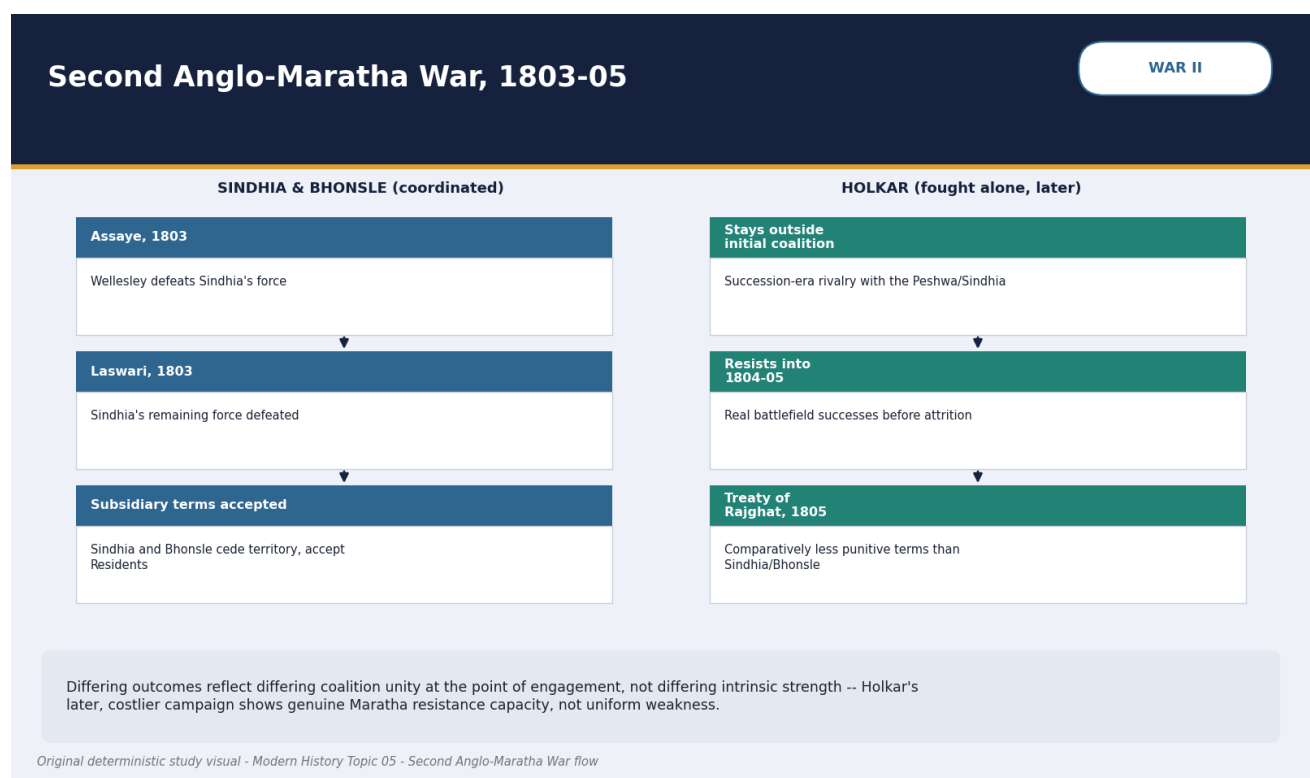
Visual 9: the Bassein causal chain, 1800-1802 -- from Nana Phadnis's death to the Peshwa's Subsidiary Alliance

Visual 9: the Bassein causal chain, 1800-1802 -- from Nana Phadnis's death to the Peshwa's Subsidiary Alliance. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

12. Second Anglo-Maratha War: Assaye, Delhi, Laswari, and Holkar's resistance

FACT: Bassein directly triggered the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05), as Sindhia and Bhonsle rejected the Peshwa's subordination and took up arms, while Holkar initially stood aside and the Gaekwad of Baroda supported the Company -- again illustrating the confederacy's persistent disunity in action (Sindhia and Bhonsle fought while Holkar watched; when Holkar later took up arms, Sindhia and Bhonsle had already been checked). In the Deccan theatre, Arthur Wellesley (the future Duke of Wellington) defeated the combined Sindhia-Bhonsle forces at **Assaye (September 1803)** and again at **Argaon (November 1803)**. In the northern theatre, Lord Lake defeated Sindhia's forces at **Laswari (1 November 1803)** and occupied Delhi and Agra, bringing the nominally reigning Mughal emperor under Company protection as a pensioner. Sindhia and Bhonsle were each compelled to sue for peace, ceding territory, admitting British Residents and agreeing not to employ Europeans without British approval -- becoming subsidiary allies in the same structural sense as the Peshwa after Bassein.

FACT: Wellesley then turned to Holkar, but Yeshwant Rao Holkar, using mobile Maratha cavalry tactics and allied with the Raja of Bharatpur, fought Company forces to a standstill through 1804-05 and inflicted heavy losses on Lord Lake, including a failed attempt to storm Bharatpur's fort. Company financial strain from sustained warfare (Company debt reportedly nearly doubled between 1797 and 1806) and renewed concern over Napoleon in Europe led the Court of Directors to recall Wellesley; peace with Holkar was concluded by the **Treaty of Rajghat (1805/06)**, restoring much of his territory. ANALYSIS: the correct comparative point for an answer on this war is that the Company achieved decisive victories over Sindhia and Bhonsle specifically because it could concentrate superior artillery and disciplined infantry against forces it fought one at a time, while Holkar's continued resistance shows the limits of this advantage against a still-mobile, still-undefeated Maratha force -- reinforcing, rather than contradicting, the contingency argument of subtopic 2.



Visual 10: Second Anglo-Maratha War, 1803-05 -- Assaye, Laswari, Delhi, and Holkar's resistance

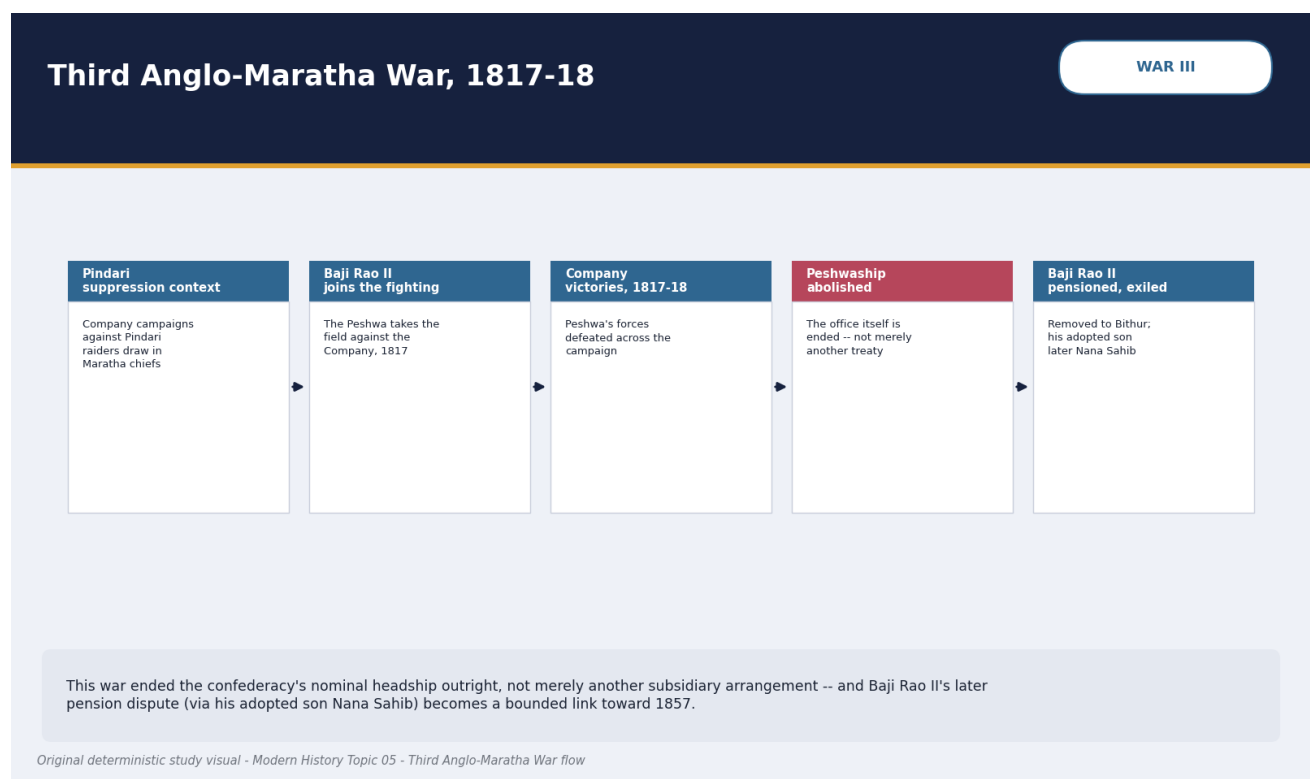
Visual 10: Second Anglo-Maratha War, 1803-05 -- Assaye, Laswari, Delhi, and Holkar's resistance. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

13. Third Anglo-Maratha War: Pindaris, 1817-18, Baji Rao II, and the end of the Peshwaship

FACT: Cornwallis's recall of Wellesley in 1805 brought a non-intervention policy that allowed Holkar and Sindhia to recover some strength, while their irregular light cavalry auxiliaries, the **Pindaris**, increasingly plundered Malwa and neighbouring territories largely outside any state's direct control -- a growing law-and-order and revenue problem that the Company itself later cited as a justification for renewed intervention. Lord Hastings, arriving as Governor-General in 1813, articulated the explicit doctrine of **paramountcy** (subtopic 1): that the Company's own security interests entitled it to act against any Indian power, allied or not, that it judged a threat. Peshwa Baji Rao II, chafing under the rigid supervision of the British Resident at Poona since Bassein, made a final attempt to rally the Maratha chiefs and attacked the British Residency at Poona in November 1817; Appa Sahib of Nagpur (Bhonsle) attacked the Nagpur Residency, and Holkar's forces also prepared for war.

FACT: Hastings responded decisively: he compelled Sindhia to accept British suzerainty without fighting, and defeated the Peshwa's, Bhonsle's and Holkar's forces in a campaign fought through 1817-18, with mopping-up operations against scattered Pindari and Maratha remnants continuing into 1819. Baji Rao II was deposed and pensioned at Bithur, near Kanpur -- the **Peshwaship was abolished outright**, never to be restored. His territories were annexed, forming the basis of an enlarged Bombay Presidency; a small titular kingdom of Satara was carved out and given to a descendant of Chhatrapati Shivaji as a symbolic gesture, ruled as a complete Company dependent (Satara later became a Doctrine of Lapse case in 1848, examined in Part VII). Holkar and Bhonsle accepted subsidiary terms and ceded further territory.

ANALYSIS: the Third Anglo-Maratha War completes the fragmentation trajectory begun at Bassein: the First War (1775-82) produced a genuinely negotiated peace between roughly comparable powers; by the Second War (1803-05) the Company could isolate and defeat individual Maratha houses in sequence; by the Third War (1817-18) there was no unified Maratha command left to face at all, only a set of separately defeated chiefs and an abolished Peshwaship. By 1818 the Company held paramountcy over virtually the entire subcontinent excepting the Punjab and Sindh -- the two fronts examined in Parts V and VI.



Visual 11: Third Anglo-Maratha War, 1817-18 -- Pindaris, the end of the Peshwaship, and Baji Rao II's pensioning

Visual 11: Third Anglo-Maratha War, 1817-18 -- Pindaris, the end of the Peshwaship, and Baji Rao II's pensioning. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

PART IV - THE SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE SYSTEM

14. Precedents and Wellesley's systematisation: the exact core clauses

FACT: the practice of stationing a Company-paid force alongside an allied Indian ruler was not itself Wellesley's invention -- the technique had precedents in earlier Company arrangements and in comparable French subsidiary practice on the Indian subcontinent earlier in the eighteenth century. What Wellesley did, from his arrival as Governor-General in 1798, was give this older practice a **systematic, aggressive and near-universal application**, using it explicitly as his primary instrument (alongside outright war and the assumption of previously subordinated territories) for subordinating Indian states to Company paramourty.

FACT: the Subsidiary Alliance's core clauses, consistent across every case examined in subtopic 15, were: (1) the allied ruler accepted the permanent stationing of a British force within his own territory; (2) the ruler paid for this force's maintenance, either through a cash subsidy or by ceding revenue-yielding territory in lieu of cash; (3) the ruler accepted a British Resident at his court; (4) the ruler could not employ any European in his service without British approval; (5) the ruler could not negotiate, make war, or maintain independent diplomatic relations with any other Indian state without consulting the Governor-General; and (6) in return, the Company undertook to defend the ruler from external and internal enemies and promised, at least formally, non-interference in the state's internal administration -- a promise the historical record shows was seldom honoured in practice.

ANALYSIS: reading these six clauses together shows precisely why contemporaries and later historians alike judged the system so corrosive of genuine sovereignty: clauses (1)-(2) removed financial and military self-sufficiency; clauses (3)-(5) removed diplomatic and administrative independence; and clause (6)'s protection promise, rather than compensating for these losses, is what made the loss politically survivable for the ruler in the short term while entrenching Company control in the long term. A single British commentator of the period is recorded (via Bipan Chandra) as describing the system memorably as "a system of fattening allies as we fatten oxen, till they were worthy of being devoured" -- a vivid contemporary characterisation of the dependency-to-annexation trajectory, quoted here as a period reflection rather than as this package's own analytical claim.

Subsidiary Alliance: six clauses, what each removed

CORE CLAUSES

Clause	What it removed
Permanent subsidiary force	Independent capacity for self-defence
Resident at court	Independent day-to-day governance discretion
Ban on independent diplomacy	External relations and alliance choices
No European employment without Company approval	Independent access to rival military expertise
Cash subsidy OR territorial cession	Fiscal surplus or the ceded territory's revenue base
Nominal protection guarantee	Little practical value; masked deepening dependency

Case sequence: Hyderabad 1798 (enlarged 1800) -> Mysore 1799 (post-conquest) -> Awadh 1801 (territorial cession) -> Bassein/Peshwa 1802 (alone triggered a further war).

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Subsidiary Alliance sovereignty erosion

Visual 12: Subsidiary Alliance -- the six core clauses and what each removed

Visual 12: Subsidiary Alliance -- the six core clauses and what each removed. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

15. The case sequence: Hyderabad 1798, Mysore 1799, Awadh 1801, Bassein 1802 and after

FACT: Wellesley signed his first Subsidiary Treaty with the **Nizam of Hyderabad in 1798**, requiring the Nizam to dismiss his French-trained troops and maintain a subsidiary force at his own cost, in return for Company protection against Maratha encroachment; a further 1800 treaty enlarged this subsidiary force and converted part of the payment from cash to a territorial cession. **Mysore's restored Wodeyar ruler accepted subsidiary terms in 1799** immediately after Seringapatam's fall (subtopic 8), with the added clause that the Governor-General could assume the state's administration outright if judged necessary. The **Nawab of Awadh was forced to accept a Subsidiary Treaty in 1801**, surrendering roughly half his kingdom (including Rohilkhand and the Doab territory between the Ganga and the Yamuna) in place of an enlarged cash subsidy, alongside acceptance of British "advice" on internal administration and reorganisation of his own police and army under British direction; this 1801 settlement built on an existing subsidiary arrangement already in place at Awadh since 1801's predecessor arrangements under Warren Hastings and Wellesley's own brother Henry, and left the Nawab's authority hollow even within the reduced territory he retained. **Peshwa Baji Rao II accepted the Treaty of Bassein in 1802** (subtopic 11), followed by Sindhia's and Bhonsle's own subsidiary submissions after the Second Anglo-Maratha War (subtopic 12).

FACT: Wellesley dealt still more directly with several smaller states: the Nawab of the Carnatic was compelled in 1801 to cede his kingdom outright to the Company in exchange for a pension (rather than accepting a subsidiary arrangement), and the rulers of Tanjore and Surat were similarly pensioned off and their territories absorbed -- together with Mysore's ceded Malabar territory, these annexed areas formed the enlarged Madras Presidency that lasted until 1947. ANALYSIS: the correct sequencing to hold in memory for Prelims-style questions is: **Hyderabad first, 1798; Mysore, 1799**, immediately after conquest; **Awadh, 1801; the Peshwa via Bassein, 1802**, followed by Sindhia and Bhonsle after 1803 -- a chronological spread across barely five years that converted every major regional power except the still-independent Marathas' remaining resistance (ended only by 1818) and the still-unconquered Sikh and Sindh fronts (Parts V-VI) into Company dependents.

Subsidiary Alliance: six clauses, what each removed		CORE CLAUSES
Clause	What it removed	
Permanent subsidiary force	Independent capacity for self-defence	
Resident at court	Independent day-to-day governance discretion	
Ban on independent diplomacy	External relations and alliance choices	
No European employment without Company approval	Independent access to rival military expertise	
Cash subsidy OR territorial cession	Fiscal surplus or the ceded territory's revenue base	
Nominal protection guarantee	Little practical value; masked deepening dependency	
Case sequence: Hyderabad 1798 (enlarged 1800) -> Mysore 1799 (post-conquest) -> Awadh 1801 (territorial cession) -> Bassein/Peshwa 1802 (alone triggered a further war).		
Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Subsidiary Alliance sovereignty erosion		

Visual 13: the Subsidiary Alliance case sequence, 1798-1803 -- Hyderabad, Mysore, Awadh, Bassein

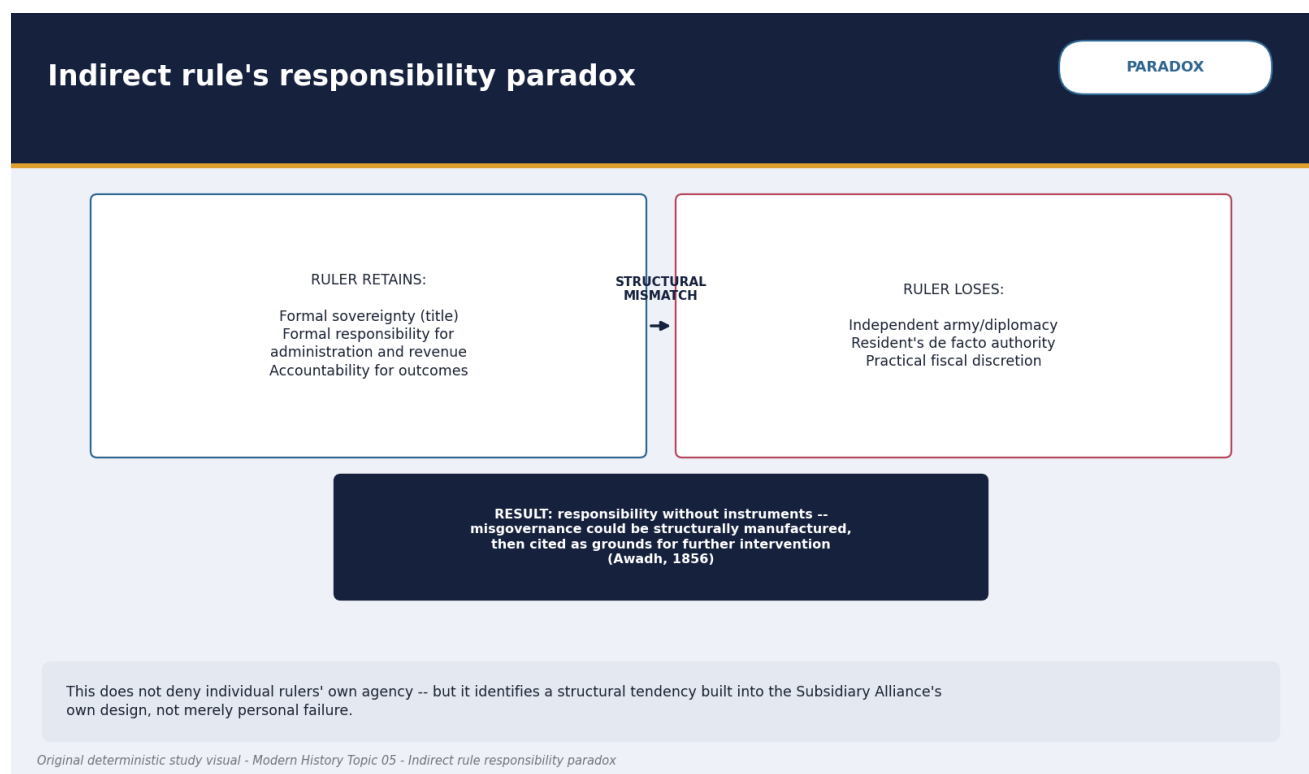
Visual 13: the Subsidiary Alliance case sequence, 1798-1803 -- Hyderabad, Mysore, Awadh, Bassein. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

16. Sovereignty eroded: dependency, the Resident, and the responsibility paradox

FACT: in practical effect, a state that signed a Subsidiary Alliance lost the right of independent self-defence, of conducting its own diplomacy, of freely employing foreign experts, and of settling disputes with neighbouring states on its own authority -- it retained nominal sovereignty and internal administrative form, while external sovereignty passed, in substance, to the Company. The British Resident at each subsidiary court increasingly interfered in day-to-day internal administration despite the formal non-interference promise, and the cost of maintaining the subsidiary force -- arbitrarily fixed and, by several contemporary and later accounts, disproportionate to the state's real paying capacity -- routinely strained the host state's finances and, in the process, impoverished its subjects through additional taxation. **FACT:** the system also caused the disbandment of the protected states' own armies, since a fully staffed subsidiary force made an independent army both unaffordable and, from the Company's perspective, undesirable; this released large numbers of unemployed soldiers and officers into the countryside, a portion of whom are recorded as having joined the roving Pindari bands examined in subtopic 13.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this is the point at which the task's "indirect rule and responsibility paradox" must be named explicitly and precisely. The Subsidiary Alliance left the ruler formally responsible for his state's governance and reputation -- he remained the nominal sovereign whom subjects, and later British officials themselves, held answerable for administrative outcomes -- while removing from him the actual instruments (army, treasury, foreign relations, and increasingly, effective control over his own court) needed to govern well or resist Resident interference. The paradox therefore runs precisely as follows: the Company created the conditions for administrative drift or decline (through fiscal strain, disbanded armies and Resident encroachment on real authority) and then, in case after case examined across this package (most starkly Awadh in 1856, Part VII), used the resulting misgovernance as its own justification for further intervention or outright annexation -- responsibility without power, followed by annexation for the failure of power the ruler was never permitted to exercise.

FACT: a clear conceptual distinction must be held here: a **cash subsidy** was a direct annual cash payment for the maintenance of the stationed force, while a **territorial cession** transferred revenue-yielding land to the Company in lieu of, or in partial substitution for, that cash payment (as happened with the Nizam's second 1800 treaty and with Awadh's 1801 settlement) -- both routes achieved the same underlying dependency, but a territorial cession additionally and permanently reduced the state's own resource base, making future recovery of any independent capacity progressively less possible. **ANALYSIS:** this distinction is one of the most commonly tested precision points in Subsidiary Alliance questions (including, potentially, the 2018 Prelims item examined in Part IX), and a careful answer should identify, for any named case, whether the Company was paid in cash or in land.



Visual 14: indirect rule's responsibility paradox -- power removed, responsibility retained

PART V - SINDH: A BOUNDED FRONTIER CASE

17. Sindh: commercial and strategic context, and Napier's 1843 annexation

FACT: Sindh, ruled by a confederation of Talpur Amirs (at Hyderabad, Khairpur and Mirpur), first drew sustained Company attention for **commercial and strategic**, rather than revenue, reasons: the Indus river offered a potential trade artery into central Asia and the Punjab, and growing British anxiety over Russian and Persian influence approaching Afghanistan (the wider "Great Game" context) made control of the Indus route and the north-western approaches to India a strategic priority from the 1830s. An 1832 commercial treaty opened the Indus and Sindh's roads to Company trade; further arrangements tied to the First Afghan War (1838-42) brought British troops into Sindh and, in 1839, imposed a Subsidiary Treaty on the Amirs, including a subsidiary force stationed at their expense -- placing Sindh, structurally, within the same dependency logic examined in Part IV even before its outright annexation.

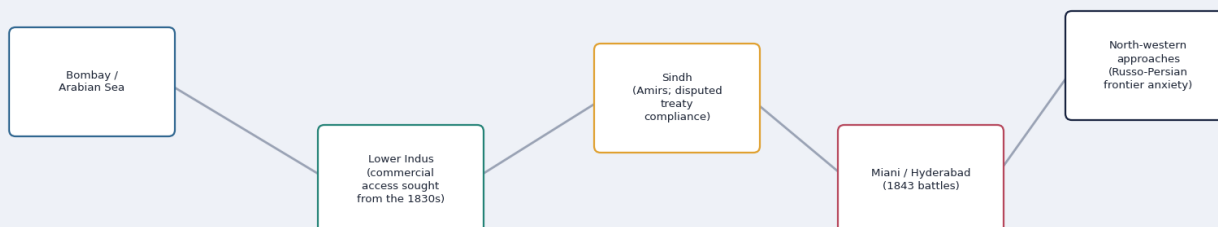
FACT: after the Company's costly and difficult First Afghan War, the Governor-General Lord Ellenborough sought a fresh, harsher treaty from the Amirs (1842-43) that would have further curtailed their authority and ceded additional territory; the immediate pretext for war came when an attack on the British Residency at Hyderabad (Sindh) by forces of some Amirs followed the tension surrounding this new treaty's imposition. Major-General **Charles Napier** defeated the Amirs' forces at the **Battle of Miani (17 February 1843)** and again at the **Battle of Dabo/Hyderabad (24 March 1843)**, after which Sindh was **annexed outright in 1843**.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: Napier's own private diary is recorded (via Bipan Chandra) as candidly admitting the annexation's dubious legal and moral basis: "We have no right to seize Sind, yet we shall do so, and a very advantageous, useful humane piece of rascality it will be." This package uses only this attested diary entry; the popular story that Napier telegraphed the single Latin word "Peccavi" ("I have sinned" -- a pun on "I have Sindh") is a widely repeated but historically unverified anecdote and is deliberately **excluded** here as unconfirmed. The exam-ready reading of Sindh is that it was annexed principally for **strategic and commercial control of the Indus frontier** approaching Afghanistan, using a manufactured treaty grievance as proximate pretext -- a pattern of outright annexation distinct from both the Subsidiary Alliance route (Part IV) and Dalhousie's later Doctrine of Lapse (Part VII), since Sindh involved neither a subsidiary treaty's gradual dependency nor a disputed adoption, but direct conquest of a frontier territory judged strategically indispensable.

Sindh: frontier logic and Napier's 1843 annexation

FRONTIER CASE

ILLUSTRATIVE ROUTE SKETCH -- NOT TO SCALE, NOT A SURVEYED MAP



Commercial and strategic frontier logic, not religious or cultural motive, drove annexation; sources verified for this package exclude anecdotal material such as the unverified 'Peccavi' pun.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Sindh frontier route map

Visual 15: Sindh's frontier logic, 1832-1843 -- from Indus trade treaty to Napier's annexation

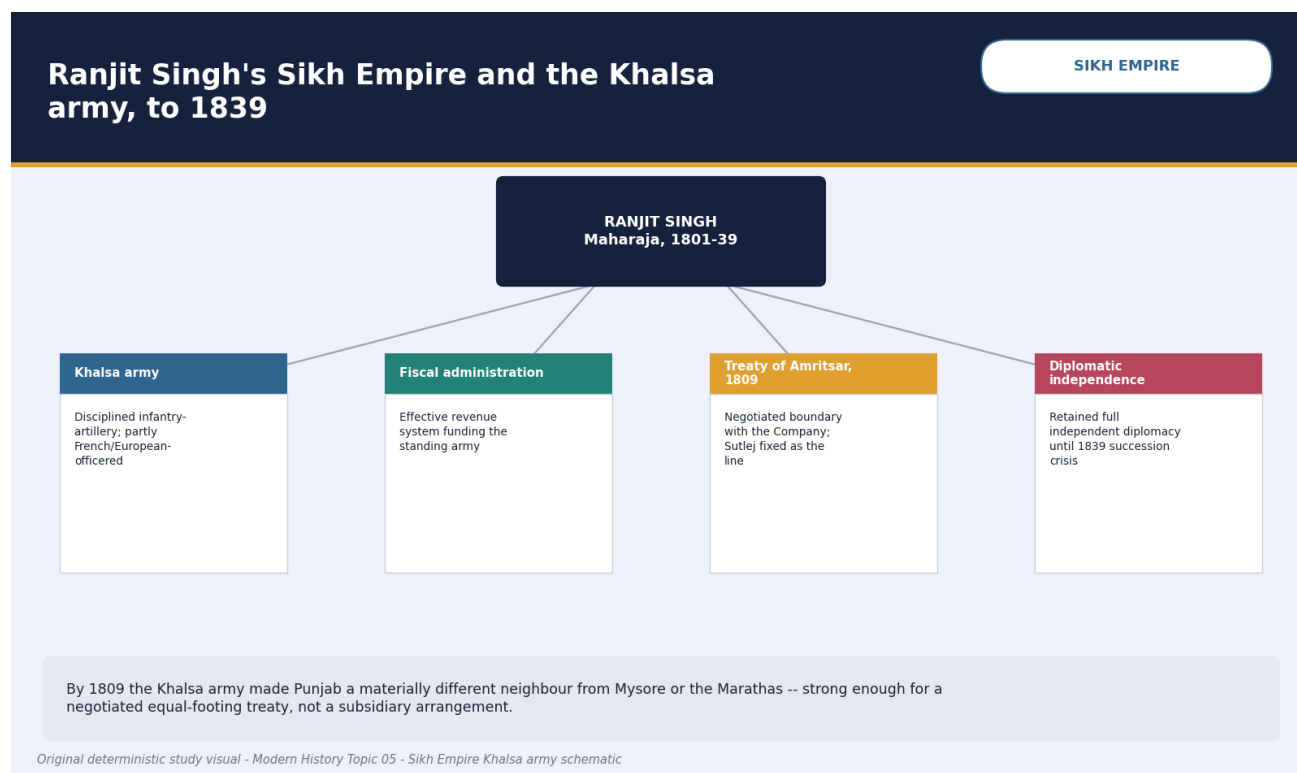
Visual 15: Sindh's frontier logic, 1832-1843 -- from Indus trade treaty to Napier's annexation. This is a schematic route diagram and is explicitly NOT TO SCALE.

PART VI - THE SIKH EMPIRE AND THE ANGLO-SIKH WARS

18. Ranjit Singh's state, the Khalsa army, and the Treaty of Amritsar, 1809

FACT: Ranjit Singh unified the fractious Sikh misls (confederate bands) of the Punjab from 1799 (when he took Lahore) into a single, centralised kingdom, eventually extending his authority from the Sutlej to the Khyber Pass and into Kashmir. His **Khalsa army** was distinctive for its scale and its systematic modernisation: infantry and artillery were reorganised and drilled on European lines with the help of French, Italian and other European officers he recruited (including Jean-François Allard and Jean-Baptiste Ventura), giving Punjab, by Ranjit Singh's death, one of the most professionally organised and best-equipped standing armies among contemporary Indian states, with a large artillery park cast in state-controlled foundries.

FACT: the Company's relationship with Ranjit Singh was fixed by the **Treaty of Amritsar (1809)**, concluded after Lord Minto's envoy Charles Metcalfe negotiated with Ranjit Singh amid British anxiety over a possible Napoleonic threat approaching India via Persia and Afghanistan. The treaty recognised Ranjit Singh's sovereignty over his territories north and west of the **Sutlej river**, while the Sikh cis-Sutlej chiefs to the south and east of that river came under Company protection; Ranjit Singh, in return, abandoned any further expansion south of the Sutlej. ANALYSIS: Amritsar 1809 is the clearest example in this entire package of the Company treating a strong, well-organised Indian state as a genuine equal, negotiated boundary partner rather than as a Subsidiary Alliance dependency -- a direct illustration of the contingency argument (subtopic 2): the Company adapted its approach to the real correlation of forces on each frontier, choosing negotiated coexistence with a militarily formidable Ranjit Singh in 1809 while choosing conquest, alliance-dependency or annexation elsewhere depending on relative strength and opportunity. **Ranjit Singh himself never fought the Company** -- he died on 27 June 1839, a full six years before the first Anglo-Sikh war began, and this distinction is a frequently tested precision point.



Visual 16: Ranjit Singh's Sikh Empire and the Khalsa army, to 1839

Visual 16: Ranjit Singh's Sikh Empire and the Khalsa army, to 1839. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

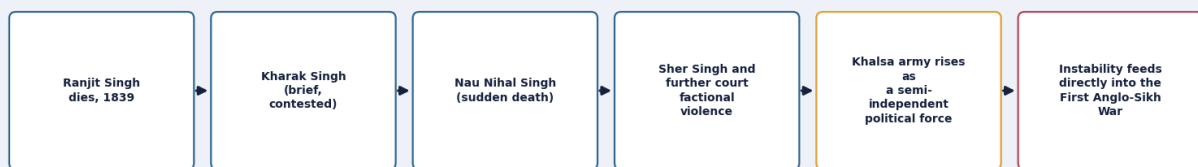
19. Post-1839 succession crisis: factional instability after Ranjit Singh

FACT: Ranjit Singh's death in June 1839 was followed by rapid, destabilising successions -- his son Kharak Singh (died 1840), grandson Nau Nihal Singh (died the same day as his father's funeral procession, 1840), and a succession of further short reigns amid intense factional rivalry among Sikh sardars (notably the Sandhawalia and Dogra factions) and increasingly assertive intervention by the Khalsa army's own regimental councils (panchayats), which had begun acting as an independent political force in the court's absence of settled authority. By 1843 the child Maharaja Duleep Singh (Ranjit Singh's youngest son) occupied the throne under his mother Rani Jindan Kaur's regency, with real power contested between the durbar's court factions and the increasingly assertive, semi-autonomous Khalsa army.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this rapid factional collapse -- five rulers in scarcely six years, following one long, stable reign -- is the essential precondition for the First Anglo-Sikh War, in the same structural sense that Nana Phadnis's 1800 death and the subsequent succession feuding preconditioned the Marathas' fragmentation before Bassein (subtopic 11): a previously formidable, unified state lost its unifying leadership and fell into internal rivalry precisely at the moment the Company's frontier interest in the Punjab was intensifying (partly driven by the Company's own difficult First Afghan War experience, 1838-42, which had already brought British forces close to Punjab's borders).

Post-Ranjit Singh instability, 1839-45

SUCCESSION CRISIS



Ranjit Singh did NOT fight the Anglo-Sikh Wars -- he died in 1839, years before either war began; the British did not create this instability but subsequently exploited it.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Post-Ranjit instability chain

Visual 17: post-Ranjit Singh instability, 1839-45 -- five rulers, factional collapse, and the Khalsa army's rise as an independent force

Visual 17: post-Ranjit Singh instability, 1839-45 -- five rulers, factional collapse, and the Khalsa army's rise as an independent force. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

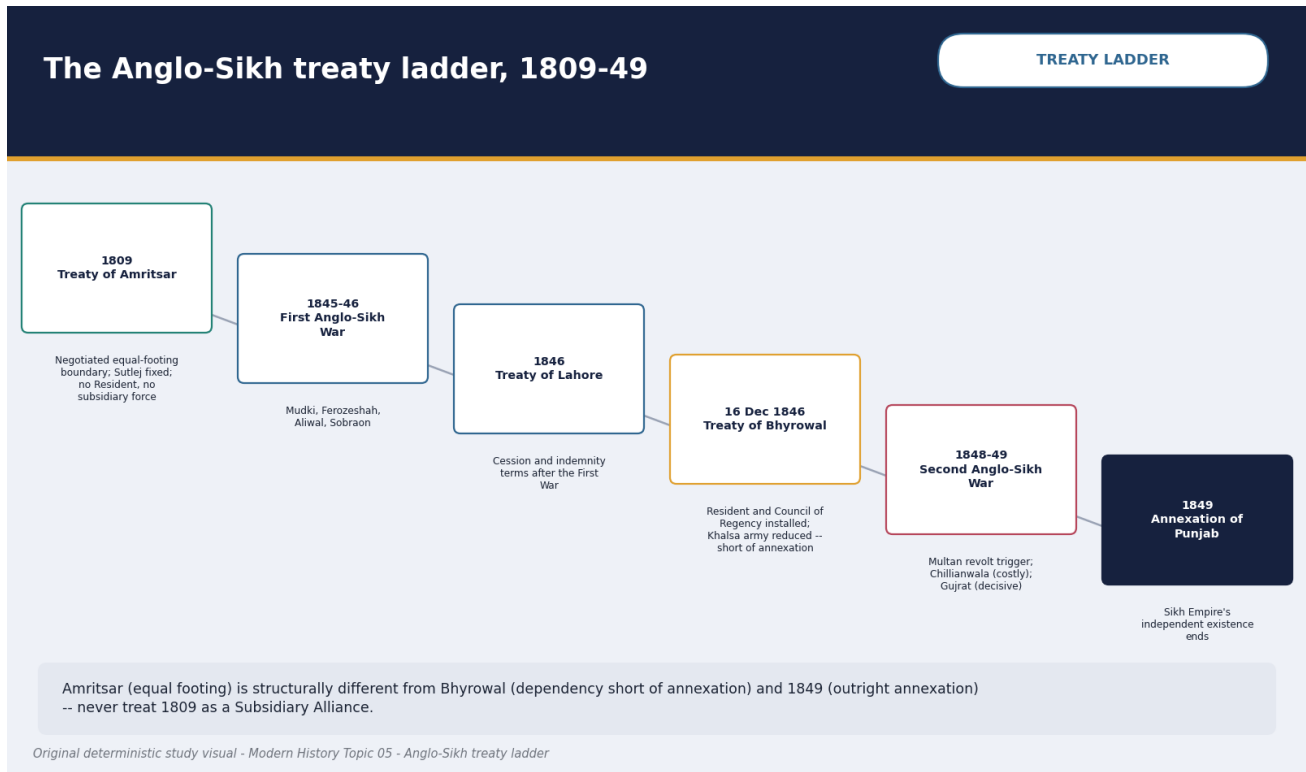
20. First Anglo-Sikh War: Mudki to Sobraon, Lahore, and Bhyrowal

FACT: rising mutual suspicion -- the Company's build-up of forces on the Sutlej frontier following the Afghan war, and the Khalsa army's own increasingly independent political assertiveness at Lahore -- led the Khalsa army to cross the Sutlej in December 1845, precipitating the **First Anglo-Sikh War**. Four major battles followed at supported precision: **Mudki (18 December 1845)**, **Ferozeshah (21-22 December 1845)**, **Aliwal (28 January 1846)** and **Sobraon (10 February 1846)** -- each a hard-fought Company victory, with Sobraon effectively deciding the war by breaking the last organised Khalsa resistance on the Sutlej's southern bank.

FACT: the **Treaty of Lahore (8-9 March 1846)** followed: the Sikh state ceded the Jullundur Doab (territory between the Sutlej and Beas rivers) and Kashmir (the latter separately sold soon after to Gulab Singh of Jammu for a fixed sum, creating the princely state of Jammu and Kashmir under British paramountcy), paid a war indemnity, agreed to reduce the Khalsa army's size, and accepted a British Resident at Lahore together with a British force stationed there temporarily. Continuing instability at the Lahore durbar led to a further settlement, the **Treaty of Bhyrowal (16**

December 1846), under which a Council of Regency was established at Lahore under British supervision, with **Henry Lawrence** as Resident holding effectively decisive authority during Duleep Singh's minority, and a British garrison stationed at Lahore at the durbar's expense -- placing the Sikh state, in substance, under a Subsidiary-Alliance-like dependency without the Company yet annexing it outright.

ANALYSIS: the Lahore-to-Bhyrowal sequence shows the Company applying, on the Sikh frontier in 1846, essentially the same dependency logic examined in Part IV (Resident control, a maintained British force, loss of independent military capacity) rather than immediate annexation -- a further illustration that the Company's choice of instrument (negotiated boundary treaty in 1809, dependency-Residency in 1846, outright annexation in 1849) tracked the relative military and political balance at each specific moment, not a fixed British programme applied identically everywhere.



Visual 18: the Anglo-Sikh treaty ladder -- Amritsar 1809 to Lahore/Bhyrowal 1846 to annexation 1849

Visual 18: the Anglo-Sikh treaty ladder -- Amritsar 1809 to Lahore/Bhyrowal 1846 to annexation 1849. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

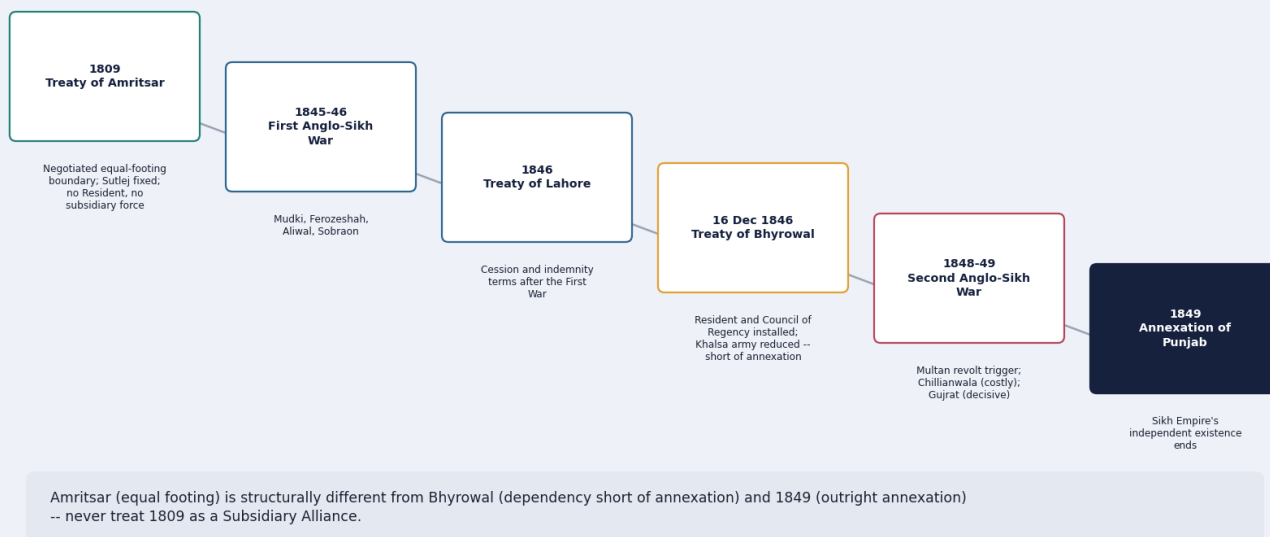
21. Second Anglo-Sikh War: the Multan trigger, Chillianwala, Gujrat, and 1849 annexation

FACT: the **Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848-49)** began with a rebellion at **Multan**, where the local governor **Diwan Mulraj**, resisting Company revenue and administrative demands, killed two British officers sent to oversee the province's transfer, sparking a wider rising that drew in Sikh sardars disaffected with the Bhyrowal settlement's constraints. Company and allied forces besieged Multan while a separate field campaign confronted the main Khalsa forces: the **Battle of Ramnagar (22 November 1848)** was an inconclusive early clash; the **Battle of Chillianwala (13 January 1849)** was exceptionally hard-fought and costly for the Company, with the outcome disputed enough at the time that it was not treated as a clear British victory; the decisive engagement came at the **Battle of Gujrat (21 February 1849)**, where superior Company artillery broke the Khalsa army's remaining organised resistance.

FACT: the Punjab was **formally annexed on 29 March 1849**; the young Maharaja Duleep Singh was pensioned and sent to England, and the Khalsa army was disbanded outright. ANALYSIS: the Second Anglo-Sikh War's proximate trigger (a provincial governor's revolt at Multan against encroaching Company administrative control) reads, in miniature, as a preview of exactly the kind of dispossession and resentment examined at wider scale in Part VIII's bridge to 1857: a local authority stripped of real administrative discretion by encroaching British control chose armed resistance once negotiation and accommodation seemed to offer no further protection -- reinforcing this package's central point that Company expansion proceeded through a repeated interplay of dependency, encroachment, resistance and annexation, not through any single mechanism applied uniformly across every frontier.

The Anglo-Sikh treaty ladder, 1809-49

TREATY LADDER



Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Anglo-Sikh treaty ladder

Visual 19: Second Anglo-Sikh War, 1848-49 -- Multan, Chillianwala, Gujrat, and the annexation of Punjab

Visual 19: Second Anglo-Sikh War, 1848-49 -- Multan, Chillianwala, Gujrat, and the annexation of Punjab. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

PART VII - DALHOUSIE, THE DOCTRINE OF LAPSE, AND AWADH

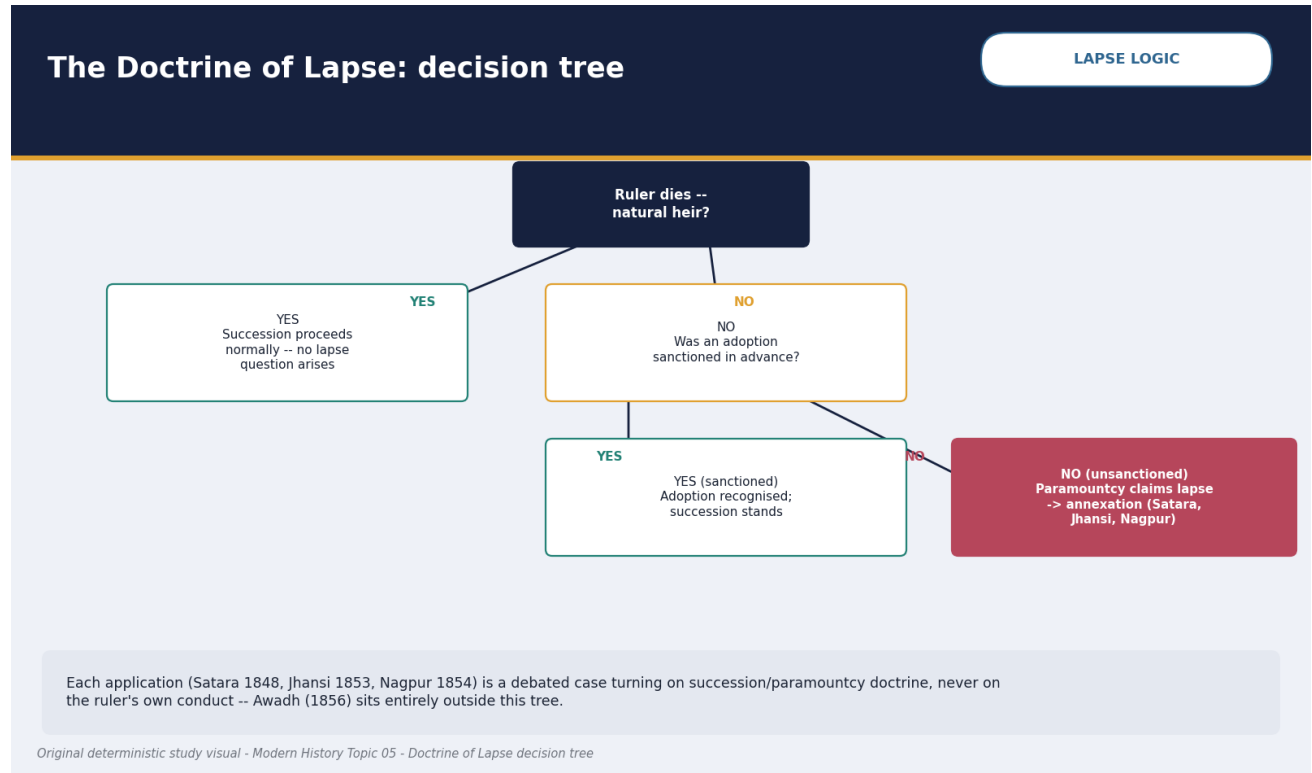
22. The Doctrine of Lapse: principles, paramountcy, and the verified cases

FACT: Lord Dalhousie, Governor-General from 1848 to 1856, articulated the **Doctrine of Lapse** as an extension of the paramountcy principle already asserted by Lord Hastings (subtopic 13): where a dependent or protected Indian state's ruler died without a **natural (biological) male heir**, Dalhousie held that the Company, as paramount power, could refuse to recognise an adopted heir and instead annex the state outright, on the reasoning that such states existed only by British sufferance and had no independent right to perpetuate themselves through adoption without British sanction. This was a marked hardening of the earlier, more permissive Company practice (under Hastings and others) of generally recognising adoptions in subordinate states unless a specific treaty clause forbade it.

FACT: the clearest, best-attested cases of Lapse annexation under Dalhousie are: **Satara (1848)**, the first case, where the Raja's adopted heir was not recognised; **Jaitpur and Sambalpur (1849)**; further minor Central Indian and hill states including **Udaipur (Chhattisgarh, distinct from the Rajputana Udaipur)** and **Baghat** in the years around 1849-52; **Nagpur (1853-54)**, where Raghuji III's death without a recognised adopted heir led to annexation and the state's considerable treasury and jewels being appropriated; and **Jhansi (1853-54)**, where Raja Gangadhar Rao's adoption of Damodar Rao shortly before his own death in November 1853 was refused recognition, and the state was annexed -- a decision Rani Lakshmibai contested and that fed directly into her role in the 1857 rising (Part VIII).
ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this package deliberately does **not** extend the Lapse list further into contested or poorly attested "universal" enumerations found in some popular accounts; only the above, well-corroborated cases are asserted here, consistent with the no-fabrication constraint.

FACT: Dalhousie separately distinguished, in a related but conceptually distinct family of decisions, **title and pension questions** from territorial Lapse proper: when former Peshwa Baji Rao II died at Bithur in 1851, Dalhousie refused to continue his personal pension and title to his adopted son, **Nana Sahib** (Dhondu Pant) -- this was a denial of a personal pension/title succession, not a territorial annexation (Baji Rao II's Peshwaship had already been abolished in 1818, subtopic 13), and Nana Sahib's resulting grievance is examined as a bounded link in Part VIII. ANALYSIS:

keeping the territorial-Lapse cases (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi and the smaller states) analytically separate from title/pension denials (Nana Sahib) is essential precision: both fed resentment toward Company paramountcy, but only the former involved the Doctrine of Lapse as a territorial-annexation instrument in the strict sense.



Visual 20: the Doctrine of Lapse decision tree -- natural heir, adoption, and annexation

Visual 20: the Doctrine of Lapse decision tree -- natural heir, adoption, and annexation. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

Annexation matrix, 1848-56

ANNEXATIONS

State	Year	Mechanism	Key distinguishing note
Satara	1848	Doctrine of Lapse	No natural heir; adoption not pre-sanctioned
Jhansi	1853	Doctrine of Lapse	Rani's adoption of a successor rejected
Nagpur	1854	Doctrine of Lapse	Succession vacancy; paramountcy claim applied
Punjab	1849	War (Second Anglo-Sikh War)	Outright conquest, not succession-based
Awadh	1856	Misgovernance (NOT Lapse)	Living, heirred Nawab; no succession vacancy at all

Title and pension issues are differentiated case by case (for example, Nana Sahib's denied pension continuation after Baji Rao II's adopted son was refused recognition) -- avoid any dubious universal 'annexed states' list.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Annexation matrix

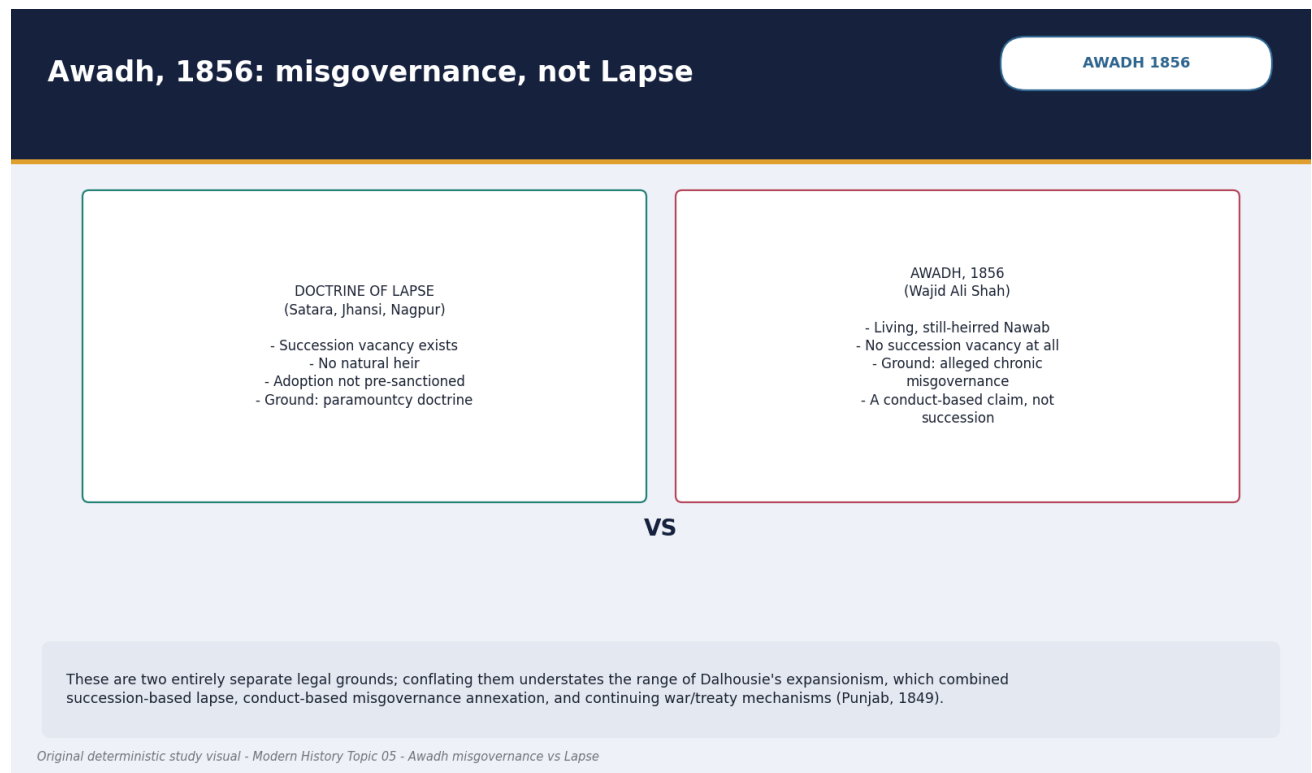
Visual 21: annexation matrix, 1848-56 -- Lapse cases, title/pension cases, and Awadh compared

Visual 21: annexation matrix, 1848-56 -- Lapse cases, title/pension cases, and Awadh compared. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

23. Awadh, 1856: misgovernance, explicitly NOT Lapse

FACT: the **annexation of Awadh in February 1856** is a distinct case that this package deliberately separates from the Doctrine of Lapse. Awadh's Nawab, **Wajid Ali Shah**, was alive and had heirs; there was no succession dispute or adoption question at all. Dalhousie's own officer, Governor-General's agent James Outram, prepared a report alleging chronic administrative misrule, judicial corruption and fiscal disorder at Lucknow, and on this basis of **alleged internal misgovernance** -- not any lapse of succession -- the Company annexed Awadh outright, deposing Wajid Ali Shah and pensioning him.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this distinction is one of the most important precision points in the entire package and must not be blurred: Awadh already stood in a Subsidiary Alliance relationship since 1801 (Part IV, subtopic 15), so its annexation is best read as the logical, if unusually blunt, end point of the **indirect-rule responsibility paradox** examined in subtopic 16 -- a state whose ruler had long been stripped of his own army, independent finances and diplomatic capacity by the very Subsidiary Alliance the Company had imposed, was then judged and annexed for misgoverning within the residual authority he had been left. Awadh's annexation, coming barely a year before 1857 and affecting a large, densely populated and militarily significant recruiting ground for the Company's own Bengal Army sepoys, is widely treated by historians as one of the most immediately inflammatory single acts feeding directly into the events of 1857 (bounded bridge, Part VIII) -- but it must be labelled correctly on its own terms as a **misgovernance annexation**, structurally and legally separate from the Doctrine of Lapse cases of subtopic 22.



Visual 22: Awadh 1856 -- misgovernance annexation compared against true Lapse cases

Visual 22: Awadh 1856 -- misgovernance annexation compared against true Lapse cases. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

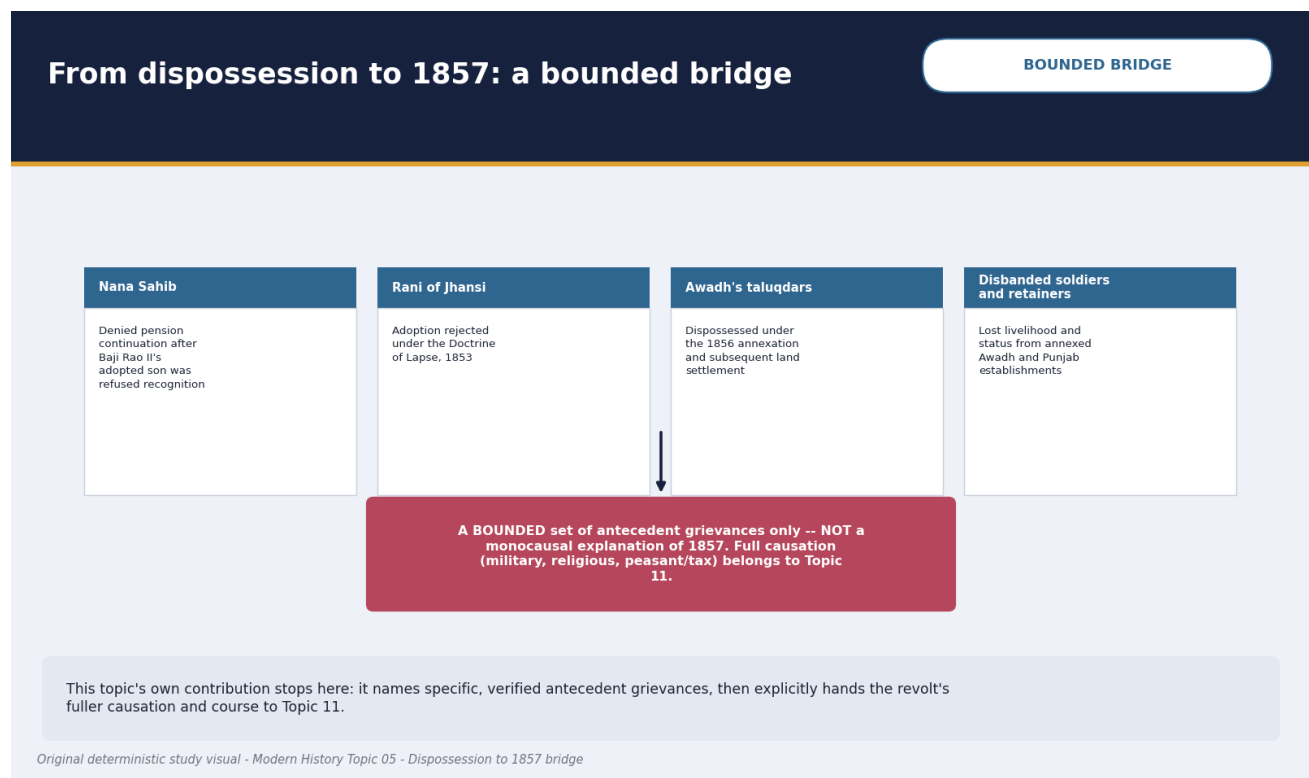
PART VIII - BRIDGE TO 1857, HISTORIOGRAPHY, AND COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS

24. Dispossession and the road to 1857: a bounded bridge, not a monocausal claim

(Topic 11 owns the 1857 rising itself -- causes, spread, suppression and consequences -- in full; this subtopic states only the narrow, bounded linkage between this package's expansion story and that later event.)

FACT: by 1856, the territorial expansion traced across Parts II-VII had produced several distinct categories of dispossessed or aggrieved actors whose specific grievances are directly traceable to named episodes within this package: **Nana Sahib**, denied his adoptive father Baji Rao II's pension and title in 1851 (subtopic 22); the **Rani of Jhansi**, whose adopted son's succession was refused under Lapse in 1853-54 (subtopic 22); the **taluqdars (large landholders) of Awadh**, many of whom lost long-held estates and local authority under the land-revenue settlement the Company imposed after the 1856 annexation (subtopic 23); and substantial numbers of disbanded soldiers and unemployed officers from annexed states' former armies (subtopics 16, 21) who lost both livelihood and social standing. Awadh additionally supplied a very large proportion of the Company's own Bengal Army sepoy recruits, so its 1856 annexation directly touched the loyalties and family connections of soldiers serving within the Company's own ranks.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this package states only a **bounded, non-monocausal** linkage: these named grievances -- Nana Sahib's, the Rani of Jhansi's, the Awadh taluqdars', and disbanded soldiers' -- are well-attested antecedents that fed into the wider crisis of 1857, and figures such as Nana Sahib and the Rani of Jhansi did become prominent rebel leaders in 1857. It is incorrect, however, to claim that territorial expansion and annexation alone "caused" 1857; the rising's fuller causal picture -- military grievances (the greased cartridges controversy), religious and social anxieties, land-revenue and taxation pressures on peasants, and the specific sequence of the sepoy mutiny's spread -- belongs entirely to **Topic 11**, which this package explicitly defers to for the event itself. What this package owns and asserts is only the **supply of dispossessed actors and grievances** that expansion (as traced in Parts II-VII) fed into that wider crisis.



Visual 23: from dispossession to 1857 -- a bounded bridge (full account at Topic 11)

Visual 23: from dispossession to 1857 -- a bounded bridge (full account at Topic 11). Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

25. Historiography: four lenses on British territorial expansion

FACT: the nationalist conquest-critique lens (associated with writers in the Bipan Chandra tradition among others) reads Company expansion as a sustained project of political subjugation compounding the economic drain examined at Topic 07, emphasising broken treaty promises (Wadgaon's terms overturned, Bassein's coercive origin, Awadh's residual sovereignty stripped before its 1856 annexation), and Company contemporaries' own candid admissions of dubious legality (Napier's Sindh diary entry, subtopic 17; the "fattening allies" characterisation of the Subsidiary Alliance, subtopic 14) as direct evidence of conquest dressed in treaty language.

FACT: the fiscal-military or corporate-state lens (associated with scholarship in the tradition of P.J. Marshall and C.A. Bayly, and applied to Mysore specifically by Burton Stein's "military fiscalism" framing, subtopic 5) reads the entire contest less as a clash of "British" versus "Indian" civilisations and more as a competition between **rival fiscal-military state projects** -- Company Bengal, Tipu's Mysore, and to a lesser degree the Maratha houses and Ranjit Singh's Punjab -- each attempting to convert agrarian revenue into standing military capacity, with the Company's structurally larger and more diversified revenue base (Part I, subtopics 3-4) proving decisive over time rather than any inherent civilisational or technological gap.

FACT: the collaboration and Indian-agency lens (drawing on the broader "collaboration" historiographical tradition and Seema Alavi's specific work on sepoy recruitment) emphasises that the Company's military and administrative machine was staffed overwhelmingly by Indian soldiers, bankers, revenue officials and regional allies (subtopics 3-4, 9, 12), and that regional rulers' own alliance calculations (the Nizam and Marathas alternating sides across the Mysore wars, subtopic 6; the Gaekwad's support in the Second Maratha War, subtopic 12) were autonomous, self-interested decisions by Indian actors, not simple British manipulation of passive subjects.

FACT: the military-revolution and contingency lens (drawing on Douglas Peers's "Anglo-Indian militarism" framing and this package's own contingency argument, subtopic 2) stresses that the Company's repeated battlefield successes rested on a specific, replicable combination of disciplined infantry drill, standardised artillery, reliable logistics and credit (subtopics 3-4) that was itself contingent and reversible -- as the Company's own reverses at Wadgaon (1779), against Tipu in the Second Mysore War, and against Holkar (1804-05) demonstrate -- rather than an inevitable or predetermined outcome.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: an examiner-grade answer should be able to name at least two of these four lenses, attribute them to the correct historiographical tradition, and use them to organise evidence rather than treating "the British won because they were superior" as a sufficient explanation in itself; the strongest analytical move is combining the fiscal-military lens (explaining *capacity*) with the collaboration/agency lens (explaining *why that capacity found local partners and exploitable divisions*).

Reading expansion: four historiographical lenses

HISTORIOGRAPHY

Lens	Associated historian(s)	Core emphasis
Nationalist conquest critique	R.C. Dutt tradition; Bipan Chandra	Expansion as extractive dispossession
Fiscal-military / corporate state	Seema Alavi; P.J. Marshall	Institutional / organisational capacity as driver
Collaboration / Indian agency	C.A. Bayly	Indian bankers, sepoys, allies actively shaping outcomes
Military revolution / contingency	Douglas Peers; Burton Stein (Mysore)	Tactical-organisational edge; genuine contingency

These lenses are complementary, not competing -- fiscal capacity, institutional organisation, Indian agency and contingent outcomes can all operate simultaneously within a single case.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Historiography matrix

Visual 24: four historiographical lenses on British territorial expansion. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

26. Comparative synthesis: Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh; war vs alliance vs lapse vs misgovernance

FACT: placing the three major fronts side by side sharpens the comparative point examiners repeatedly test. **Mysore** (Part II) was defeated in a sequence of four wars fought against a single, reform-capable centralised state whose resistance ultimately failed for want of a durable regional coalition (the Marathas and Hyderabad sided with the Company in three of four wars) rather than for want of administrative or military capacity. **The Marathas** (Part III) were a structurally decentralised five-house confederacy whose resistance was progressively hollowed out less by any single battlefield defeat than by internal succession crises (1800-02) that the Company's diplomacy (Bassein) converted into sequential, separable conflicts -- ending not in a negotiated peace of equals (as in 1782) but in the outright abolition of the Peshwaship itself (1818). **The Sikh Empire** (Part VI) was, under Ranjit Singh, the one major power the Company treated as a genuine negotiating equal (Amritsar, 1809) precisely because of its demonstrated military strength; only after his death produced the same kind of succession-driven internal fragmentation seen among the Marathas did the Company move to war (1845-46) and, after a second rising, outright annexation (1849).

FACT: the instruments of subordination employed were correspondingly distinct and must not be conflated: **outright war followed by partition and a subsidiary settlement** (Mysore 1799; Punjab's path via 1846 dependency to 1849 annexation); **war followed by systematic Subsidiary Alliance dependency without immediate annexation** (the Peshwa after Bassein 1802; the Nizam from 1798; Awadh from 1801); **the Doctrine of Lapse**, applied specifically to succession-without-natural-heir cases in already-dependent or protected minor and princely states (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi); **misgovernance annexation**, applied uniquely to Awadh in 1856 on grounds of alleged internal misrule rather than succession; and **direct frontier conquest**, applied to Sindh in 1843 on primarily strategic-commercial grounds.

ANALYSIS: the single most important synthesis point for a Mains answer is that **the Company selected its instrument case by case according to the specific balance of local military strength, alliance opportunity, and existing dependency status** -- a genuinely contingent, adaptive process (subtopic 2), not a single fixed formula mechanically applied to every state encountered between 1767 and 1856.

Comparative resistance: Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh			
COMPARISON			
Dimension	Mysore	Marathas	Sikh Empire
Mechanism	War (4 rounds), conquest	Alliance (Bassein), then war	War, after treaty breakdown
Advantage exploited	Isolation via Nizam/Marathas	Succession-era rivalry	Post-1839 instability
Opponent's capacity	Genuine military-fiscal reform	Real but fragmented	Highest -- the Khalsa army
Outcome	Conquest + subsidiary control, 1799	Peshwaship abolished, 1818	Outright annexation, 1849

All three built genuine state capacity; none failed from a deficiency of will -- isolation, relative scale, and (for the Sikh case) succession-era timing explain the differing outcomes.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Comparative resistance matrix

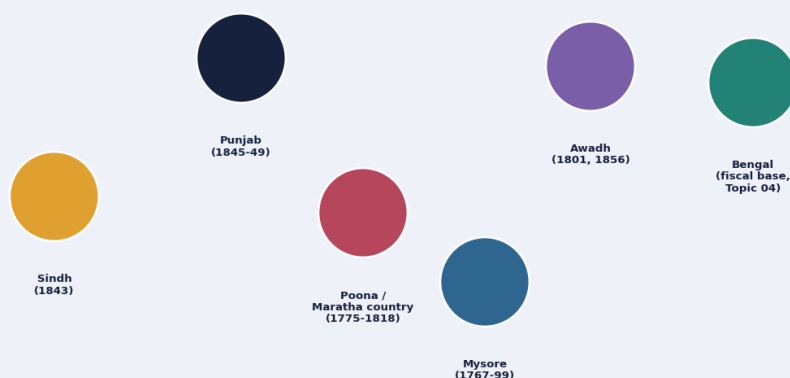
Visual 25: comparative resistance -- Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh, and the four distinct instruments of subordination

Visual 25: comparative resistance -- Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh, and the four distinct instruments of subordination. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

Major Company campaigns, 1767-1849

CAMPAIGN MAP

ILLUSTRATIVE SCHEMATIC LAYOUT ONLY -- EXPLICITLY NOT TO SCALE AND NOT GEOGRAPHICALLY ACCURATE



Node positions are schematic and relative only, chosen for legibility -- this is a study aid for remembering which campaign belongs where in broad relation to Bengal, never a substitute for an atlas.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Campaign map (illustrative, not to scale)

Visual 26: campaign map of major Company campaigns, 1767-1849 (illustrative locations only)

Visual 26: campaign map of major Company campaigns, 1767-1849. This is a schematic, illustrative location map and is explicitly NOT TO SCALE.

PART IX - SOURCES, PYQ AUDIT AND PRACTICE

Transparent PYQ audit and route decision

Audit scope: every Prelims and Mains GS-I/GS-II/Essay routing ledger and integration-audit file currently in the repository, covering 2018 through 2026, was checked line by line for any question mentioning Haidar Ali, Tipu Sultan, the Anglo-Mysore Wars, the Maratha confederacy or Anglo-Maratha Wars, the Treaty of Bassein, the Subsidiary Alliance, Sindh or Napier, Ranjit Singh, the Khalsa army, the Anglo-Sikh Wars, Dalhousie, the Doctrine of Lapse, or the 1856 annexation of Awadh.

Audit result: this topic **owns exactly two verified, directly routed PYQs** across the entire 2018-2026 window, confirmed independently against local OCR'd official papers held under `attempts/_pyq_text/`, with no further item found routed here in any checked ledger:

1. **2018 Prelims, GS-I, Q75** -- Subsidiary Alliance, solved in full immediately below, with its answer explicitly labelled INFERRED ANSWER -- NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED, since no official answer key for this paper is held locally.
2. **2022 Mains, GS-I, Q2** -- on why Company armies prevailed, solved as Mains 1 below with a complete, non-bounded, multi-theatre examiner-grade model; this is the same question Topic 04's own package deliberately answered only as a bounded, Bengal-only bridge, explicitly deferring the full answer to this topic.

No further PYQ is claimed for this topic. Where this package's own original MCQs and Mains questions appear below, they are clearly original practice material, not represented as previous UPSC questions.

PYQ 1 solved -- 2018 Prelims, GS-I, Q75 (Subsidiary Alliance)

Question (verbatim, original option order preserved): "Which one of the following statements does not apply to the system of Subsidiary Alliance introduced by Lord Wellesley?"

- (a) To maintain a large standing army at other's expense
- (b) To keep India safe from Napoleonic danger
- (c) To secure a fixed income for the Company
- (d) To establish British paramountcy over the Indian States."

Official key status: not held locally; a targeted search for the official Civil Services Preliminary Examination 2018 answer key for this paper was carried out before concluding this, and no locally verifiable official key text was found. The label below therefore applies in full.

INFERRED ANSWER -- NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: **(c) To secure a fixed income for the Company.**

Confidence: moderate-to-high (independent web corroboration converged on option (c) across multiple sources on a second search attempt; this package's own elimination logic, set out below, independently reaches the same option).

Elimination reasoning:

- **(a) does apply:** subtopic 14 establishes that a permanently stationed subsidiary force, maintained at the allied ruler's own expense (by cash subsidy or ceded revenue), was the Subsidiary Alliance's defining first clause -- this is precisely what the system did.
- **(b) does apply:** subtopic 7 and subtopic 14 both confirm that Wellesley repeatedly invoked the danger of French/Napoleonic influence reaching India (via Tipu's outreach, and via the wider European war) as a stated justification for his forward, systematised alliance policy, whatever later historians conclude about how exaggerated that danger actually was.
- **(d) does apply:** subtopic 16's entire analysis of sovereignty erosion, and the case sequence in subtopic 15, show that establishing British paramountcy over Indian states was the system's central strategic effect and openly stated aim.
- **(c) is the best-supported exception:** the Subsidiary Alliance's payment mechanism (subtopic 14, subtopic 16) was structured as cost recovery for maintaining an externally stationed force, or as a compensating territorial cession, not as a scheme to generate a net "fixed income" surplus for the Company's general treasury; describing the system's purpose as securing "a fixed income for the Company" mischaracterises a cost-recovery and control mechanism as a revenue-generation scheme, making it the statement least accurately describing the system's actual design purpose among the four options.

Why this matters for exam technique: this is a "does NOT apply" negative-framing question; the safest method is to confirm each of the other three options against a named subtopic before selecting the exception, exactly as done above, rather than guessing directly at the "odd one out."

Evidence and answer-writing drills

The eleven most-tested UPSC traps, at a glance

TRAPS GRID

Inevitability trap

Treating expansion as pre-planned, not contingent (Wadgaon, 2nd Mysore War, Holkar 1804-05 disprove this)

Ranjit Singh trap

Attributing the Anglo-Sikh Wars to Ranjit Singh -- he died in 1839, before either war

Amritsar trap

Calling the 1809 Treaty of Amritsar a Subsidiary Alliance -- it was a negotiated equal-footing boundary treaty

Lapse-vs-misgovernance trap

Classifying Awadh 1856 as a Lapse case -- it had a living, heirred Nawab, no succession vacancy

Seven further traps (cash subsidy vs cession, universal 'lapse list' overreach, fabricated sums/casualties, and more) are worked through in the drills immediately below.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - UPSC traps grid

Visual 27: the eleven most-tested UPSC traps in this topic, at a glance

Visual 27: the eleven most-tested UPSC traps in this topic, at a glance. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

Drill 1 - Company armies were overwhelmingly Indian, not "British"

Claim: State explicitly, as the 2022 PYQ itself frames it, that these armies were "mostly comprising of Indian soldiers" under a comparatively thin layer of British officers. Never describe Company victories as demographically "British"; explain how Indian recruitment was integrated with regular finance, command, artillery and logistics.

Exam move: Any answer that explains Company success purely through "British" military or technological superiority, without naming the Indian sepoy composition, has misread the question's own framing and lost an easy opening mark.

Drill 2 - Contingency, not inevitability

Claim: Present expansion as a sequence of case-by-case choices shaped by local alliance opportunities and each ruler's internal politics (subtopic 2), not as a predetermined "rise of British power" narrative; cite the Company's own reverses (Wadgaon 1779, the Second Mysore War, Holkar's 1804-05 resistance) as direct evidence against inevitability.

Exam move: A question asking "how" or "why" expansion succeeded rewards naming at least one specific Company reverse alongside the successes -- this single habit demonstrates the contingency argument rather than merely asserting it.

Drill 3 - Tipu's reforms were real but bounded, not myth and not modern industry

Claim: Credit Tipu's revenue centralisation, agrarian and irrigation encouragement, and "military fiscalism" (Burton Stein's term) as genuine and source-attested, while also naming Irfan Habib's caution that Mysore's modernising ambition ran ahead of its actual resources -- never claim Mysore rivalled contemporary European industrial capacity, and never dismiss the reforms as fabricated nationalist myth either.

Exam move: A balanced answer on Tipu names one specific reform (direct revenue assessment, replacing intermediaries) and one specific limit (resource constraint per Habib) in the same paragraph.

Drill 4 - The Mysore wars' alliance pattern shifted every time; it was never fixed

Claim: State precisely: Marathas and the Nizam sided WITH the Company in the First (1767-69) and Third (1790-92) wars, but WITH Haidar Ali AGAINST the Company in the Second (1780-84) war; only in the Fourth (1799) was there no comparable counterweight, because Hyderabad was already a Subsidiary Alliance dependency since 1798.

Exam move: Never write "the Marathas and the Nizam always supported the Company against Mysore" -- this is factually wrong for the Second War specifically and is one of the most common alliance-sequencing errors in this topic.

Drill 5 - Tipu's French connection was real diplomacy, not proof of an imminent French invasion

Claim: Confirm Tipu's genuine outreach to Revolutionary France, Kabul, Arabia and Turkey (subtopic 7), while also naming Edward Ingram's assessment that the actual probability of French military intervention by 1798-99 was low -- Wellesley's invocation of the "French danger" functioned significantly as a pretext for a war he had independent reasons to want.

Exam move: State both halves together -- "real diplomatic outreach, exaggerated invasion threat" -- rather than either denying the French contact occurred or accepting Wellesley's threat assessment at face value.

Drill 6 - Bassein (1802) was a turning point, not the end of Maratha resistance

Claim: Bassein removed the Peshwa -- the confederacy's nominal head -- from the field of opposition, but Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar all continued fighting through the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05), and the confederacy was defeated only by 1818 in the Third War; never state that Bassein ended Maratha resistance outright.

Exam move: A "significance of Bassein" answer earns full marks only by explaining WHY it mattered (removing the confederacy's legitimating head, enabling serial isolation) rather than by overstating WHAT it immediately ended.

Drill 7 - Distinguish a cash subsidy from a territorial cession precisely

Claim: A cash subsidy was a direct annual payment; a territorial cession transferred revenue-yielding land in lieu of, or partial substitution for, that payment (as at the Nizam's 1800 treaty and Awadh's 1801 settlement) -- both produced dependency, but only cession permanently reduced the state's own resource base.

Exam move: For any named Subsidiary Alliance case, state explicitly whether payment was in cash or in ceded land; this is a frequently tested precision point, and the 2018 Prelims PYQ solved above turns on a closely related distinction.

Drill 8 - Name the responsibility paradox in both directions

Claim: State both halves explicitly -- the Subsidiary Alliance stripped a ruler of army, treasury and diplomacy while leaving him formally responsible for governance outcomes, and the Company then used resulting administrative strain (fiscal pressure, Resident interference, disbanded soldiers turning to Pindari banditry) as its own justification for further intervention.

Exam move: An answer naming only "the ruler lost power" or only "the Company blamed misgovernance," without connecting the two as cause and consequence, has described half the mechanism -- exactly as Topic 04's Dual Government paradox required both halves.

Drill 9 - Napier's Sindh quote is genuine; the "Peccavi" pun is not

Claim: Cite only Napier's attested diary entry ("We have no right to seize Sind, yet we shall do so...") as evidence of the annexation's dubious legality; do not repeat the popular "Peccavi" ("I have sinned"/"I have Sindh") telegram story, which is a widely circulated but historically unverified anecdote excluded from this package.

Exam move: If a question invites a quotation on Sindh's annexation, use the diary entry only, and never present the Peccavi pun as a sourced historical fact.

Drill 10 - Ranjit Singh never fought an Anglo-Sikh War

Claim: State plainly that Ranjit Singh died in June 1839, a full six years before the First Anglo-Sikh War began in December 1845; the Treaty of Amritsar (1809) was a negotiated boundary settlement between the Company and a militarily strong, sovereign equal, not a Subsidiary Alliance and not a war treaty.

Exam move: Any statement implying Ranjit Singh fought, negotiated after defeat, or was annexed by the Company is a basic actor-timeline error; the wars followed only after his death produced succession chaos (subtopic 19).

Drill 11 - Match each Anglo-Sikh war to its own battles and settlement, never mix them

Claim: First War (Dec 1845-Feb 1846): Mudki, Ferozeshah, Aliwal, Sobraon, then the Treaty of Lahore and the Treaty of Bhyrowal (dependency, not annexation). Second War (1848-49): the Multan rebellion trigger, Ramnagar, Chillianwala, Gujrat, then outright annexation of Punjab in March 1849.

Exam move: A statement placing Chillianwala or Gujrat in the First War, or Mudki/Sobraon in the Second, is a common date-battle mismatch; anchor each battle to its correct war using the trigger event (Sutlej crossing in 1845; Multan rebellion in 1848) as the memory hook.

Drill 12 - Keep Lapse, title/pension denial, and misgovernance annexation as three separate mechanisms

Claim: The Doctrine of Lapse applied specifically where a dependent ruler died without a natural heir and an adoption was refused (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi); Nana Sahib's case was a personal pension/title denial, not territorial Lapse (the Peshwaship itself had already been abolished in 1818); Awadh's 1856 annexation rested on alleged misgovernance, with a living Nawab and no succession dispute at all.

Exam move: A question naming "Dalhousie's annexations" collectively still expects each case correctly assigned to its own mechanism; grouping Awadh under "Doctrine of Lapse" is one of the single most common and heavily penalised errors on this topic.

Drill 13 - The 1857 bridge is bounded evidence, never a monocausal claim

Claim: Name only the specific, attested links this topic owns -- Nana Sahib's pension denial, the Rani of Jhansi's refused adoption, Awadh's dispossessed taluqdars, disbanded soldiers -- as antecedent grievances feeding into 1857, while stating explicitly that the rising's fuller causation (military grievances, religious anxiety, peasant taxation pressure) belongs to Topic 11.

Exam move: Never write "territorial expansion and annexation caused the 1857 revolt" as a standalone, sufficient claim; always pair named antecedents with an explicit hand-off statement naming Topic 11 for the fuller picture.

Drill 14 - Never invent a PYQ, an official key, or a topic boundary

Claim: This topic owns exactly two verified routed PYQs (2018 Prelims Q75; 2022 Mains Q2), per this package's own audit above; the 2018 answer is explicitly labelled INFERRED ANSWER -- NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED because no local key exists, and no further PYQ, troop strength, subsidy sum, territorial share, casualty figure or quotation is invented anywhere in this package.

Exam move: When a question edges toward Topics 02, 04, 06, 07 or 11's material, state the boundary explicitly (e.g., "Topic 02's material," "Topic 11's material") rather than silently absorbing or refusing to engage with adjacent content.

Learning MCQs (20; key rotation A -> B -> C -> D repeated five times)

Correct options are deliberately rotated by actual option placement, not by relabelling: A -> B -> C -> D through the full set. Read the explanation after attempting each item.

Q1. Which sequence correctly orders the "rungs" of Company territorial expansion introduced in this topic's analytical frame?

- A. Ring-fence a friendly buffer state, impose subsidiary dependency, assert paramountcy, then annex
- B. Annex first, then impose a buffer, then negotiate paramountcy
- C. Assert paramountcy first, then create buffers, then negotiate subsidiary status
- D. Impose subsidiary dependency before any buffer state exists, then annex without paramountcy

Answer: A. Ring-fence a friendly buffer state, impose subsidiary dependency, assert paramountcy, then annex

Explanation: Subtopic 1 establishes this as the recurring, though not universally rigid, escalation logic -- buffer/ring-fence first, then subsidiary dependency, then the broader paramountcy claim (Hastings, 1813), with annexation as a possible final step, not a fixed first move.

Q2. Which of the following is the clearest direct evidence against a purely "inevitable Company victory" reading of this period?

- A. The size of the Bengal Army by 1856
- B. The Company's own reverses at Wadgaon (1779) and against Holkar (1804-05)
- C. The Treaty of Amritsar's negotiated boundary
- D. The Subsidiary Alliance's six core clauses

Answer: B. The Company's own reverses at Wadgaon (1779) and against Holkar (1804-05)

Explanation: Subtopic 2's contingency argument is best supported by named Company defeats or stalemates, showing outcomes were not predetermined; the other options describe Company strength or negotiated settlements, not reverses.

Q3. Which feature most directly converted Indian recruitment into durable Company military capacity?

- A. Recruitment alone, without regular pay, drill or supply
- B. Exclusive dependence on European soldiers for field operations
- C. A salaried sepoy army integrated with standardised drill, artillery, officers and organised logistics
- D. A refusal to use Indian bankers, suppliers or allied contingents

Answer: C. A salaried sepoy army integrated with standardised drill, artillery, officers and organised logistics

Explanation: Indian recruitment became strategically effective because the Company combined it with regular finance, command, artillery and supply. Numbers alone do not explain repeated campaigning or battlefield endurance.

Q4. Which factor is specifically identified in this topic as part of "why Company armies prevailed II," alongside credit/supply and maritime reinforcement?

- A. Superior European racial characteristics, as claimed in some colonial-era writing
- B. A fixed, unchanging alliance structure applied identically on every frontier
- C. Universal Indian passivity toward Company rule
- D. Diplomacy that serially isolated opponents, aided by Indian allies and recruits

Answer: D. Diplomacy that serially isolated opponents, aided by Indian allies and recruits

Explanation: Subtopic 4 names diplomatic isolation and Indian allies/recruits explicitly as structural factors; the other options are either unsupported colonial-era claims or contradicted by this topic's own contingency and alliance-shift evidence.

Q5. Historian Burton Stein's term "military fiscalism," as applied to Tipu Sultan's Mysore, refers specifically to which practice?

- A. Direct, broad-based state revenue collection deliberately mobilised to sustain a large standing army
- B. A policy of refusing all taxation in favour of voluntary contributions
- C. Reliance solely on plunder from neighbouring states for army funding
- D. A system copied wholesale from contemporary British parliamentary taxation

Answer: A. Direct, broad-based state revenue collection deliberately mobilised to sustain a large standing army

Explanation: Subtopic 5 defines Stein's "military fiscalism" precisely this way -- direct assessment replacing intermediary-based collection, specifically to fund centralised military capacity, structurally comparable to the Company's own Bengal-based strategy.

Q6. In which Anglo-Mysore War did the Marathas and the Nizam of Hyderabad fight ALONGSIDE Haidar Ali/Tipu Sultan, AGAINST the Company?

- A. The First Anglo-Mysore War (1767-69)
- B. The Second Anglo-Mysore War (1780-84)
- C. The Third Anglo-Mysore War (1790-92)
- D. The Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799)

Answer: B. The Second Anglo-Mysore War (1780-84)

Explanation: Subtopic 6 states this precisely: the Marathas and the Nizam sided with the Company in the First and Third wars, but joined Haidar Ali against the Company in the Second War -- a frequently tested alliance-sequencing point.

Q7. Which is the most historically balanced reading of Tipu Sultan's diplomatic outreach to Revolutionary France, per this topic's sourced assessment?

- A. It never happened; the French connection is a later British fabrication
- B. It was a decisive, fully realised military alliance that came close to defeating the Company outright
- C. The outreach was real and diplomatically significant, but Edward Ingram's assessment holds that the actual probability of French intervention by 1798-99 was low, exaggerated by Wellesley as partial pretext
- D. France formally annexed part of Mysore as a colony before 1799

Answer: C. The outreach was real and diplomatically significant, but Edward Ingram's assessment holds that the actual probability of French intervention by 1798-99 was low, exaggerated by Wellesley as partial pretext

Explanation: Subtopic 7 requires holding both halves together -- genuine diplomacy, exaggerated invasion probability -- as the correct, source-supported position; the other options err toward denial or overstatement.

Q8. After the fall of Seringapatam in 1799, what happened to Mysore's core territory and its ruling dynasty?

- A. It was annexed outright and never restored to any Indian ruling family
- B. It was given independently to the Nizam of Hyderabad as a reward
- C. It was declared a fully sovereign, unrestricted kingdom under Tipu's own surviving family
- D. It was restored to the Wodeyar dynasty, but immediately bound by a Subsidiary Alliance authorising British assumption of administration if judged necessary

Answer: D. It was restored to the Wodeyar dynasty, but immediately bound by a Subsidiary Alliance authorising British assumption of administration if judged necessary

Explanation: Subtopic 8 confirms the Wodeyar restoration alongside immediate subsidiary subordination -- nominal restoration combined with substantive dependency, not full annexation and not unrestricted sovereignty.

Q9. Which five houses together made up the Maratha confederacy discussed in this topic?

- A. The Peshwa (Poona), Sindhia (Gwalior), Holkar (Indore), Bhonsle (Nagpur), and Gaekwad (Baroda)
- B. The Peshwa, the Nizam, the Wodeyar, the Sikh Khalsa, and the Amirs of Sindh
- C. Sindhia, Holkar, Bhonsle, Gaekwad, and the Mughal emperor
- D. The Peshwa, Sindhia, Holkar, the Rani of Jhansi, and Nana Sahib

Answer: A. The Peshwa (Poona), Sindhia (Gwalior), Holkar (Indore), Bhonsle (Nagpur), and Gaekwad (Baroda)

Explanation: Subtopic 9 names exactly these five houses; the other options mix in unrelated states or actors from entirely different fronts (Sikh, Sindh) or later periods (Jhansi, Nana Sahib).

Q10. The First Anglo-Maratha War (1775-82) concluded with which treaty, restoring the pre-war status quo?

- A. The Treaty of Bassein
- B. The Treaty of Salbai (1782), mediated by Mahadji Sindhia
- C. The Treaty of Seringapatam
- D. The Treaty of Rajghat

Answer: B. The Treaty of Salbai (1782), mediated by Mahadji Sindhia

Explanation: Subtopic 10 identifies Salbai as the genuinely negotiated settlement ending the First Anglo-Maratha War, restoring the pre-war position and securing roughly twenty years of peace; the other treaties belong to different wars or fronts entirely.

Q11. Why is the Treaty of Bassein (1802) described in this topic as the single most consequential turning point in Company-Maratha relations?

- A. It ended all Maratha military resistance permanently and immediately
- B. It formally annexed the entire Maratha confederacy to the Company
- C. It removed the Peshwa, the confederacy's nominal head, from the field of opposition, converting an external contest into separable conflicts with individual houses
- D. It restored Baji Rao II's full, unrestricted sovereignty

Answer: C. It removed the Peshwa, the confederacy's nominal head, from the field of opposition, converting an external contest into separable conflicts with individual houses

Explanation: Subtopic 11 explains that Bassein's significance lies in enabling serial isolation of Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar individually, not in ending resistance outright (which continued through 1818) or in formal annexation (which came only in 1818 for the Peshwaship).

Q12. At which battle did Lord Lake defeat Sindhia's forces and occupy Delhi and Agra during the Second Anglo-Maratha War?

- A. Assaye
- B. Argaon
- C. Chillianwala
- D. Laswari (1 November 1803)

Answer: D. Laswari (1 November 1803)

Explanation: Subtopic 12 attributes Laswari to Lord Lake's northern campaign against Sindhia; Assaye and Argaon were Arthur Wellesley's Deccan-theatre victories, and Chillianwala belongs to the unrelated Second Anglo-Sikh War.

Q13. What was the ultimate outcome for the Peshwaship at the end of the Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817-18)?

- A. It was abolished outright; Baji Rao II was deposed and pensioned at Bithur
- B. It was restored with expanded powers under British protection
- C. It passed to Yeshwant Rao Holkar as the new Peshwa
- D. It was merged permanently with the Nizam's Hyderabad state

Answer: A. It was abolished outright; Baji Rao II was deposed and pensioned at Bithur

Explanation: Subtopic 13 confirms the Peshwaship's outright abolition, never restored -- a sharper outcome than the dependency (not abolition) imposed on Hyderabad, Awadh or Mysore.

Q14. Which of the following was NOT one of the Subsidiary Alliance's six core clauses as set out in this topic?

- A. Acceptance of a British Resident at the ruler's court
- B. Permanent stationing of a British force at the ruler's own expense, with no promise of Company protection in return
- C. A ban on employing Europeans without British approval
- D. A restriction on independent diplomacy or war-making without consulting the Governor-General

Answer: B. Permanent stationing of a British force at the ruler's own expense, with no promise of Company protection in return

Explanation: Subtopic 14 states the Company DID undertake, at least formally, to defend the ruler in return -- a promise seldom honoured in practice, but nominally present; describing the arrangement as offering no reciprocal promise at all misstates the sixth clause.

Q15. In which order did Wellesley's Subsidiary Alliance system spread across major states, per the verified case sequence in this topic?

- A. Awadh (1801), then Hyderabad (1798), then Mysore (1799), then Bassein (1802)
- B. Bassein (1802), then Mysore (1799), then Hyderabad (1798), then Awadh (1801)
- C. Hyderabad (1798), then Mysore (1799), then Awadh (1801), then the Peshwa via Bassein (1802)
- D. Mysore (1799), then Awadh (1801), then Bassein (1802), then Hyderabad (1798)

Answer: C. Hyderabad (1798), then Mysore (1799), then Awadh (1801), then the Peshwa via Bassein (1802)

Explanation: Subtopic 15 fixes this exact chronological sequence -- Hyderabad first, Mysore immediately after conquest, then Awadh, then the Peshwa -- a frequently tested ordering point.

Q16. The "responsibility paradox" of indirect rule, as this topic defines it, refers to which arrangement?

- A. The ruler retained full army and treasury control but lost only ceremonial status
- B. The Company assumed full formal governing responsibility while the ruler retained real power
- C. Both sides shared power and responsibility equally at all times
- D. The Company created conditions for administrative strain (fiscal pressure, disbanded armies, Resident interference) while the ruler remained formally responsible for governance, later cited to justify further intervention

Answer: D. The Company created conditions for administrative strain (fiscal pressure, disbanded armies, Resident interference) while the ruler remained formally responsible for governance, later cited to justify further intervention

Explanation: Subtopic 16 defines the paradox precisely as responsibility without power, followed by annexation or intervention justified by the very administrative strain the Company's own system had helped create.

Q17. What was the primary strategic-commercial context that drew Company attention to Sindh before its 1843 annexation?

- A. A desire to control the Indus river trade route and secure the north-western frontier approaches amid wider concern over Russian and Persian influence
- B. A succession dispute among the Talpur Amirs requiring British arbitration
- C. A request from the Amirs themselves for British administrative merger
- D. A religious dispute requiring British intervention

Answer: A. A desire to control the Indus river trade route and secure the north-western frontier approaches amid wider concern over Russian and Persian influence

Explanation: Subtopic 17 identifies this commercial-strategic frontier logic as Sindh's defining context, not a succession dispute (that mechanism belongs to Lapse cases), a request for merger, or a religious dispute.

Q18. The Treaty of Amritsar (1809) between the Company and Ranjit Singh established which boundary and relationship?

- A. Full Subsidiary Alliance status for Ranjit Singh's kingdom
- B. The Sutlej river as boundary, recognising Ranjit Singh's sovereignty north and west of it, with cis-Sutlej chiefs under Company protection
- C. Outright Company annexation of Lahore
- D. A boundary at the Indus river, with Ranjit Singh accepting British paramountcy

Answer: B. The Sutlej river as boundary, recognising Ranjit Singh's sovereignty north and west of it, with cis-Sutlej chiefs under Company protection

Explanation: Subtopic 18 confirms Amritsar as a negotiated boundary treaty between comparative equals, not a Subsidiary Alliance or annexation -- the Sutlej, not the Indus, was the fixed boundary.

Q19. How many rulers occupied the Sikh throne in the roughly six years following Ranjit Singh's death in June 1839, illustrating the succession crisis?

- A. Only one, in an unbroken and stable succession
- B. Two, with no factional rivalry
- C. Five, amid intense factional rivalry and the Khalsa army's rise as an independent political force
- D. None; the throne remained vacant throughout

Answer: C. Five, amid intense factional rivalry and the Khalsa army's rise as an independent political force

Explanation: Subtopic 19 traces this rapid five-ruler succession crisis (Kharak Singh, Nau Nihal Singh, and further short reigns before the child Duleep Singh), directly preconditioning the First Anglo-Sikh War.

Q20. Which four battles, in correct chronological order, decided the First Anglo-Sikh War (1845-46)?

- A. Chillianwala, Gujrat, Ramnagar, Multan
- B. Plassey, Buxar, Assaye, Laswari
- C. Seringapatam, Mangalore, Madras, Wadgaon
- D. Mudki, Ferozeshah, Aliwal, Sobraon

Answer: D. Mudki, Ferozeshah, Aliwal, Sobraon

Explanation: Subtopic 20 fixes this exact sequence (18 Dec 1845 to 10 Feb 1846); the other options list battles from entirely different wars (Bengal, Mysore, Maratha) or wrongly include Second Anglo-Sikh War battles (Chillianwala, Gujrat, Ramnagar, Multan).

Broad MCQs (44; key rotation A -> B -> C -> D repeated eleven times)

Q21. The "ring-fence" concept in this topic's analytical frame refers to which strategy?

- A. Creating or supporting a friendly buffer state along a frontier to protect Company territory from a rival power, before any deeper dependency is imposed
- B. Physically walling Company cantonments for defence
- C. A Mughal-era customs boundary later inherited unchanged by the Company
- D. A purely naval blockade strategy used only against European rivals

Answer: A. Creating or supporting a friendly buffer state along a frontier to protect Company territory from a rival power, before any deeper dependency is imposed

Explanation: Subtopic 1 uses "ring-fence" for this buffer-creation logic, the first rung before subsidiary dependency, paramountcy and annexation; the other options are unrelated or invented meanings.

Q22. In the Second Anglo-Mysore War (1780-84), which outcome best illustrates the Company facing a genuine reverse rather than an inevitable advance?

- A. Immediate Company capture of Seringapatam
- B. Haidar Ali's repeated defeats of Company forces in the Carnatic, with the war ending inconclusively at the Treaty of Mangalore
- C. A swift, decisive Company naval victory off Mangalore
- D. The Nizam's unconditional surrender to the Company

Answer: B. Haidar Ali's repeated defeats of Company forces in the Carnatic, with the war ending inconclusively at the Treaty of Mangalore

Explanation: Subtopic 6 confirms this war's inconclusive, mutually-restoring settlement after Haidar's battlefield successes -- a clear reverse/stalemate, not a smooth Company advance.

Q23. Which combination of factors is cited in this topic as underpinning Company officer, artillery and logistics superiority, alongside sepoy numbers?

- A. Reliance purely on mercenary European regiments with no Indian troops at all
- B. Superior individual soldier physical stature, as claimed in colonial-era racial theory
- C. A comparatively thin but professionalised British officer corps, standardised artillery, and organised logistics drawing on Bengal's revenue base
- D. Complete avoidance of any artillery in the field, relying solely on cavalry

Answer: C. A comparatively thin but professionalised British officer corps, standardised artillery, and organised logistics drawing on Bengal's revenue base

Explanation: Subtopic 3 attributes Company effectiveness to this specific combination -- professional officers, standardised artillery, and a revenue-funded logistics chain -- not to racial theory or an all-European force, which this package explicitly does not assert.

Q24. Which factor, alongside diplomacy and serial isolation of opponents, is specifically named in "why Company armies prevailed II"?

- A. A policy of never accepting Indian recruits into any regiment
- B. Complete Company self-sufficiency in supply, without reliance on Indian bankers or credit
- C. Reliance on foreign mercenary loans exclusively from continental Europe
- D. Credit and supply networks together with maritime reinforcement capacity

Answer: D. Credit and supply networks together with maritime reinforcement capacity

Explanation: Subtopic 4 names credit/supply and maritime reinforcement as structural advantages alongside diplomacy; the other options misstate or invert this topic's own claims about Indian recruits and credit reliance.

Q25. How did Haidar Ali rise to effective control of Mysore by 1761?

- A. He ousted the corrupt dalavai Nanjaraj as a rising army officer, leaving the Wodeyar king a titular figurehead
- B. He was formally crowned king by the Mughal emperor
- C. He inherited the throne directly from the previous Wodeyar ruler
- D. He was appointed by the Company as a subsidiary ruler

Answer: A. He ousted the corrupt dalavai Nanjaraj as a rising army officer, leaving the Wodeyar king a titular figurehead

Explanation: Subtopic 5 confirms this precise rise-to-power route -- military talent displacing an existing minister, not inheritance, Mughal coronation, or Company appointment.

Q26. The Treaty of Madras (1769), ending the First Anglo-Mysore War, involved which outcome?

- A. Outright Company annexation of Mysore
- B. Haidar Ali's forces threatened Madras directly and dictated a peace of mutual restoration and mutual defence, which the Company later failed to honour
- C. Formal French recognition of Haidar Ali as emperor
- D. A permanent ban on Mysore maintaining any standing army

Answer: B. Haidar Ali's forces threatened Madras directly and dictated a peace of mutual restoration and mutual defence, which the Company later failed to honour

Explanation: Subtopic 6 confirms Haidar dictated these terms after a strong military position, and that the Company did not honour the mutual-defence promise when the Marathas attacked Haidar in 1771.

Q27. What was the key outcome of the Treaty of Mangalore (1784), ending the Second Anglo-Mysore War?

- A. Establishment of a Subsidiary Alliance over Mysore
- B. Cession of half of Mysore's territory to the Company
- C. Restoration of each side's conquests, concluded after Haidar Ali's death by his son Tipu Sultan
- D. Tipu Sultan's death in battle

Answer: C. Restoration of each side's conquests, concluded after Haidar Ali's death by his son Tipu Sultan

Explanation: Subtopic 6 confirms Mangalore as a mutual-restoration peace, concluded by Tipu after Haidar's December 1782 death; the territorial cession and Subsidiary Alliance belong to later settlements (1792 and 1799 respectively).

Q28. Under the Treaty of Seringapatam (1792), ending the Third Anglo-Mysore War, Tipu Sultan was required to do what?

- A. Accept full Company annexation of Mysore
- B. Accept a Subsidiary Alliance immediately
- C. Disband his entire army permanently
- D. Cede roughly half his territory to the allied powers and pay a war indemnity

Answer: D. Cede roughly half his territory to the allied powers and pay a war indemnity

Explanation: Subtopic 6 confirms this cession-and-indemnity outcome after Cornwallis's combined campaign with the Marathas and the Nizam; annexation and the Subsidiary Alliance came only after the Fourth War in 1799.

Q29. Haidar Ali's 1766 annexation of which coastal region first extended Mysore's reach to lucrative pepper, sandalwood and cardamom trade?

- A. Malabar and Calicut
- B. Bengal's coastal districts
- C. The Coromandel Carnatic coast
- D. Sindh's coastline

Answer: A. Malabar and Calicut

Explanation: Subtopic 7 confirms this 1766 annexation as the origin of Mysore's recurring friction with the Marathas' own coastal reach and with Travancore.

Q30. Tipu Sultan's mid-1780s trade policy toward English merchants in his ports involved which measure?

- A. Free, unrestricted trade access granted specifically to Company merchants
- B. Export embargoes on pepper, sandalwood and cardamom, and restrictions on English traders' dealings
- C. A formal customs union with the Company
- D. Abolition of all export duties on every commodity

Answer: B. Export embargoes on pepper, sandalwood and cardamom, and restrictions on English traders' dealings

Explanation: Subtopic 7 names this specific embargo policy as a commercial friction reinforcing the wider strategic rivalry with the Company, particularly around Malabar's trade.

Q31. How did Tipu Sultan die in 1799?

- A. In exile after surrendering Seringapatam without resistance
- B. By suicide following the city's fall
- C. Defending Seringapatam on 4 May 1799, with his army remaining loyal through the city's fall
- D. In a naval battle off the Malabar coast

Answer: C. Defending Seringapatam on 4 May 1799, with his army remaining loyal through the city's fall

Explanation: Subtopic 8 confirms Tipu died defending his capital, with his forces recorded as loyal to the end, not surrendering or fleeing.

Q32. What supplied Lord Cornwallis's direct pretext for launching the Third Anglo-Mysore War (1790-92)?

- A. A dispute over Sindh's frontier
- B. A direct Mysorean attack on Madras itself
- C. Tipu's refusal to pay tribute to the Mughal emperor
- D. Tipu Sultan's 1789-90 attack on the Raja of Travancore, a state under Company protection

Answer: D. Tipu Sultan's 1789-90 attack on the Raja of Travancore, a state under Company protection

Explanation: Subtopic 7 identifies this attack on a Company-protected neighbour as the direct pretext Cornwallis used to launch the Third Anglo-Mysore War.

Q33. Whose death in 1800 removed the Maratha confederacy's most experienced check on internal rivalry, directly preconditioning the Treaty of Bassein?

- A. Nana Phadnis
- B. Mahadji Sindhia
- C. Peshwa Baji Rao II
- D. Yeshwant Rao Holkar

Answer: A. Nana Phadnis

Explanation: Subtopic 11 identifies Nana Phadnis's 1800 death, after roughly three decades holding the confederacy together, as the precipitating event for the succession-era feuding that led to Bassein.

Q34. Raghunath Rao's 1775 appeal to the Company's Bombay establishment, backed after his defeat in Gujarat, is associated with which early, uncounted-by-Calcutta agreement?

- A. The Treaty of Salbai
- B. An early Bombay-led agreement traditionally associated with the Treaty of Surat, not ratified by the Company's Calcutta authorities
- C. The Treaty of Bassein
- D. The Treaty of Rajghat

Answer: B. An early Bombay-led agreement traditionally associated with the Treaty of Surat, not ratified by the Company's Calcutta authorities

Explanation: Subtopic 10 confirms this Bombay-Calcutta split -- the Bombay government's own initiative was not endorsed by Calcutta, which instead concluded the separate Treaty of Purandar in 1776.

Q35. The 1779 Convention/Treaty of Wadgaon required the Company's Bombay force to do what?

- A. Annex additional Maratha territory
- B. Install Raghunath Rao as Peshwa immediately
- C. Renounce all its conquests and abandon Raghunath Rao's cause outright, after being defeated and encircled
- D. Pay an indemnity to Mahadji Sindhia only

Answer: C. Renounce all its conquests and abandon Raghunath Rao's cause outright, after being defeated and encircled

Explanation: Subtopic 10 confirms Wadgaon as a humiliating Company reverse -- forced renunciation after encirclement, not a negotiated gain or partial settlement.

Q36. On what date was the Treaty of Bassein signed, formalising Peshwa Baji Rao II's Subsidiary Alliance?

- A. 23 June 1757
- B. 22 October 1764
- C. 1 November 1803
- D. 31 December 1802

Answer: D. 31 December 1802

Explanation: Subtopic 11 fixes this precise date, immediately after Holkar's 25 October 1802 defeat of the combined Peshwa-Sindhia forces near Poona; the other dates belong to Plassey, Buxar and Laswari respectively.

Q37. At which battle, in September 1803, did Arthur Wellesley (the future Duke of Wellington) defeat the combined Sindhia-Bhonsle forces in the Deccan theatre?

- A. Assaye
- B. Chillianwala
- C. Sobraon
- D. Miani

Answer: A. Assaye

Explanation: Subtopic 12 confirms Assaye (September 1803) as Arthur Wellesley's Deccan-theatre victory, distinct from Lord Lake's northern-theatre Laswari and from the unrelated Sikh and Sindh battles listed as distractors.

Q38. The Treaty of Rajghat (1805/06), restoring much of Holkar's territory, followed which development?

- A. Holkar's immediate surrender at the war's outset
- B. Yeshwant Rao Holkar's continued resistance, using mobile cavalry tactics, forcing Company financial strain and a change of Governor-General policy
- C. Holkar's alliance with the Company against Sindhia
- D. The abolition of the Peshwaship

Answer: B. Yeshwant Rao Holkar's continued resistance, using mobile cavalry tactics, forcing Company financial strain and a change of Governor-General policy

Explanation: Subtopic 12 confirms Holkar's sustained resistance and the Company's recall of Wellesley amid financial strain, leading to Rajghat's comparatively lenient restoration of territory.

Q39. Lord Hastings's explicit articulation of the "paramountcy" doctrine from 1813 held which position?

- A. The Company should never intervene beyond existing treaty obligations
- B. Only Parliament in London could authorise any Indian military action
- C. The Company's own security interests entitled it to act against any Indian power it judged a threat, allied or not
- D. Only the Mughal emperor retained authority to sanction Company military action

Answer: C. The Company's own security interests entitled it to act against any Indian power it judged a threat, allied or not

Explanation: Subtopic 13 attributes this explicit paramountcy doctrine to Hastings, directly enabling the decisive campaign against the Peshwa, Bhonsle and Holkar in 1817-18.

Q40. Nana Sahib's grievance against the Company, which fed into his later role in 1857, arose from which specific decision?

- A. The 1818 abolition of the Peshwaship itself, which Nana Sahib is said to have personally fought against
- B. The Doctrine of Lapse applied to a Maratha territory Nana Sahib ruled directly
- C. The 1802 Treaty of Bassein's terms
- D. Dalhousie's refusal to continue Baji Rao II's personal pension and title to his adopted son after Baji Rao II's 1851 death

Answer: D. Dalhousie's refusal to continue Baji Rao II's personal pension and title to his adopted son after Baji Rao II's 1851 death

Explanation: Subtopic 24 (and subtopic 22's title/pension distinction) confirms this was a personal pension/title denial in 1851, structurally separate from territorial Doctrine of Lapse cases and from the already-completed 1818 abolition of the Peshwaship.

Q41. The technique of stationing a Company-paid force alongside an allied Indian ruler, later systematised by Wellesley as the Subsidiary Alliance, had which characteristic before 1798?

- A. It had precedents in earlier Company practice and in comparable French subsidiary arrangements, but lacked Wellesley's systematic, near-universal application
- B. It was entirely unprecedented and invented wholly by Wellesley
- C. It had been used only once before, by Warren Hastings against Awadh
- D. It originated with the Marathas, who imposed it on the Company

Answer: A. It had precedents in earlier Company practice and in comparable French subsidiary arrangements, but lacked Wellesley's systematic, near-universal application

Explanation: Subtopic 14 explicitly credits Wellesley with systematisation, not invention -- the underlying technique had genuine precedents that Wellesley then applied far more aggressively and universally.

Q42. The contemporary characterisation quoted in this topic -- describing the Subsidiary Alliance as "a system of fattening allies as we fatten oxen, till they were worthy of being devoured" -- is presented as which kind of evidence?

- A. This package's own original analytical claim
- B. A period British commentator's reflection, quoted as a contemporary characterisation, not this package's own analytical claim
- C. An official East India Company government resolution
- D. A verified quotation from Tipu Sultan

Answer: B. A period British commentator's reflection, quoted as a contemporary characterisation, not this package's own analytical claim

Explanation: Subtopic 14 explicitly frames this vivid quotation as a period reflection cited via Bipan Chandra, distinguishing it from this package's own analytical voice.

Q43. The Nizam of Hyderabad's Subsidiary Alliance arrangement, first concluded in 1798 and enlarged in 1800, required the Nizam to do what?

- A. Accept direct Mughal suzerainty instead of British protection
- B. Cede his entire kingdom outright to the Company
- C. Dismiss his French-trained troops and maintain a subsidiary force at his own cost, later partly through territorial cession
- D. Pay no subsidy at all, receiving the force free of charge

Answer: C. Dismiss his French-trained troops and maintain a subsidiary force at his own cost, later partly through territorial cession

Explanation: Subtopic 15 confirms this was the Company's first Subsidiary Alliance case (1798), later enlarged in 1800 with part-payment converted to ceded territory.

Q44. Under the 1801 Subsidiary Treaty imposed on Awadh, the Nawab surrendered roughly which territories in place of an enlarged cash subsidy?

- A. Malabar and Canara
- B. The Jullundur Doab and Kashmir
- C. Berar and Nagpur
- D. Rohilkhand and the Doab (between the Ganga and the Yamuna)

Answer: D. Rohilkhand and the Doab (between the Ganga and the Yamuna)

Explanation: Subtopic 15 confirms these were the specific territories ceded under Awadh's 1801 settlement; the other options belong to Mysore's coast, later Central India annexations, and the 1846 Sikh settlement respectively.

Q45. Which of the following states/rulers were compelled to cede their kingdoms outright in exchange for a pension, rather than accepting a Subsidiary Alliance, under Wellesley?

- A. The Nawab of the Carnatic (1801), and the rulers of Tanjore and Surat
- B. The Nizam of Hyderabad
- C. Peshwa Baji Rao II
- D. Ranjit Singh's Punjab

Answer: A. The Nawab of the Carnatic (1801), and the rulers of Tanjore and Surat

Explanation: Subtopic 15 distinguishes these direct-pension annexations (forming the enlarged Madras Presidency) from the Subsidiary Alliance route applied to Hyderabad, the Peshwa, and (in a wholly different, later mechanism) Punjab.

Q46. What is the precise difference between a "cash subsidy" and a "territorial cession" under the Subsidiary Alliance system, as this topic defines them?

- A. They are simply two names for the identical arrangement with no practical difference
- B. A cash subsidy was an annual cash payment for the stationed force's upkeep; a territorial cession transferred revenue-yielding land in lieu of, or partial substitution for, that payment, permanently reducing the state's own resource base
- C. A cash subsidy applied only to Mysore; a territorial cession applied only to the Marathas
- D. A territorial cession was always larger in value than any cash subsidy

Answer: B. A cash subsidy was an annual cash payment for the stationed force's upkeep; a territorial cession transferred revenue-yielding land in lieu of, or partial substitution for, that payment, permanently reducing the state's own resource base

Explanation: Subtopic 16 draws this precise distinction, noting a territorial cession's more permanent impact on the ceding state's future capacity -- a frequently tested precision point connected to the 2018 Prelims PYQ solved in this Part.

Q47. The disbandment of a protected state's own army under the Subsidiary Alliance system is linked in this topic to which subsequent development?

- A. The immediate abolition of the Doctrine of Lapse
- B. A permanent reduction in Company military strength
- C. A rise in the number of unemployed soldiers and officers, some of whom joined the roving Pindari bands
- D. Direct annexation of Awadh in 1801

Answer: C. A rise in the number of unemployed soldiers and officers, some of whom joined the roving Pindari bands

Explanation: Subtopic 16 draws this direct link between disbanded subsidiary-state armies and the Pindari problem that later justified Lord Hastings's paramountcy-based intervention (subtopic 13).

Q48. The 1832 commercial treaty affecting Sindh achieved which outcome?

- A. Outright annexation of Sindh to the Company
- B. Ceded Karachi to the Company permanently
- C. Established a Subsidiary Alliance over the Amirs
- D. Opened the Indus river and Sindh's roads to Company trade

Answer: D. Opened the Indus river and Sindh's roads to Company trade

Explanation: Subtopic 17 confirms this 1832 treaty's commercial, non-annexationist character, well before the 1839 subsidiary treaty and 1843 annexation.

Q49. The 1839 Subsidiary Treaty imposed on Sindh's Amirs is best understood in the context of which wider Company undertaking?

- A. The First Afghan War (1838-42), which brought British troops into Sindh
- B. The Third Anglo-Maratha War
- C. The Second Anglo-Sikh War
- D. The Fourth Anglo-Mysore War

Answer: A. The First Afghan War (1838-42), which brought British troops into Sindh

Explanation: Subtopic 17 links the 1839 Subsidiary Treaty on Sindh directly to Company military transit needs for the First Afghan War, not to any of the other, unrelated campaigns listed.

Q50. At which two battles, in 1843, did Charles Napier defeat the Amirs' forces before Sindh's annexation?

- A. Assaye and Argaon
- B. Miani (17 February 1843) and Dabo/Hyderabad (24 March 1843)
- C. Mudki and Ferozeshah
- D. Chillianwala and Gujrat

Answer: B. Miani (17 February 1843) and Dabo/Hyderabad (24 March 1843)

Explanation: Subtopic 17 confirms these two 1843 battles as the immediate military prelude to Sindh's annexation; the other pairs belong to the Maratha, First Anglo-Sikh, and Second Anglo-Sikh wars respectively.

Q51. Which quotation is verified and used in this topic regarding Sindh's annexation, and which popular story is deliberately excluded as unverified?

- A. Verified: Wellesley's letter on the "most favourable opportunity"; excluded: the Black Hole narrative
- B. Verified: Clive's 1772 testimony on corruption; excluded: Napier's diary entry
- C. Verified: Napier's diary entry admitting the annexation's dubious legality; excluded: the popular "Peccavi" ("I have sinned"/"I have Sindh") telegram pun
- D. Verified: the "fattening allies" quote; excluded: Napier's diary entry

Answer: C. Verified: Napier's diary entry admitting the annexation's dubious legality; excluded: the popular "Peccavi" ("I have sinned"/"I have Sindh") telegram pun

Explanation: Subtopic 17 and Drill 9 both confirm this exact verified-versus-excluded pairing; the "Peccavi" pun is a widely repeated but historically unverified anecdote deliberately excluded from this package.

Q52. Ranjit Singh's Khalsa army was modernised with the help of which kind of recruited personnel?

- A. Ottoman Turkish cavalry officers exclusively
- B. Afghan mercenary commanders exclusively
- C. Exclusively Company-trained British officers on loan
- D. French, Italian and other European officers (including Jean-Francois Allard and Jean-Baptiste Ventura)

Answer: D. French, Italian and other European officers (including Jean-Francois Allard and Jean-Baptiste Ventura)

Explanation: Subtopic 18 names these specific European officers recruited by Ranjit Singh to modernise the Khalsa army's infantry, artillery and drill.

Q53. In which month and year did Ranjit Singh die, six years before the First Anglo-Sikh War began?

- A. June 1839
- B. December 1845
- C. March 1849
- D. February 1846

Answer: A. June 1839

Explanation: Subtopic 18/19 fix this precise date, underscoring that Ranjit Singh never fought the Company -- the wars began only after his death produced succession instability.

Q54. Which two Sikh rulers died in rapid succession immediately after Ranjit Singh, deepening the post-1839 crisis?

- A. Duleep Singh and Rani Jindan Kaur
- B. Kharak Singh (died 1840) and Nau Nihal Singh (died the same day as his father's funeral procession, 1840)
- C. Wajid Ali Shah and Nana Sahib
- D. Baji Rao II and Raghunath Rao

Answer: B. Kharak Singh (died 1840) and Nau Nihal Singh (died the same day as his father's funeral procession, 1840)

Explanation: Subtopic 19 confirms this specific, unusually rapid double succession crisis as a key precondition for the Khalsa army's rising political independence and the eventual war.

Q55. What precipitated the crossing of the Sutlej by the Khalsa army in December 1845, starting the First Anglo-Sikh War?

- A. A direct order from Ranjit Singh
- B. The Multan rebellion
- C. Rising mutual suspicion from Company frontier build-up after the Afghan war and the Khalsa army's own increasingly independent political assertiveness at Lahore
- D. Dalhousie's Doctrine of Lapse

Answer: C. Rising mutual suspicion from Company frontier build-up after the Afghan war and the Khalsa army's own increasingly independent political assertiveness at Lahore

Explanation: Subtopic 20 identifies this mutual-suspicion dynamic as the war's precipitating context; Ranjit Singh had already been dead for six years, the Multan rebellion belongs to the Second War, and the Doctrine of Lapse is an unrelated, later mechanism.

Q56. Under the Treaty of Lahore (March 1846), which territories did the Sikh state cede?

- A. Sindh and Malabar
- B. Satara and Jhansi
- C. Rohilkhand and the Doab
- D. The Jullundur Doab and Kashmir (the latter separately sold to Gulab Singh of Jammu)

Answer: D. The Jullundur Doab and Kashmir (the latter separately sold to Gulab Singh of Jammu)

Explanation: Subtopic 20 confirms this specific cession, including the creation of Jammu and Kashmir as a princely state under British paramountcy through the Kashmir sale to Gulab Singh.

Q57. Under the Treaty of Bhyrowal (16 December 1846), who held effectively decisive authority at Lahore during Duleep Singh's minority?

- A. Henry Lawrence, as British Resident, under a Council of Regency
- B. Rani Jindan Kaur alone, without British oversight
- C. Diwan Mulraj
- D. Charles Napier

Answer: A. Henry Lawrence, as British Resident, under a Council of Regency

Explanation: Subtopic 20 names Henry Lawrence specifically as the Resident holding real authority under the Bhyrowal settlement, a dependency arrangement short of outright annexation.

Q58. The Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848-49) began with a rebellion centred at which location, triggered by which figure?

- A. Lahore, triggered by Duleep Singh
- B. Multan, triggered by Diwan Mulraj's killing of two British officers sent to oversee the province's transfer
- C. Amritsar, triggered by Ranjit Singh's heirs
- D. Peshawar, triggered by an Afghan incursion

Answer: B. Multan, triggered by Diwan Mulraj's killing of two British officers sent to oversee the province's transfer

Explanation: Subtopic 21 confirms Multan and Diwan Mulraj's specific role as the war's proximate trigger, distinct from the earlier, unrelated First War's Sutlej-crossing trigger.

Q59. Which battle, on 21 February 1849, decisively broke the Khalsa army's remaining organised resistance in the Second Anglo-Sikh War?

- A. Mudki
- B. Ferozeshah
- C. Gujrat
- D. Ramnagar

Answer: C. Gujrat

Explanation: Subtopic 21 confirms Gujrat (21 February 1849) as the decisive engagement, following the inconclusive Ramnagar and the costly, disputed Chillianwala; Mudki and Ferozeshah belong to the earlier, separate First War.

Q60. On what date was the Punjab formally annexed, ending the Sikh Empire, and what happened to Maharaja Duleep Singh?

- A. 1858; he was made a British peer immediately
- B. 10 February 1846; he was restored to full sovereignty
- C. 1856; he was declared Governor-General's agent
- D. 29 March 1849; he was pensioned and sent to England, and the Khalsa army was disbanded

Answer: D. 29 March 1849; he was pensioned and sent to England, and the Khalsa army was disbanded

Explanation: Subtopic 21 fixes this precise annexation date and outcome, distinct from the 1846 date (First War settlement, not annexation) and unrelated later dates offered as distractors.

Q61. The Doctrine of Lapse, as articulated by Dalhousie, permitted the Company to annex a dependent state under which specific condition?

- A. Where the ruler died without a natural (biological) male heir and Dalhousie refused to recognise an adopted heir
- B. Whenever the ruler's territory was strategically valuable, regardless of succession
- C. Whenever a ruler was accused of misgovernance, regardless of succession status
- D. Only where the ruler voluntarily requested annexation

Answer: A. Where the ruler died without a natural (biological) male heir and Dalhousie refused to recognise an adopted heir

Explanation: Subtopic 22 defines the Doctrine of Lapse precisely by this natural-heir/adoption-refusal condition, distinguishing it sharply from misgovernance annexation (Awadh, subtopic 23) or purely strategic conquest (Sindh, subtopic 17).

Q62. Raja Gangadhar Rao's adoption of Damodar Rao shortly before his death in November 1853 was refused recognition by Dalhousie, leading to which outcome?

- A. Satara's annexation in 1848
- B. Jhansi's annexation (1853-54), later contested by Rani Lakshmibai
- C. Awadh's annexation in 1856
- D. Sindh's annexation in 1843

Answer: B. Jhansi's annexation (1853-54), later contested by Rani Lakshmibai

Explanation: Subtopic 22 confirms this exact sequence for Jhansi, feeding directly into Rani Lakshmibai's role in 1857 (subtopic 24), distinct from Satara (the first Lapse case, 1848), Awadh (misgovernance, not Lapse), and Sindh (frontier conquest).

Q63. Why does this topic explicitly classify the 1856 annexation of Awadh as separate from the Doctrine of Lapse?

- A. Because Awadh was annexed by Napier, not Dalhousie
- B. Because Awadh had never signed a Subsidiary Alliance
- C. Because Awadh's Nawab, Wajid Ali Shah, was alive with heirs and no succession dispute existed; the annexation rested instead on alleged internal misgovernance reported by James Outram
- D. Because Awadh's annexation predated Dalhousie's tenure

Answer: C. Because Awadh's Nawab, Wajid Ali Shah, was alive with heirs and no succession dispute existed; the annexation rested instead on alleged internal misgovernance reported by James Outram

Explanation: Subtopic 23 draws this precise distinction -- misgovernance annexation with a living, heir-bearing ruler, categorically different from a true Lapse case's succession-without-heir condition.

Q64. Which historiographical lens, per this topic's four-lens framework, best combines with the fiscal-military lens to explain both Company capacity and why that capacity found exploitable local divisions?

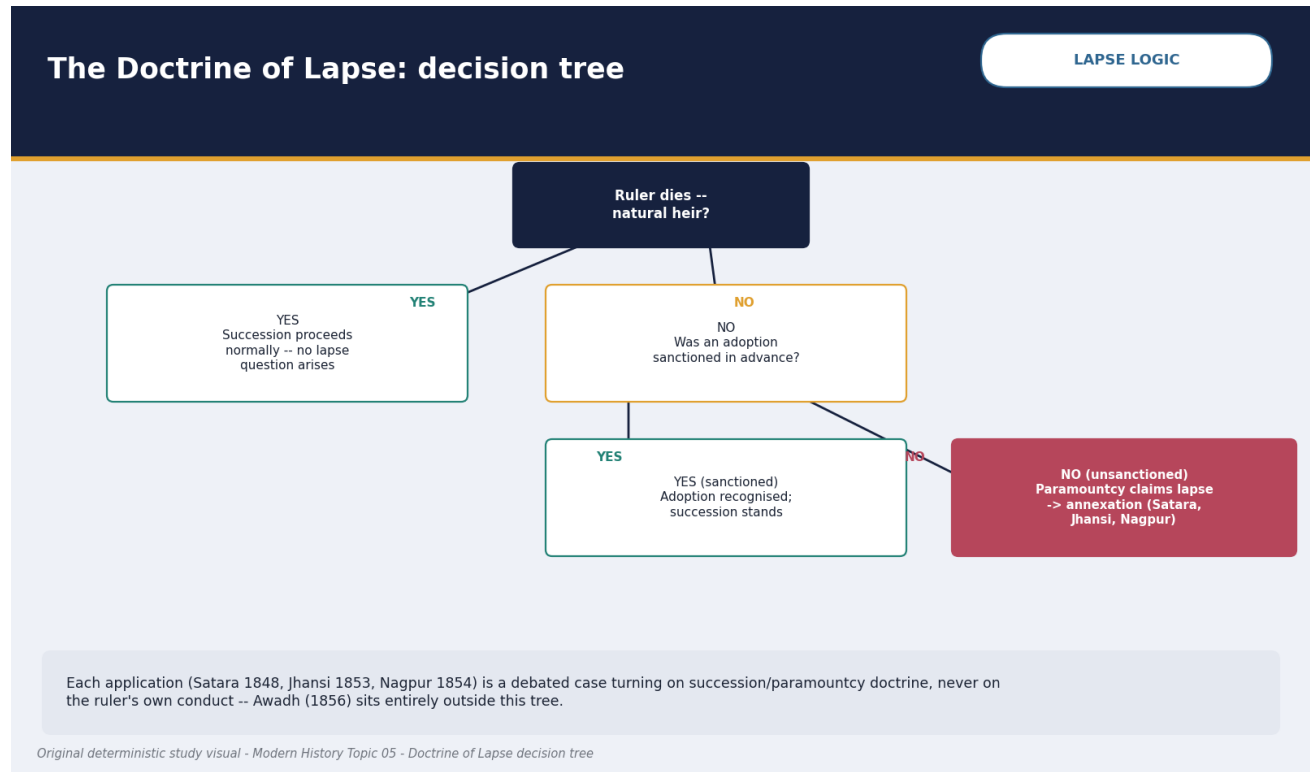
- A. The military-revolution/contingency lens alone, without reference to any other lens
- B. A lens denying that any historiographical disagreement exists on this topic
- C. A lens asserting British racial or civilisational superiority
- D. The collaboration and Indian-agency lens, emphasising autonomous regional alliance calculations and Indian staffing of the Company's own machine

Answer: D. The collaboration and Indian-agency lens, emphasising autonomous regional alliance calculations and Indian staffing of the Company's own machine

Explanation: Subtopic 25's analysis explicitly identifies combining the fiscal-military lens (capacity) with the collaboration/agency lens (why that capacity found local partners and exploitable divisions) as the strongest analytical move; the other options misstate or reject the framework.

Remedial MCQs (16; targeted at this topic's most common specific errors)

Each item below corrects a real, frequently seen misstatement. Read the flawed student statement, then select the accurate remedial correction.



Visual 28: recurring Lapse/misgovernance/title-pension confusions, matched to the remedial items below

Visual 28: recurring Lapse/misgovernance/title-pension confusions, matched to the remedial items below. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

Q65. A student writes: 'The Company's armies that defeated Indian rulers were overwhelmingly British soldiers.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. These armies were composed mostly of Indian sepoys, organised through regular finance, drill, artillery, logistics and a comparatively thin British officer corps
- B. The statement is accurate; sepoys were a small minority throughout
- C. Only Bengal's army used Indian troops; Madras and Bombay armies were entirely British
- D. Indian soldiers were used only in non-combat logistics roles

Answer: A. These armies were composed mostly of Indian sepoys, organised through regular finance, drill, artillery, logistics and a comparatively thin British officer corps

Explanation: This is precisely the framing the 2022 Mains PYQ itself uses; describing Company victories as demographically "British" misreads both the question and the source evidence in subtopic 3.

Q66. A student writes: 'Tipu Sultan's Mysore had already achieved a level of industrial modernity comparable to contemporary Europe.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The statement is accurate without qualification
- B. Tipu's reforms (direct revenue assessment, agrarian and irrigation encouragement, "military fiscalism") were genuine, but Irfan Habib's own caution notes his modernising ambition ran ahead of the state's actual resources
- C. Tipu made no meaningful reforms at all; this is a nationalist myth
- D. Modernity is irrelevant to assessing Mysore's military capacity

Answer: B. Tipu's reforms (direct revenue assessment, agrarian and irrigation encouragement, "military fiscalism") were genuine, but Irfan Habib's own caution notes his modernising ambition ran ahead of the state's actual resources

Explanation: Subtopic 5's balanced position credits real reform while flagging its resource limits -- both overstatement and dismissal are errors this topic explicitly guards against.

Q67. A student writes: 'The Marathas and the Nizam always allied with the Company against Mysore in every Anglo-Mysore War.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. Only the Nizam ever allied with Mysore; the Marathas never did
- B. The statement is accurate for all four wars
- C. They allied with the Company in the First and Third wars, but sided WITH Haidar Ali AGAINST the Company in the Second Anglo-Mysore War (1780-84)
- D. Neither the Marathas nor the Nizam were involved in any Anglo-Mysore War

Answer: C. They allied with the Company in the First and Third wars, but sided WITH Haidar Ali AGAINST the Company in the Second Anglo-Mysore War (1780-84)

Explanation: Subtopic 6 and Drill 4 both flag this exact alliance-sequencing error as one of the most common in this topic.

Q68. A student writes: 'Napier's famous telegram "Peccavi" ("I have sinned"/"I have Sindh") is a verified primary-source quotation confirming his own admission of wrongdoing.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The quotation is from Wellesley, not Napier
- B. The statement is accurate and the telegram's original text is held in this repository
- C. Napier never expressed any doubt about Sindh's annexation in any document
- D. The "Peccavi" story is a widely repeated but historically unverified anecdote, deliberately excluded from this package; the verified quotation is Napier's own diary entry admitting the annexation's dubious legality

Answer: D. The "Peccavi" story is a widely repeated but historically unverified anecdote, deliberately excluded from this package; the verified quotation is Napier's own diary entry admitting the annexation's dubious legality

Explanation: Subtopic 17 and Drill 9 both draw this exact verified-versus-unverified distinction; citing "Peccavi" as sourced fact is a specifically flagged error in this package.

Q69. A student writes: 'Ranjit Singh personally led the Sikh Empire's forces against the Company in the Anglo-Sikh Wars and was defeated.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. Ranjit Singh died in June 1839, a full six years before the First Anglo-Sikh War began in December 1845; he never fought the Company
- B. The statement is accurate; he led the First Anglo-Sikh War personally
- C. He led only the Second Anglo-Sikh War, not the First
- D. He was captured and pensioned after the First Anglo-Sikh War

Answer: A. Ranjit Singh died in June 1839, a full six years before the First Anglo-Sikh War began in December 1845; he never fought the Company

Explanation: Subtopic 18/19 and Drill 10 both flag this precise actor-timeline error; the wars followed only after his death produced succession instability.

Q70. A student writes: 'The First Anglo-Sikh War (1845-46) ended with the outright annexation of the Punjab.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The statement is accurate; annexation followed directly from Sobraon
- B. The First War ended with the Treaty of Lahore and the Treaty of Bhyrowal, establishing a Resident-controlled dependency, not annexation; Punjab was annexed only in March 1849, after the Second Anglo-Sikh War
- C. The First War ended in a Sikh victory with no treaty at all
- D. Punjab was annexed in 1846 but restored to Duleep Singh in 1849

Answer: B. The First War ended with the Treaty of Lahore and the Treaty of Bhyrowal, establishing a Resident-controlled dependency, not annexation; Punjab was annexed only in March 1849, after the Second Anglo-Sikh War

Explanation: Subtopic 20-21 and Drill 11 both confirm this precise war-to-outcome sequencing; conflating the First War's dependency outcome with the Second War's annexation is a frequent error.

Q71. A student writes: 'Awadh was annexed in 1856 under Dalhousie's Doctrine of Lapse, after the Nawab died without an heir.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. Awadh was annexed by Napier, not Dalhousie
- B. The statement is accurate; Awadh is a standard Lapse case
- C. Awadh's Nawab, Wajid Ali Shah, was alive with heirs; annexation rested on alleged internal misgovernance reported by James Outram, a mechanism this package explicitly distinguishes from the Doctrine of Lapse
- D. Awadh was never actually annexed; it remained independent until 1947

Answer: C. Awadh's Nawab, Wajid Ali Shah, was alive with heirs; annexation rested on alleged internal misgovernance reported by James Outram, a mechanism this package explicitly distinguishes from the Doctrine of Lapse

Explanation: Subtopic 23 and Drill 12 both flag grouping Awadh under the Doctrine of Lapse as one of the single most common and heavily penalised errors on this topic.

Q72. A student writes: 'Nana Sahib's grievance against the Company was a territorial Doctrine of Lapse case, just like Jhansi.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. Nana Sahib's grievance concerned Sindh's annexation
- B. The statement is accurate; both are identical Lapse cases
- C. Nana Sahib ruled a state that was annexed under Lapse in 1853
- D. Nana Sahib's grievance was Dalhousie's refusal to continue his adoptive father Baji Rao II's personal pension and title after Baji Rao II's 1851 death -- a title/pension denial, structurally distinct from a territorial Lapse annexation like Jhansi's

Answer: D. Nana Sahib's grievance was Dalhousie's refusal to continue his adoptive father Baji Rao II's personal pension and title after Baji Rao II's 1851 death -- a title/pension denial, structurally distinct from a territorial Lapse annexation like Jhansi's

Explanation: Subtopic 22/24 and Drill 12 draw this precise mechanism distinction; the Peshwaship itself had already been abolished in 1818, well before this 1851 pension dispute.

Q73. A student writes: 'The Treaty of Bassein (1802) ended all Maratha military resistance to the Company outright.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. Bassein removed only the Peshwa from the field of opposition; Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar continued fighting through the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05), and the confederacy was defeated only by 1818 in the Third War
- B. The statement is accurate; no Maratha house fought after 1802
- C. Bassein was a Maratha military victory over the Company
- D. Bassein applied only to Sindhia, not to the Peshwa

Answer: A. Bassein removed only the Peshwa from the field of opposition; Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar continued fighting through the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05), and the confederacy was defeated only by 1818 in the Third War

Explanation: Subtopic 11 and Drill 6 both flag overstating Bassein's immediate effect as a common error; its significance is structural (isolating the Peshwa), not an instant end to all resistance.

Q74. A student writes: 'Every Subsidiary Alliance treaty required the allied ruler to pay in ceded territory; cash payment was never used.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The statement is accurate for every single case
- B. Payment could be either a cash subsidy or a territorial cession (or a combination, as at the Nizam's 1800 treaty and Awadh's 1801 settlement); the two are distinct mechanisms, not identical or mutually exclusive across all cases
- C. Cash payment was used only by the Marathas
- D. Territorial cession was used only in Sindh

Answer: B. Payment could be either a cash subsidy or a territorial cession (or a combination, as at the Nizam's 1800 treaty and Awadh's 1801 settlement); the two are distinct mechanisms, not identical or mutually exclusive across all cases

Explanation: Subtopic 14/16 and Drill 7 both require this precise cash-versus-cession distinction, directly relevant to the 2018 Prelims PYQ solved in this Part.

Q75. A student writes: 'A cash subsidy and a territorial cession under the Subsidiary Alliance are simply two names for an identical arrangement.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. A cash subsidy was always larger in value than a territorial cession
- B. The statement is accurate; there is no practical difference
- C. They are distinct: a cash subsidy was an annual payment, while a territorial cession transferred revenue-yielding land, permanently reducing the ceding state's own resource base -- a materially different long-term effect
- D. Only Mysore ever paid a cash subsidy

Answer: C. They are distinct: a cash subsidy was an annual payment, while a territorial cession transferred revenue-yielding land, permanently reducing the ceding state's own resource base -- a materially different long-term effect

Explanation: Subtopic 16 and Drill 7 both require naming this precise, frequently tested difference explicitly, not treating the two mechanisms as interchangeable.

Q76. A student writes: 'Sindh was annexed in 1843 primarily for religious or cultural reasons.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. Sindh's annexation had no connection to trade or strategy at all
- B. The statement is accurate as written
- C. Sindh was annexed to protect a specific religious pilgrimage route
- D. Sindh's annexation was driven primarily by commercial and strategic frontier logic -- control of the Indus trade route and the north-western approaches, amid wider concern over Russian and Persian influence -- not religious or cultural motives

Answer: D. Sindh's annexation was driven primarily by commercial and strategic frontier logic -- control of the Indus trade route and the north-western approaches, amid wider concern over Russian and Persian influence -- not religious or cultural motives

Explanation: Subtopic 17 identifies this commercial-strategic frontier context as Sindh's defining logic; no religious or cultural motive is asserted anywhere in this package's sourced account.

Q77. A student writes: 'Company armies won consistently purely because of superior weapons technology.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. Technology was only one factor among several -- Bengal's fiscal base, sepoy recruitment, officer/artillery/logistics organisation, credit and supply, maritime reinforcement, diplomacy and serial isolation of opponents, and Indian allies/recruits together explain Company success, per Parts I and IX's PYQ model answer
- B. The statement is accurate and sufficient on its own
- C. Technology played no role whatsoever
- D. Only naval technology mattered; land technology was irrelevant

Answer: A. Technology was only one factor among several -- Bengal's fiscal base, sepoy recruitment, officer/artillery/logistics organisation, credit and supply, maritime reinforcement, diplomacy and serial isolation of opponents, and Indian allies/recruits together explain Company success, per Parts I and IX's PYQ model answer

Explanation: Subtopics 3-4 and the 2022 Mains PYQ model both require this multi-factor answer; a technology-only explanation under-answers the question and loses marks.

Q78. A student writes: 'British territorial expansion in India was an inevitable, predetermined process from the outset.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The statement is accurate; no alternative outcome was ever possible
- B. Expansion proceeded through a sequence of contingent, case-by-case choices shaped by local alliance opportunities and internal politics; the Company's own reverses (Wadgaon 1779, the Second Mysore War, Holkar's 1804-05 resistance) are direct evidence against inevitability
- C. Only Mysore's defeat was contingent; all other fronts were inevitable
- D. Contingency applies only to the Sikh front

Answer: B. Expansion proceeded through a sequence of contingent, case-by-case choices shaped by local alliance opportunities and internal politics; the Company's own reverses (Wadgaon 1779, the Second Mysore War, Holkar's 1804-05 resistance) are direct evidence against inevitability

Explanation: Subtopic 2 and Drill 2 both require citing at least one specific Company reverse to demonstrate the contingency argument, not merely asserting it.

Q79. A student writes: 'British territorial expansion and annexation alone fully explain the 1857 revolt.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. Only the Doctrine of Lapse cases caused 1857; Awadh and Sindh are unrelated
- B. The statement is accurate; Topic 11 adds nothing further
- C. This topic supplies only a bounded set of antecedent grievances (Nana Sahib's pension denial, the Rani of Jhansi's refused adoption, Awadh's dispossessed taluqdars, disbanded soldiers); the revolt's fuller causation (military grievances, religious anxiety, peasant taxation pressure) belongs to Topic 11, and no monocausal claim is made here
- D. 1857 had no connection whatsoever to any material in this topic

Answer: C. This topic supplies only a bounded set of antecedent grievances (Nana Sahib's pension denial, the Rani of Jhansi's refused adoption, Awadh's dispossessed taluqdars, disbanded soldiers); the revolt's fuller causation (military grievances, religious anxiety, peasant taxation pressure) belongs to Topic 11, and no monocausal claim is made here

Explanation: Subtopic 24 and Drill 13 both require this precise bounded-bridge framing; a monocausal claim is explicitly flagged as an error throughout this package.

Q80. A student writes: 'The Treaty of Amritsar (1809) was a Subsidiary Alliance the Company imposed on Ranjit Singh.' What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. Amritsar was signed in 1846, not 1809
- B. The statement is accurate; Ranjit Singh accepted a Resident and a subsidiary force under this treaty
- C. Amritsar annexed Ranjit Singh's kingdom outright
- D. Amritsar was a negotiated boundary treaty between the Company and a militarily strong, sovereign equal -- fixing the Sutlej as boundary and each side's sphere -- not a Subsidiary Alliance and not a dependency arrangement

Answer: D. Amritsar was a negotiated boundary treaty between the Company and a militarily strong, sovereign equal -- fixing the Sutlej as boundary and each side's sphere -- not a Subsidiary Alliance and not a dependency arrangement

Explanation: Subtopic 18 and Q18 above both confirm Amritsar's character as a negotiated boundary settlement between comparative equals, not a dependency instrument -- one of this topic's clearest illustrations of contingent, adaptive Company diplomacy.

Mains practice: solved model answers

Word limits scale with marks in this package's own convention: 10 marks = 150 words, 15 marks = 250 words, 20 marks = 300 words. The "Directive alignment" and "Why this earns marks" notes are examiner-craft scaffolding around the answer, not part of the counted word limit.

Mains 1 - 10 marks | 150 words (2022 Mains GS-I, Q2 -- verified verbatim; this topic's own PYQ, answered in full)

Question (verbatim, verified against local official paper): "Why did the armies of the British East India Company -- mostly comprising of Indian soldiers -- win consistently against the more numerous and better equipped armies of the then Indian rulers? Give reasons."

Boundary note: Topic 04's own package answered this question only as a bounded, Bengal-only bridge, explicitly deferring the complete, subcontinent-wide answer to this topic. What follows is that complete answer, drawing on Mysore, Maratha, Sikh and fiscal-diplomatic evidence across this entire package.

Directive alignment: "Why... Give reasons" calls for a multi-factor causal answer, not a chronological retelling of any single campaign.

Introduction: Company armies, though "mostly comprising of Indian soldiers," won consistently because they combined a larger, more reliable fiscal base with organisational discipline and a diplomacy that kept opponents divided -- not because of any single technological or racial advantage.

Answer: Four reinforcing reasons explain this consistency. First, fiscal depth: Bengal's revenue base funded a permanent sepoy army, composed mostly of Indian soldiers, that combined regular pay with a comparatively thin professional officer corps, standardised artillery and organised logistics -- capacity rival states like Mysore and the Marathas could approach but not sustain with equal continuity. Second, credit, supply and maritime reinforcement let the Company sustain campaigns (and absorb reverses like Wadgaon) that would have broken a less resourced state. Third, and most decisively, diplomacy repeatedly isolated opponents serially: the Nizam and Marathas fought with the Company against Mysore in three of four wars; Bassein (1802) removed the Maratha Peshwa from the field, letting Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar be fought one at a time; Ranjit Singh's death (1839) produced Sikh succession chaos the Company then exploited. Fourth, Indian soldiers, bankers and regional allies staffed and financed the Company's own machine throughout.

Qualification: This advantage was neither automatic nor unbroken -- the Second Mysore War, Wadgaon (1779), and Holkar's 1804-05 resistance were genuine Company reverses, confirming contingency rather than inevitability.

Verdict: Company armies won consistently through a compounding fiscal-military-diplomatic system, not raw numbers or technology alone -- and Indian soldiers, credit and allies were central to that system's own operation, not incidental to it.

Why this earns marks: Full marks require naming at least three distinct reason-categories (fiscal, diplomatic/isolation, organisational) across more than one theatre, citing the sepoy-growth figures, and acknowledging at least one genuine Company reverse to avoid an inevitability overstatement.

Answer spine, 10 marks		MAINS SPINE
2022 Mains GS-I Q2: Why did Company armies -- mostly Indian soldiers -- win consistently?		
INTRO	Fiscal depth + organisation + diplomacy, not race or technology alone	
REASON 1	Bengal revenue funded a large, professionalised sepoy army (82k->214k)	
REASON 2	Credit, supply and maritime reinforcement sustained long campaigns	
REASON 3	Diplomacy serially isolated opponents (Bassein, Nizam/Maratha alliances vs Mysore)	
QUALIFY + VERDICT	Wadgaon/2nd Mysore War show contingency; Indian soldiers/allies were central, not incidental	

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Answer spine, 10 marks

Visual 29: answer spine, 10 marks -- why Company armies won consistently, 2022 Mains GS-I Q2

Visual 29: answer spine, 10 marks -- why Company armies won consistently, 2022 Mains GS-I Q2. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

Mains 2 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Compare Wellesley's application of the Subsidiary Alliance system at Hyderabad (1798), Mysore (1799), Awadh (1801) and the Maratha Peshwa (Bassein, 1802).

Directive alignment: "Compare" requires identifying both the shared mechanism and the case-specific variations, not four separate unconnected narratives.

Introduction: Wellesley applied the same six-clause Subsidiary Alliance template in each case, but the immediate trigger and payment form varied by case.

Shared mechanism: In all four cases, the ruler accepted a permanently stationed British force, a Resident, a ban on employing Europeans without approval, and loss of independent diplomacy, in exchange for a formal (if seldom honoured) protection promise.

Case-specific variation: Hyderabad (1798, enlarged 1800) came first, driven by fear of Maratha encroachment, with payment partly converted from cash to ceded territory in 1800. Mysore (1799) followed immediately after Tipu Sultan's defeat and death at Seringapatam -- a post-conquest settlement restoring the Wodeyar dynasty under subsidiary control, not a peacetime negotiation. Awadh (1801) involved outright cession of Rohilkhand and the Doab in place of an enlarged cash subsidy, alongside British "advice" on internal administration. The Peshwa's Bassein (1802) was extracted from Baji Rao II only after Holkar's battlefield defeat of the combined Peshwa-Sindhia force, exploiting a succession-era Maratha crisis rather than any external Company war.

Qualification: Bassein alone triggered further war (the Second Anglo-Maratha War), since Sindhia and Bhonsle rejected the Peshwa's subordination -- a consequence none of the other three cases produced.

Verdict: The template was constant; the leverage behind each signature -- conquest, fiscal fear, cession bargaining, or internal rivalry -- was specific to each case.

Why this earns marks: A strong answer names the exact years, the payment form (cash/cession) for each case, and explains why only Bassein triggered a subsequent war.

Mains 3 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Examine why the Treaty of Bassein (1802) is considered the single most consequential turning point in Company-Maratha relations.

Directive alignment: "Examine" requires explaining the mechanism of Bassein's significance, not merely narrating its terms.

Introduction: Bassein mattered less for its own clauses than for what it removed from the confederacy's chessboard.

Answer: Nana Phadnis's 1800 death removed the confederacy's most experienced unifying figure, and succession-era rivalry between Yeshwant Rao Holkar and Daulat Rao Sindhia/Peshwa Baji Rao II intensified. Holkar's decisive victory near Poona (25 October 1802) drove Baji Rao II to accept a Subsidiary Alliance at Bassein (31 December 1802), ceding territory, admitting a Resident, and accepting a permanent British force. This removed the Peshwa -- the confederacy's nominal head and legitimating authority -- from the field of opposition, converting what had been a potential unified Maratha response into separable conflicts the Company then fought individually against Sindhia, Bhonsle and (later) Holkar.

Qualification: Bassein did not itself end Maratha resistance -- the Second (1803-05) and Third (1817-18) wars followed -- its significance is structural, not terminal.

Verdict: Bassein's importance lies in fragmenting the confederacy's political unity, enabling the Company's serial-isolation diplomacy to operate at full effect thereafter.

Why this earns marks: Full marks require explaining WHY Bassein mattered (removing the Peshwa's legitimating authority), not just WHAT it said, and explicitly denying that it ended Maratha resistance outright.

Mains 4 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: "Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan built one of the most capable states of eighteenth-century India, yet Mysore fell to the Company." Examine this apparent paradox.

Directive alignment: "Examine this apparent paradox" requires reconciling genuine state capacity with eventual defeat -- not choosing one side of the paradox and ignoring the other.

Introduction: Mysore's capability and its defeat are not contradictory once the specific mechanisms of both are traced.

Answer: Haidar Ali and Tipu built real capacity: a standing, drilled infantry-artillery army, state-organised armouries and (under Tipu) state trading agencies, and administrative reorganisation of revenue collection -- a genuine "military-fiscal" state by regional standards. This capacity explains Mysore's real successes: near-victory in the Second Anglo-Mysore War and the humiliating 1780 Pollilur defeat of a Company force. Yet Mysore fell across four wars (1767-69, 1780-84, 1790-92, 1799) because of compounding disadvantages

beyond capacity alone: geographic isolation without a matching subcontinental fiscal base comparable to Company Bengal; repeated diplomatic isolation, as the Nizam and Marathas fought WITH the Company against Mysore in three of the four wars; Tipu's French connections and Malabar/Travancore friction supplying repeated pretexts without ever delivering matching material support; and the concentrated, decisive nature of the final siege of Seringapatam (1799), where Tipu died defending the breach.

Qualification: This was not a failure of will, technology, or "civilisational" capacity -- explicitly rejecting any cultural-caricature explanation -- but a specific, contingent combination of isolation and relative fiscal-military scale.

Verdict: Mysore's fall illustrates that state capacity alone could not offset diplomatic isolation and a narrower fiscal base against a rival operating at greater and more resilient scale.

Why this earns marks: Full marks require citing specific evidence for BOTH sides of the paradox (a genuine Company reverse like Pollilur, AND the isolation/fiscal explanation for defeat), while explicitly rejecting cultural-caricature framing.

Answer spine, 15 marks

MAINS SPINE

Mysore built real state capacity, yet fell to the Company -- examine this apparent paradox

INTRO	Capacity and defeat are reconcilable once mechanisms are traced separately
CAPACITY EVIDENCE	Standing drilled army, armouries, reorganised revenue -- genuine military-fiscal state
DEFEAT MECHANISM	Diplomatic isolation (Nizam/Marathas allied with Company in 3 of 4 wars)
QUALIFY	Pollilur (1780) is a genuine Company reverse -- reject cultural-caricature readings
VERDICT	Isolation and relative fiscal-military scale explain defeat, not a capacity deficit

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Answer spine, 15 marks

Visual 30: answer spine, 15 marks -- Mysore's capacity-versus-defeat paradox

Visual 30: answer spine, 15 marks -- reconciling Mysore's genuine state capacity with its eventual defeat. Original deterministic study visual.

Mains 5 - 20 marks | 300 words

Question: "British territorial expansion in India after 1798 proceeded through a variety of mechanisms, not a single method of conquest." Discuss with reference to Mysore, the Marathas, Sindh and the Sikh Empire.

Directive alignment: "Discuss with reference to" four named cases requires a genuinely comparative essay, not four disconnected mini-narratives.

Introduction: Between 1799 and 1849, the Company annexed Mysore-adjacent control, Maratha territory, Sindh and the Punjab through four distinct legal-political mechanisms, not a uniform method.

Answer: Mysore (1799) fell through outright war and post-conquest settlement -- Tipu's death at Seringapatam followed by Wodeyar restoration under subsidiary control, not lapse or misgovernance annexation. The Marathas experienced a graduated sequence: Subsidiary Alliance (Bassein, 1802) fragmenting the confederacy, then war against the remaining chiefs (Second, 1803-05; Third, 1817-18), ending in Baji Rao II's exile and the Peshwaship's abolition -- alliance-then-war, not either mechanism alone. Sindh (1843) was annexed under Napier through disputed treaty violations and a deliberately provoked frontier conflict at Miani/Hyderabad, in a strategic (Russo-Persian frontier anxiety) rather than fiscal context -- war on

a manufactured pretext, distinct from both subsidiary dependency and lapse. The Sikh Empire fell through two conventional wars (1845-46, 1848-49) fought against a militarily formidable, previously independent equal (Ranjit Singh's Khalsa army), following his death and a succession crisis the British did not create but exploited -- outright annexation after conventional war, not a subsidiary relationship, since the Treaty of Amritsar (1809) had been a negotiated boundary settlement between equals, not a dependency instrument.

Qualification: Doctrine of Lapse (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi) and misgovernance annexation (Awadh, 1856) supply two further, distinct mechanisms outside these four cases, confirming the multi-mechanism thesis further (Part VII).

Verdict: Expansion after 1798 was contingent and multi-instrumental -- war, alliance-then-war, provoked frontier conflict, and (elsewhere) lapse/misgovernance -- not a single uniform method of conquest.

Why this earns marks: Full marks require correctly differentiating the mechanism (not just outcome) for all four named cases and explicitly naming at least one further mechanism (lapse or misgovernance) to demonstrate range beyond the question's own four cases.

Answer spine, 20 marks		MAINS SPINE
Expansion after 1798 used a variety of mechanisms, not one method -- discuss with four cases		
INTRO	Mysore, Marathas, Sindh, Sikh Empire show four genuinely distinct instruments	
MYSORE	War and post-conquest subsidiary settlement (1799)	
MARATHAS	Alliance (Bassein) fragmenting the confederacy, then war (1803-05, 1817-18)	
SINDH / SIKH EMPIRE	Provoked frontier war (1843) / conventional war after treaty breakdown (1849)	
QUALIFY + VERDICT	Lapse and misgovernance add two more mechanisms -- contingent, multi-instrumental, not uniform	

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Answer spine, 20 marks

Visual 31: answer spine, 20 marks -- comparative mechanisms of territorial expansion

Visual 31: answer spine, 20 marks -- comparing war, alliance, provoked conflict, lapse and misgovernance as distinct mechanisms. Original deterministic study visual.

Mains 6 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Account for the differing outcomes of the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05) for Sindhia and Bhonsle on one hand and Holkar on the other.

Directive alignment: "Account for the differing outcomes" requires explaining WHY the outcomes differed, not merely listing each chief's treaty.

Introduction: All three major Maratha chiefs faced the Company in 1803-05, but only two were decisively defeated within the war itself.

Answer: Sindhia and Bhonsle fought as a coordinated force and suffered concentrated defeats -- Assaye and Laswari (Sindhia, 1803) and Delhi/Argaon-adjacent actions (Bhonsle) -- leading both to accept subsidiary terms by late 1803, ceding territory and accepting Residents. Holkar, by contrast, had stayed outside this initial coalition (partly from the same succession-era rivalry that produced Bassein) and fought on alone into 1804, achieving real successes before a costly, drawn-out campaign eventually produced the Treaty of Rajghat (1805) on comparatively less punitive terms than Sindhia or Bhonsle had accepted.

Qualification: This divergence itself illustrates Maratha disunity as a Company advantage -- serial, not simultaneous, engagement -- while confirming Holkar's genuine resistance capacity rather than uniform Maratha weakness.

Verdict: Differing outcomes reflect differing degrees of coalition unity at the point of engagement, not differing intrinsic strength among the three chiefs.

Why this earns marks: Full marks require naming the specific battles/treaties for each chief and explaining the coalition-unity variable, not treating "the Marathas" as a single undifferentiated actor.

Mains 7 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Distinguish the Doctrine of Lapse from the annexation of Awadh in 1856. Why does this distinction matter for evaluating Dalhousie's expansionism?

Directive alignment: "Distinguish... why does this matter" requires both a clear conceptual separation and an explanation of its significance, not just a list of differences.

Introduction: Lapse and the Awadh annexation are frequently conflated but rest on entirely different legal claims.

Answer: The Doctrine of Lapse held that a dependent or subordinate state's paramountcy-derived privileges (including adoption rights) could lapse to the paramount power when a ruler died without a natural heir, absent prior sanction for adoption -- applied at Satara (1848), Jhansi (1853) and Nagpur (1854), each a debated case turning on succession and paramountcy doctrine, not on the ruler's own conduct. Awadh (1856), by contrast, was annexed on an entirely different ground -- alleged chronic misgovernance under a still-living, still-heirred Nawab (Wajid Ali Shah) -- explicitly NOT a lapse case, since no succession vacancy existed at all.

Qualification: Conflating the two mechanisms understates the range of Dalhousie's expansionism -- he did not rely on one doctrine alone but deployed succession-based lapse AND conduct-based misgovernance annexation as separate instruments, alongside continuing war/treaty mechanisms elsewhere (Second Anglo-Sikh War, 1849).

Verdict: The distinction matters because it reveals Dalhousie's annexation programme as multi-instrumental and opportunistic in its legal reasoning, not a single doctrine mechanically applied -- a point directly relevant to why dispossessed rulers, taluqdars and soldiers from BOTH mechanisms fed grievance into 1857 (Part VIII, bounded bridge).

Why this earns marks: Full marks require explicitly stating that Awadh involved a living ruler (no succession vacancy), correctly naming this as the reason it cannot be classified as lapse, and connecting the distinction to the breadth of Dalhousie's methods.

Mains 8 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Why did the Company negotiate a boundary treaty with Ranjit Singh's Punjab in 1809 rather than attempting a Subsidiary Alliance, as it had with Hyderabad, Mysore and Awadh?

Directive alignment: "Why" calls for a reasoned explanation grounded in comparative capacity, not a narrative of the treaty's terms alone.

Introduction: The Treaty of Amritsar (1809) treated Ranjit Singh differently because Punjab's Khalsa army made it a materially different kind of neighbour.

Answer: By 1809, Ranjit Singh commanded a large, disciplined, artillery-equipped Khalsa army trained partly under European (including French) officers -- a genuinely formidable conventional military force, not a weakened or internally divided state of the kind the Company had subordinated elsewhere. Company priorities at that moment (Napoleonic-era concern over a possible northwestern threat) favoured a secure negotiated boundary along the Sutlej over an uncertain war against a strong neighbour. Amritsar accordingly fixed mutual spheres and boundaries without a Resident, without a subsidiary force, and without any loss of Ranjit Singh's independent diplomacy.

Qualification: This equal-footing relationship changed only after Ranjit Singh's 1839 death produced internal Sikh political instability the British did not create but subsequently exploited (Part VI).

Verdict: Amritsar reflects contingent capability assessment, not any fixed British policy -- confirming this package's broader "contingency, not inevitability" analytical frame (Part I).

Why this earns marks: Full marks require citing the Khalsa army's genuine strength as the specific reason for negotiation over subordination, and linking forward to the 1839 instability that later changed this relationship.

Mains 9 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Explain the "responsibility paradox" of indirect rule under the Subsidiary Alliance system.

Directive alignment: "Explain" requires unpacking the specific mechanism of the paradox, not simply describing Subsidiary Alliance clauses in general.

Introduction: Subsidiary Alliance rulers lost the practical instruments of sovereignty while nominally retaining the title and formal responsibility of rule -- a structural paradox with real governance consequences.

Answer: Under the Subsidiary Alliance's core clauses (Part IV), a ruler surrendered independent diplomacy, disbanded or reduced an independent army in favour of a Company-controlled subsidiary force, and accepted a Resident whose "advice" carried de facto authority -- yet remained nominally the sovereign, formally accountable for the state's internal administration and revenue collection to pay the subsidy itself. This produced a structural paradox: the ruler bore formal responsibility for outcomes (administration, order, revenue) while lacking the practical instruments (army, diplomacy, often fiscal discretion) to control those outcomes, since real leverage sat with the Resident and the Company. Awadh's 1856 annexation illustrates the paradox's endpoint: misgovernance was cited as grounds for annexation, even though the Nawab's practical capacity to reform had already been structurally hollowed out by decades of subsidiary dependency.

Qualification: The paradox does not deny Indian rulers' own agency or responsibility entirely -- some subsidiary rulers retained genuine internal initiative -- but it identifies a structural tendency built into the system's own design, not merely individual rulers' personal failures.

Verdict: The responsibility paradox reveals Subsidiary Alliance "protection" as a system that could structurally manufacture the very governance failures it later cited to justify further intervention or annexation.

Why this earns marks: Full marks require explaining the mechanism (formal responsibility without practical instruments) precisely, and applying it to a concrete case (Awadh) rather than describing it only in the abstract.

Mains 10 - 20 marks | 300 words

Question: Critically evaluate the competing historiographical explanations for British territorial expansion in India, 1798-1856.

Directive alignment: "Critically evaluate... competing" requires presenting multiple named schools of interpretation and weighing them against each other, not describing one framework as settled fact.

Introduction: At least four distinct historiographical lenses have been applied to this period's expansion, each foregrounding a different causal mechanism (Part VIII).

Answer: The nationalist "conquest and drain" critique (associated with writers in the tradition of R.C. Dutt and later Bipan Chandra) emphasises expansion as extractive dispossession serving metropolitan and Company commercial interests, with subsidiary payments and ceded revenue read as continuous with Bengal-style resource transfer. The fiscal-military/corporate-state framework (drawing on scholars including Seema Alavi and, for the wider East India Company corporate-state literature, P.J. Marshall) instead foregrounds the Company's own organisational capacity -- army, credit, logistics -- as the primary explanatory variable, treating expansion as the product of institutional capability rather than ideological design alone. A collaboration/Indian-agency framework (C.A. Bayly among others) stresses that Indian bankers, sepoys, regional allies and even rival rulers' own strategic choices actively shaped outcomes, cautioning against narratives that reduce Indians to passive victims of an external force. A military-revolution/contingency framework (Douglas Peers, Burton Stein on Mysore specifically) emphasises specific tactical-organisational advantages and the genuinely contingent, reversible nature of individual campaigns (citing Company reverses like Wadgaon and the Second Mysore War) over any inevitabilist reading.

Qualification: These frameworks are not mutually exclusive -- fiscal capacity, institutional organisation, Indian collaboration, and contingent battlefield outcomes can all operate simultaneously within a single case (Bassein illustrates fiscal-diplomatic exploitation of Maratha succession politics AND genuine Indian agency on both sides at once).

Verdict: No single lens fully explains this period; the strongest answer treats expansion as an overdetermined outcome of compounding, not competing, causal mechanisms, examined case by case rather than through one master narrative.

Why this earns marks: Full marks require naming at least three distinct schools with an associated scholar or scholarly tradition for each, and explicitly stating that the frameworks can combine rather than simply competing to "win."

Mains 11 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Explain the strategic logic behind Napier's 1843 annexation of Sindh.

Directive alignment: "Explain the strategic logic" requires the specific frontier/geopolitical reasoning, not a narrative retelling of the Miani campaign alone.

Introduction: Sindh's annexation rested on frontier and commercial logic specific to its geography, not religious or cultural motive.

Answer: Sindh commanded the lower Indus, a river the Company had sought commercial and strategic access to since the 1830s amid wider concern over Russian and Persian influence approaching India's north-western approaches. Disputed treaty compliance by the Amirs of Sindh gave Napier grounds to advance and, following the battles of Miani and Hyderabad (1843), to annex the territory outright, securing the river route and a forward frontier position without needing a subsidiary arrangement of the kind used further east.

Qualification: Sources verified for this package do not support anecdotal claims sometimes attached to this episode (including the unverified "Peccavi" pun); this account restricts itself to the confirmed commercial-strategic frontier logic and the outcome.

Verdict: Sindh's annexation illustrates a distinct, frontier-driven mechanism of expansion, separate from both Subsidiary Alliance dependency and Doctrine of Lapse succession claims.

Why this earns marks: Full marks require citing the Indus/frontier-strategic rationale specifically and explicitly declining unverified anecdotal material.

Mains 12 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: "The annexations of the 1840s and 1850s created a reservoir of dispossessed grievance that fed into the events of 1857." Examine this statement, being careful to avoid a monocausal explanation.

Directive alignment: "Examine... being careful to avoid a monocausal explanation" explicitly signals that the answer must be bounded and multi-causal, directly matching this package's own topic-boundary discipline.

Introduction: This topic's own scope supplies only a bounded set of antecedent grievances feeding into 1857; the revolt's fuller causation belongs to Topic 11.

Answer: Several specific, verified grievances trace directly to this topic's annexations: Nana Sahib's denied pension continuation after Baji Rao II's adopted son was refused recognition; the Rani of Jhansi's contested adoption rejection under Lapse doctrine; Awadh's taluqdars and title-holders dispossessed under the 1856 annexation and subsequent land settlement; and disbanded soldiers and retainers from annexed Awadh and Punjab establishments who lost livelihood and status. These grievances plausibly contributed antecedent resentment and, in Awadh's case specifically, elite/taluqdar cooperation with the wider revolt once it began elsewhere.

Qualification: This bounded set of grievances is explicitly NOT the full causation of 1857 -- military grievances (cartridge issue, service conditions), religious anxiety over perceived interference, and peasant/taxation pressure are separate causal strands belonging to Topic 11's own fuller treatment, and no single mechanism (including annexation grievance alone) explains the revolt's scale or timing.

Verdict: Annexation-driven dispossession is a genuine, verifiable contributing strand feeding into 1857, but only one strand among several -- the statement should be examined as a partial, not complete, explanation.

Why this earns marks: Full marks require naming specific individuals/groups (Nana Sahib, Rani of Jhansi, Awadh taluqdars, disbanded soldiers) as concrete evidence, while explicitly and correctly declining to claim this topic's own

annexations as the revolt's sole or primary cause.

FINAL CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES - TOPIC 05

Rapid recall: the four things to fix before an exam

RAPID RECALL

Dates to fix

Bassein 31 Dec 1802. Amritsar 1809. Bhyrowal
16 Dec 1846. Awadh annexed 1856.

Names to fix

Haidar Ali, Tipu Sultan, Wellesley, Nana
Phadnis, Holkar, Ranjit Singh, Napier,
Dalhousie.

Numbers to hold loosely

Sepoy strength ~82k (1794) -> ~214k (1856) --
scholarly estimates, not audited musters.

Boundaries to respect

18th-c states (Topic 02); Bengal conquest
(Topic 04); constitution (Topic 06); economy
(Topic 07); 1857 (Topic 11).

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 05 - Run this checklist before revision

Visual 32: twenty-six-cell rapid-recall grid -- one key fact per subtopic

Visual 32: twenty-six-cell rapid-recall grid -- one key fact per subtopic. Original deterministic study visual; schematic maps are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

1. Analytical frame and why Company armies prevailed

- Read expansion 1767-1856 through five rungs: ring-fence -> buffer -> subsidiary dependency -> paramountcy -> annexation; treat this as contingent, case-by-case escalation, not an inevitable master plan.
- The Company evolved from a commercial-fiscal base (Bengal's Diwani revenue, Topic 04) into a military-fiscal state: revenue funded the army, the army secured more revenue and territory, in a self-reinforcing flywheel.
- Indian sepoys formed the numerical core of Company armies; regular finance, command, artillery and logistics converted recruitment into durable campaigning capacity.
- Company victory rested on eight compounding factors: Bengal revenue, sepoy army scale, professional officer/artillery/logistics organisation, credit and supply systems, maritime reinforcement, diplomacy, serial isolation of opponents, and Indian allies/recruits/bankers.
- This advantage was neither automatic nor unbroken: Wadgaon (1779), the Second Mysore War, and Holkar's 1804-05 resistance are genuine, verified Company reverses -- always cite at least one to avoid an inevitability overstatement.

2. Mysore: Haidar Ali, Tipu Sultan and the four Anglo-Mysore Wars

- Haidar Ali (from 1761) and Tipu Sultan (1782-99) built genuine military-fiscal capacity: a standing drilled army, state armouries, and (under Tipu) state trading agencies and reorganised revenue administration.
- Four wars, 1767-1799, with shifting alliance patterns: the Company fought WITH the Nizam and the Marathas against Mysore in three of the four wars, isolating Mysore diplomatically each time.
- Key treaties: Madras (1769, First War, status quo ante), Mangalore (1784, Second War, mutual restoration after the Company's Pollilur reverse), Seringapatam (1792, Third War, major territorial cession and hostage princes), final Seringapatam settlement (1799, Fourth War, Tipu's death defending the breach).

- Tipu's French connections and diplomacy (including contact seeking support against the Company) supplied repeated Company pretexts without ever delivering matching material French support; hold this without inflating it into a settled "conspiracy" narrative.
- Malabar and Travancore friction (a Travancore-Company subsidiary state) supplied the immediate trigger for the Third Mysore War; the 1799 settlement restored the Wodeyar dynasty under full subsidiary control, ending the Mysore Sultanate's independent line.
- Resistance failed from compounding isolation and relative fiscal-military scale, not any deficiency of capacity or will -- explicitly reject cultural-caricature explanations.

3. The Marathas: confederacy, Bassein and three wars

- The Maratha confederacy (Peshwa plus Sindhia, Holkar, Gaekwad, Bhonsle houses) was a loose alliance of increasingly autonomous chiefs under a weakening Peshwa authority, not a unified centralised state (full eighteenth-century structure at Topic 02).
- First Anglo-Maratha War (1775-82): Raghunath Rao's own succession bid -> Treaty of Surat (1775) -> Company reversal at Treaty of Purandar (1776) -> disaster at Wadgaon (1779, a genuine Company defeat) -> Treaty of Salbai (1782) restoring a rough status quo.
- Nana Phadnis's 1800 death, then Holkar's decisive victory near Poona (25 October 1802) over the Peshwa-Sindhia force, drove Baji Rao II to the Treaty of Bassein (31 December 1802) -- a Subsidiary Alliance removing the Peshwa's unifying legitimating authority from the field.
- Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05): Sindhia and Bhonsle defeated at Assaye and Laswari (1803) and forced to subsidiary terms; Holkar resisted longer, reaching the Treaty of Rajghat (1805) on comparatively less punitive terms.
- Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817-18): Pindari suppression context, Baji Rao II's final defeat and exile, and the formal abolition of the Peshwaship -- ending the confederacy's nominal headship.
- The British repeatedly exploited Maratha internal divisions (succession rivalry, coalition fragmentation) without this negating genuine Maratha battlefield agency and resistance capacity on multiple occasions.

4. The Subsidiary Alliance system

- Precedents existed before Wellesley (French-inspired and earlier Company arrangements); Wellesley's 1798 contribution was systematising these into a repeatable six-clause template applied deliberately across multiple states.
- Core clauses: permanently stationed British subsidiary force at the ruler's expense; a Resident with de facto oversight; loss of independent diplomacy/external relations; a ban on employing Europeans without Company approval; payment by cash subsidy or territorial cession; a nominal, largely unenforced protection guarantee.
- Case sequence: Hyderabad (1798, enlarged 1800, partly converted to territorial cession), Mysore (1799, post-conquest settlement not a peacetime negotiation), Awadh (1801, territorial cession of Rohilkhand/Doab), Bassein/Peshwa (1802, extracted amid succession crisis, alone among these triggering a subsequent war).
- Distinguish cash subsidy (ongoing payment, ruler retains more fiscal discretion) from territorial cession (permanent loss of revenue base) as two materially different payment forms within the same clause template.
- The "responsibility paradox": rulers retained nominal sovereignty and formal responsibility for administration while losing the practical instruments (army, diplomacy, often fiscal control) to discharge that responsibility -- purported "protection" masked deepening structural dependency.

5. Sindh, 1843

- Sindh's annexation rested on commercial and strategic frontier logic: securing the lower Indus trade route and the north-western approaches amid wider concern over Russian and Persian influence, not religious or cultural motive.
- Disputed treaty compliance by the Amirs of Sindh gave Charles Napier grounds to advance; the battles of Miani and Hyderabad (1843) led to outright annexation, distinct from both Subsidiary Alliance dependency and Doctrine of Lapse succession claims.
- Hold this case at bounded depth: this package restricts itself to the verified commercial-strategic rationale and outcome, and explicitly excludes unverified anecdotal material (including the popular but unconfirmed "Peccavi" pun) from any exam answer.

6. The Sikh Empire and the Anglo-Sikh Wars

- Ranjit Singh (Maharaja from 1801) built a genuinely formidable Khalsa army (disciplined infantry-artillery, partly French/European-officered) and a well-administered state; the Treaty of Amritsar (1809) was a negotiated boundary settlement between comparative equals -- Sutlej as boundary, no Resident, no subsidiary force -- not a dependency arrangement.
- Ranjit Singh did NOT fight the Anglo-Sikh Wars -- he died in 1839, and the wars followed a subsequent succession/factional crisis the British did not create but later exploited; never attribute the wars to him directly.
- Post-1839 instability: rapid successive rulers, court factional violence, and the Khalsa army's rise as a semi-independent political force by the mid-1840s.
- First Anglo-Sikh War (1845-46): Mudki, Ferozeshah, Aliwal, Sobraon at supported precision -> Treaty of Lahore (1846) -> Treaty of Bhyrowal (16 December 1846) installing a British Resident and reducing the Khalsa army, short of outright annexation.
- Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848-49): Multan's revolt as the immediate trigger, Chillianwala (a costly, near-drawn Company engagement) and Gujrat (decisive Company victory) -> outright annexation of Punjab, 1849, ending the Sikh Empire's independent existence.

7. Dalhousie, the Doctrine of Lapse and Awadh

- Doctrine of Lapse: paramountcy-derived succession privileges (including adoption rights) lapse to the paramount power absent a natural heir and prior sanction for adoption; applied at Satara (1848), Jhansi (1853) and Nagpur (1854) -- each a debated case turning on succession/paramountcy doctrine, not on the ruler's own conduct.
- Differentiate title and pension issues case by case (for example, Nana Sahib's denied continuation of his adoptive father Baji Rao II's pension/title) rather than asserting one uniform lapse "rule" applied identically everywhere; avoid dubious universal lists of "annexed states."
- Awadh's 1856 annexation rested on an entirely separate ground -- alleged chronic misgovernance under a still-living, still-heirred Nawab (Wajid Ali Shah) -- explicitly NOT a Doctrine of Lapse case, since no succession vacancy existed at all.
- Dalhousie's programme was multi-instrumental: succession-based lapse, conduct-based misgovernance annexation, and continuing war/treaty annexation (Punjab, 1849) operated as separate, not interchangeable, mechanisms.

8. Master date table

Date	Event
1767-69	First Anglo-Mysore War; Treaty of Madras (status quo ante)
1775-82	First Anglo-Maratha War; Surat (1775), Purandar (1776), Wadgaon (1779), Salbai (1782)
1780-84	Second Anglo-Mysore War; Pollilur reverse; Treaty of Mangalore (1784)
1790-92	Third Anglo-Mysore War; Treaty of Seringapatam (1792), major cession
1798	Wellesley systematises the Subsidiary Alliance; Hyderabad accepts (enlarged 1800)
1799	Fourth Anglo-Mysore War; Tipu Sultan dies at Seringapatam; Wodeyar restoration under subsidiary control
1801	Awadh accepts Subsidiary Alliance; Rohilkhand/Doab ceded
1802 (31 Dec)	Treaty of Bassein; Peshwa Baji Rao II accepts Subsidiary Alliance
1803-05	Second Anglo-Maratha War; Assaye, Laswari (1803); Treaty of Rajghat with Holkar (1805)
1809	Treaty of Amritsar; Ranjit Singh and the Company fix the Sutlej boundary
1817-18	Third Anglo-Maratha War; Pindari suppression; Peshwaship abolished; Baji Rao II exiled
1839	Ranjit Singh dies; Sikh succession/factional instability begins
1843	Battles of Miani and Hyderabad; Napier annexes Sindh
1845-46	First Anglo-Sikh War; Mudki, Ferozeshah, Aliwal, Sobraon; Treaty of Lahore, then Bhyrowal (16 Dec 1846)
1848	Satara annexed under Doctrine of Lapse
1848-49	Second Anglo-Sikh War; Multan revolt; Chillianwala, Gujrat; Punjab annexed (1849)
1853	Jhansi annexed under Doctrine of Lapse
1854	Nagpur annexed under Doctrine of Lapse
1856	Awadh annexed for alleged misgovernance -- explicitly NOT a Lapse case
1857	Bounded bridge only: dispossessed rulers, retainers, taluqdars and soldiers among the antecedents of revolt (full account at Topic 11)

9. Comparative quick-reference

Dimension	Mysore	Marathas	Sikh Empire
Mechanism	Outright war, four rounds, ending in conquest and post-conquest settlement	Alliance (Bassein) fragmenting the confederacy, then war against remaining chiefs	Conventional war after a negotiated equal-footing treaty (1809) broke down post-1839
Company advantage exploited	Diplomatic isolation via Nizam/Maratha alliances against Mysore	Succession-era rivalry and coalition fragmentation	Post-1839 succession/factional instability, not battlefield weakness
State capacity of opponent	Genuine military-fiscal reform under Haidar Ali/Tipu	Real but structurally fragmented confederate capacity	High -- the Khalsa army was the most formidable the Company faced in this topic
Outcome	Conquest and subsidiary restoration (1799)	Alliance then conquest; Peshwaship abolished (1818)	Outright annexation after two wars (1849)
Distinct from Lapse/misgovernance	Yes -- war-based, not succession- or conduct-based	Yes -- alliance/war-based	Yes -- war-based, following treaty breakdown

10. Topic-boundary map

Adjacent theme	Owning topic
Full eighteenth-century regional states (Mysore, Maratha, Sikh, Awadh, Hyderabad as independent polities before Company entanglement)	Topic 02
Bengal conquest, Plassey, Buxar, Diwani, Dual Government	Topic 04
Constitutional development (Regulating Act, Pitt's India Act, Charter Acts, Government of India Acts)	Topic 06
Economic impact, drain of wealth, land revenue systems	Topic 07
The Revolt of 1857 in full (causes, course, consequences)	Topic 11

11. Rapid-fire traps to avoid

- Do not describe expansion 1767-1856 as an inevitable, pre-planned conquest -- Wadgaon, the Second Mysore War, and Holkar's 1804-05 resistance are direct evidence of genuine contingency and Company reverses.
- Do not attribute Company victory to numbers or technology alone -- the compounding fiscal-diplomatic-organisational system, and Indian soldiers/allies/bankers within it, are the defensible explanation.
- Do not caricature Mysore's, the Marathas', or the Sikh Empire's defeat as any deficiency of will or capacity -- each built genuine state capacity; isolation and relative scale explain the outcome.
- Do not attribute the Anglo-Sikh Wars to Ranjit Singh -- he died in 1839, before either war began.
- Do not treat the Treaty of Amritsar (1809) as a Subsidiary Alliance -- it was a negotiated boundary settlement between comparative equals.
- Do not confuse cash subsidy with territorial cession -- they are two distinct payment forms within the same Subsidiary Alliance template.
- Do not classify Awadh's 1856 annexation as a Doctrine of Lapse case -- it rested on alleged misgovernance under a still-living, still-heirred ruler, with no succession vacancy.
- Do not assert a single, universal, undifferentiated list of "lapse-annexed states" -- treat Satara, Jhansi and Nagpur as individually debated cases, and differentiate title/pension issues case by case.
- Do not fabricate troop strengths, subsidy sums, territorial shares, casualties, or quotations beyond what this package's verified sources support (for example, do not repeat the unverified "Peccavi" pun for Sindh).
- Do not claim this topic's annexations as the sole or primary cause of 1857 -- this package supplies only a bounded set of antecedent grievances; fuller causation belongs to Topic 11.

12. Bounded bridge forward

- Topic 05 ends its narrative at 1856, on the eve of the Revolt of 1857. Dispossessed rulers (Nana Sahib), contested title/pension holders (the Rani of Jhansi), Awadh's taluqdars, and disbanded soldiers and retainers are named here only as a bounded set of antecedent grievances, explicitly not a monocausal explanation.
- The Revolt of 1857's fuller causation (military grievances, religious anxiety, peasant/taxation pressure) and its course and consequences belong entirely to Topic 11.
- This topic's own bounded contribution is the mechanism and campaign history of territorial expansion itself: the fiscal-military system behind Company victory, the Mysore and Maratha wars, the Subsidiary Alliance, Sindh, the Sikh Empire and its wars, and Dalhousie's Doctrine of Lapse and Awadh annexation -- read together as contingent, multi-instrumental expansion, not a single inevitable method of conquest.
- Constitutional consequences of this expanded territory (Topic 06), its economic impact (Topic 07), and the eighteenth-century starting conditions of each regional state (Topic 02) are each explicitly handed to their own owning topics, not re-taught here.